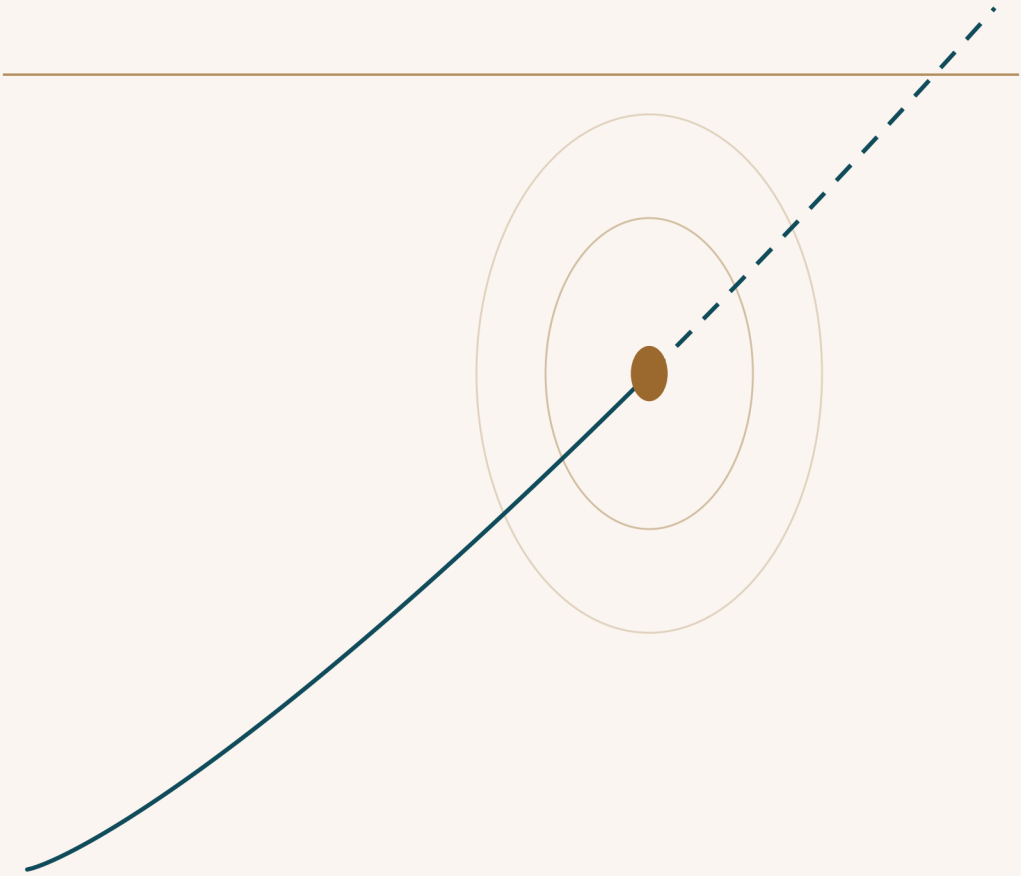
CAC MASTERS SERIES · VOLUME 3

CAC. 702

ADOLESCENT DEVELOPMENT

MASTER IN CHILDREN AND ADOLESCENT COUNSELING



TRIUNE BIBLICAL UNIVERSITY GLOBAL EXTENSION USA

ADOLESCENT DEVELOPMENT

CAC. 702

Adolescent Development

CAC. 702 · First Semester · 1.6 units · A complete lecture course for a sixteen-week semester

TRIUNE BIBLICAL UNIVERSITY GLOBAL EXTENSION USA

First Edition · 2026

Student Handbook of Comprehensive Lectures
Master in Children and Adolescent Counseling

First Edition, 2026

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DEDICATION

To the children and young people who sit in the room and are not yet sure whether they can be helped —

and to the counsellors who learn to be worth trusting.

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About This Book

This volume is the complete lecture course for **CAC. 702 Adolescent Development**, a First Semester core course of the Master in Children and Adolescent Counseling, carrying 1.6 units. It is written to be taught from and studied from without any other material in the room.

What the course is for

Every other course in the programme will teach you something to do with a child or an adolescent. This one teaches you why doing it might work, and how you would know whether it did. A counselling theory is not a belief system and not a loyalty; it is a set of answers to four hard questions — what a child is, what maintains the difficulty, by what mechanism change occurs, and what the counsellor therefore does. Answered well, those questions make practice deliberate, teachable and defensible to the parent, the school, the court or the licensing board that asks what you did and why. Answered badly or not at all, practice becomes a series of intuitive moves that cannot be evaluated and cannot be revised when they fail.

The course moves through the four great lineages of counselling theory — psychodynamic and attachment, behavioural and cognitive, humanistic and existential, systemic and family — reading each against the same four questions, and ends where practice actually lives: in the integration of competing accounts into a formulation for one particular child, held to the standard of the available evidence.

How the semester is organised

Sixteen weeks. Weeks 1 to 14 teach. Week 15 integrates: a comparative practicum in which the whole course is applied to a single extended case. Week 16 consolidates for examination. Each week is one lecture unit of about four notional hours — roughly ninety minutes of scheduled teaching, ninety minutes of seminar or practical work, and the remainder your own reading and writing. Each week has the same shape, and the shape is deliberate: outcomes you can be examined on;

the place of the week in the argument; four key concepts each tied to something a counsellor does in a room; three lectures built from propositions rather than narrative; at least one diagram placed where the argument needs one; worked examples; a practical with a debrief; seminar questions; the assessed task and its criteria; the reading, with the core text marked; and one sentence of synthesis.

A note on the child

The material is addressed throughout to work with children and adolescents, and that is not a decoration on an adult curriculum. A child cannot free-associate, may lack the vocabulary for a cognitive dispute, does not choose to attend, and is embedded in a family and a school that are themselves part of the problem and part of the solution. Theories built for adults fail in particular, predictable ways in a room with a nine-year-old. One purpose of this course is to teach you to see the failure coming.

Standards observed in this volume

British spelling in the book's own prose; American spelling preserved in quoted titles, journal names and direct quotations. Citations in APA 7th edition; only works actually cited are listed; no quotation, statistic or page number has been invented. All case material is fictitious and labelled as such; photographs generated for teaching are captioned as such; standardised instruments are described and attributed but never reproduced. Diagrams are drawn for this edition. The file is a tagged PDF conforming to PDF/UA-1. The governing specification is *HANDBOOK-STANDARD.md*, held with the series.

How to Use This Book

Read the outcomes first and last. Each week opens with what you will be able to do on completing it, written as capabilities that can be observed and examined. Read them before the week and again after it. If you cannot do what they say, you have not finished the week, however much of it you have read.

Work the examples as you meet them. Worked examples are set apart and are not optional reading. Cover the solution, attempt it, then compare. The distance between your attempt and the printed one is precisely the material the examination tests.

Do the practicals. Every week carries a practical — a timed exercise, a formulation task, a role-play, an observation or an analysis of supplied material — with a debrief. Most of them require another person or a recording of yourself and a clock. The practical is the part of the week most often skipped and the part that most changes practice. A theory you have only read is a theory you cannot use.

Keep the comparison grid. Figure 1.3 in week 1 is a blank grid: five questions down the side, four approaches across the top. Complete one column each time the course meets an approach, in your own words, and by week 15 reproduce the whole grid from memory and defend every cell. The grid is the course. Everything else is commentary on it.

Argue with the lectures. Each lecture ends in a clinical implication and a seminar question. The seminar questions are not rhetorical; write answers to them. Where a lecture states a contested position, the contest is named, and your task is to hold a position and say what would change it.

For the tutor. Each week is one four-hour block: ninety minutes of teaching, ninety minutes of seminar or practical work, the remainder preparation and follow-up. The three lectures are self-contained and may be reordered where a cohort needs the case before the theory. The assessed task printed in each week is the task set, and the criteria printed with it are the criteria used. Substitute local material in the vignette and the practical where a cohort's placements differ, provided the substitute is fictitious and labelled.

For the supervisor. The formulation exercises are yours. The question that converts knowledge into judgement is always the same: *which of the approaches in this week would formulate this case differently, and what would that formulation lead you to do on Tuesday?* A trainee who can state a mechanism of change and then say what would falsify it is ready for supervised caseload. A trainee who can only describe a theory is not.

Conventions

Convention	Meaning
Week *n*	the *n*th lecture week of the sixteen-week course
Lecture I, II, III	the three teaching sequences within a week
Worked example	a fully solved illustration; attempt it before reading the solution
Practical	a timed exercise with a debrief; requires a partner, a recording or supplied material
Hypothetical / fictitious composite	case material invented for teaching; no real client is described
Illustrative image (AI-generated)	a photograph created for this edition; depicts no identifiable person
Jurisdiction-dependent	a legal or reporting duty that must be checked against local law

Figures are numbered by week: Figure 3.2 is the second figure of week 3. Figure captions appear below the figure and table captions above the table. Every figure carries alternative text, and the file is tagged for screen readers.

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The Semester at a Glance

Sixteen weeks, one lecture unit each. Weeks 1–14 teach the course; week 15 integrates it on a single extended case; week 16 prepares the examination. The right-hand column names the assessed work of each week; the criteria for each are printed inside the week.

Week	Title	Principal lineage or task	Assessed
1	What Is Adolescence?	definitions, histories, the four questions	Reading response, 600 words
2	Puberty I: Bodies and Timing	the axis, the stages, the clocks	Timing analysis of a case
3	Puberty II: The Adolescent Brain	dual systems, pruning, the perfect storm of sleep	Dual-systems critique, 800 words
4	Thinking in Adolescence	formal operations, egocentrism, hot and cold cognition	Decision case analysis
5	Identity	Erikson, Marcia, ethnic and religious identity	Identity-status interview
6	Self, Esteem and the Body	trajectories, the comparison machine	Self-concept map
7	Emotion and Internalising	the gender gap, self-harm, the conversations that save	Risk-conversation log
8	The Family Renegotiated	autonomy, conflict, monitoring versus snooping	Conflict transcript analysis
9	Peers, Romance, Sexual Development	cliques, co-rumination, peer influence	Peer-ethnography note
10	School, Work and Aspiration	engagement, dropout, career development	Aspirations interview

Week	Title	Principal lineage or task	Assessed
11	Risk, Resilience, Positive Youth Development	function of risk-taking, the five Cs	Five-Cs audit
12	Adolescence Across Cultures	rites, child marriage, WEIRD critique	Critical review, 1,200 words
13	Clinical Adolescence	onsets, formulation, self-harm assessment	Formulation portfolio
14	Practice with Adolescents	engagement, confidentiality, motivational interviewing	Recorded interviewing segment
15	The Practicum: Three Adolescents	case conference at 13, 15 and 17	Practicum presentation
16	Revision and Examination	consolidation, past questions, examination technique	Final examination

Notional hours. 1.6 units ≈ 24 notional learning hours across the sixteen weeks, of which roughly one third is scheduled teaching and two thirds your own preparation, observation and writing. Weeks vary: the practicum week is heavier in supervised work, the revision week lighter in teaching.

Reading load. Each week marks one core text among its six readings. Read the core text before the week's teaching and the remainder across the week. The core texts of the course are Steinberg's *Age of Opportunity*, the *Lancet* commission on adolescent health and wellbeing (Patton and colleagues), and Sawyer and colleagues on the age of adolescence.

Adolescent Development

SEMESTER	UNITS	CATEGORY
First	1.6	Core

Every counsellor of adolescents carries a theory of adolescence, whether or not it has been examined. It is in the sigh behind "it is just a phase", in the flinch at the two-a-morning phone, in the sentence "we never did this at their age". This course puts those theories on the table, names them, tests them against evidence, and hands you back a set of instruments for understanding an adolescent developing — and for noticing, early and accurately, when development has left its ordinary course.

Adolescence is the strangest interval of the life course: the body matures earlier than it ever has, the social passage to adulthood later than it ever has, and the gap between the two keeps widening. In that gap a brain remakes itself — pruning, myelinating, reweighting reward against control — while the adolescent negotiates identity, esteem, desire, family jurisdiction, peer belonging, aspiration and risk, all at once, in public, with an instrument still under construction. The science of the last thirty years has overturned most of the folklore about this interval: storm and stress is neither universal nor inevitable, teenagers are neither recklessness personified nor adults-in-miniature, and the screens they carry are neither the apocalypse nor nothing. This course teaches what survived the overturning, and what the overturning itself teaches about evidence.

Two commitments govern the volume. The first is to evidence and to its limits: where a finding comes from narrow, wealthy, Western samples, you will be told; where a classic claim has been revised, you will meet the revision; where the honest answer is "we do not know", the book will say so rather than decorate. The second is to context: the adolescents of this programme grow up in compounds and classrooms, markets and churches, in several languages, in economies that tax their parents' patience, and in a digital village that arrives before the electricity sometimes does. An adolescence science that cannot speak to that world is not the science this course teaches.

A fictitious household — Adaeze, fourteen, and her cousin Kelvin, sixteen, in the care of their Auntie Bisi — accompanies the course from week 1 to week 15,

so that each theory meets the same adolescents and you can watch the theories disagree about them. Their story is a labelled composite: no real client is in these pages, and none of it is a case report.

1 LECTURE UNIT 1 Teaching week 1 4 notional hours

What Is Adolescence? Definitions, Histories and the Four Questions

LEARNING OUTCOMES

By the end of this week you will be able to:

1. **Define** adolescence biologically, socially and legally, and state why the three definitions disagree about where it begins and ends.
2. **Trace** the invention of adolescence as a concept — Hall's storm and stress, Mead's Samoan counter-evidence, the modern consensus — and say what each episode teaches about evidence.
3. **Explain** the widening-gap account of adolescence's lengthening: earlier puberty, later social adulthood, and the consequences of a longer gap.
4. **Apply** the four questions of the series — what develops, by what process, with what universality, to what purpose — to one adolescent case.
5. **State** the three corrections the modern science makes to "storm and stress": turbulence is not universal, not uniform and not inevitable.

Where this week sits

Volume 2 ended at the school gate of childhood. This volume follows the child through the gate that opens into adolescence — the period your clients will occupy for a decade of their lives and most of your working week. The week begins where all science begins: with the argument about what the thing is. Adolescence is at once a biological event, a social invention and a legal fiction, and the three do not agree; the counsellor works in the space between them.

Key concepts

ADOLESCENCE

The period between the onset of puberty and the assumption of adult roles and responsibilities: bounded at one end by biology and at the other by society, which is why its length is a historical variable rather than a natural kind. In the room: the reason a fourteen-year-old can be a defendant, a mother, a breadwinner and a child in the same week, in the same town.

STORM AND STRESS
Hall's claim that turbulence is inherent to adolescence: conflict with parents, mood disruption, risk behaviour. Partly true at group level, wholly false as destiny: most adolescents pass through with strong family ties and no serious trouble, and where turbulence concentrates it tracks context, not calendar. In the room: the myth that lets services call suffering "a phase".

THE WIDENING GAP
Adolescence lengthens from both ends: pubertal onset earlier (nutrition, health, secular trend) and adult markers later (schooling, labour markets, marriage age). A longer gap means more years of capacity without jurisdiction — more learning, more risk, more of your caseload. In the room: why "in my day we were adults at sixteen" is both true and irrelevant.

EMERGING ADULTHOOD
Arnett's proposal of a distinct period from the late teens through the twenties — identity exploration, instability, self-focus — in societies where adult roles delay further. In the room: the twenty-three-year-old on your caseload who is neither adolescent nor settled adult, and whose formulation needs a name for where they are.

Lecture I — Three definitions, one person

Proposition 1. The biological definition begins with puberty and ends nowhere in particular. Puberty is an event cascade with measurable onsets (week 2); biology offers no equally clean offset, because bodies do not become adult at a moment — they become adult in systems, at different rates, and the brain's reorganisation runs into the mid-twenties.

Proposition 2. The social definition begins and ends with roles, and roles are local. Where marriage, farming or trade admit a person at thirteen, adolescence is short; where a profession and a mortgage admit at twenty-eight, it is long. The social definition is therefore the honest one for practice: an adolescent is a person whom their society treats as not-yet-adult, and the treatment varies by gender, class and locality within a single city.

Proposition 3. The legal definition is a set of lines drawn for administrative reasons, and they contradict each other. The age of criminal responsibility, of consent, of marriage, of voting, of enlistment, of drinking: rarely the same number, sometimes in the same statute book. The counsellor works inside these contradictions daily — a fifteen-year-old who can consent to treatment in one framework and cannot consent to leave school in another — and the file must record which line governed which decision.

PRACTICE NOTE

Clinical implication. Open every adolescent file with three lines: biological stage (pubertal status, in the young), social roles carried (work, care, marriage, school), and the legal lines that touch this month's decisions. Three lines that prevent most of the category errors adolescence invites.

Lecture II — The invention of adolescence, and its refutation, and the consensus

Hall named adolescence in 1904 and gave it a temperament: storm and stress, inevitable turbulence of a transitional age. Mead answered in 1928 from Samoa: where the culture distributed child-rearing widely and sexuality without hysteria, the storm did not appear — adolescence, she argued, is a culture's product more than a gland's. The modern reading of that famous dispute is a lesson in evidence: Mead's fieldwork was thinner than her prose, and Hall's universal was a description of his own society's adolescents; both overreached, and the truth that survived is the transaction — puberty supplies the reorganisation, culture supplies the weather.

The consensus that followed, and that governs this volume, has three corrections to storm and stress. **Turbulence is not universal:** most adolescents report good family relationships, no serious risk behaviour, and no disorder; the minority in whom turbulence concentrates is identifiable by context — conflict at home, deviancy-prone peers, unsupervised time, early puberty in a late-maturing school. **Turbulence is not uniform:** it peaks in early to mid-adolescence for conflict and risk, and later for some internalising difficulty; a sixteen-year-old's calm is not evidence that the fourteen-year-old's storm was imaginary. **Turbulence is not inevitable:** it is the product of identifiable transactions, and transactions can be changed — which is the entire warrant for this profession's work with adolescents.

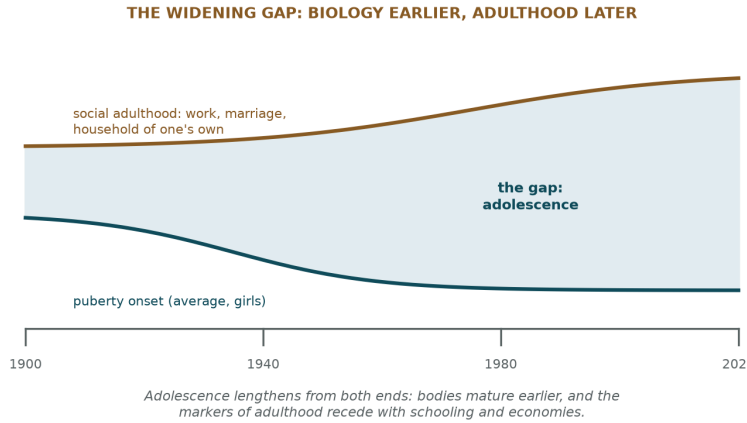


Figure 1.1 The widening gap across 1900-2020: pubertal onset falling, social adulthood rising, and the shaded space between them — adolescence — lengthening from both ends. *Source:* prepared for this edition, after Sawyer et al. (2018) and Patton et al. (2016).

Lecture III — The four questions, adolescent form

What develops? The body through puberty; the brain through pruning, myelination and a reorganisation of reward and control systems (week 3); cognition into hypothesis and abstraction (week 4); the self into an identity with commitments (weeks 5–6); emotion regulation into an adult repertoire under new emotional weather (week 7); relationships into autonomy-with-attachment at home and intimacy in friendship and romance (weeks 8–9).

By what process? Hormonal cascade and brain reorganisation; the social redefinition that hands the adolescent new audiences and new mirrors; and, above all, transaction — the adolescent's new behaviours evoking new responses from parents, peers and institutions, which shape the next round of behaviour. Adolescence is the clearest demonstration in the whole curriculum that development is a two-way street: the child who becomes an adolescent changes the household, and the changed household changes the adolescent.

With what universality? Puberty's sequence is universal; its timing is not. Identity work appears wherever society grants a moratorium; where it grants none, identity is foreclosed early and the "crisis" your textbooks describe is a luxury of the gap. The WEIRD critique of volume 1 bites hardest here: much adolescent psychology was built on American high-school students, and the adolescent of this programme may be a trader, a carer, a spouse or a migrant worker at fourteen.

To what purpose? To produce, by the end of the period, a person who can regulate emotion, hold commitments, work with others and tolerate uncertainty

— and to produce them by rehearsal, in the safest theatre available. Adolescence is not a storm to survive; it is a specialisation period for becoming someone, and the counsellor's work is to keep the theatre safe enough to rehearse in.

The running case of this volume

Adaeze and Kelvin — a fictitious composite. Adaeze ("Ada") is fourteen, in Secondary 2: bright, recently quiet, her mother says "the light has gone out of her" since the move to the senior school; she sleeps late, wakes late, and has stopped singing in the church choir. Her cousin Kelvin is sixteen, in SS1, repeating: charming, unreliable, recently arrested for a phone snatch he says he "only held", and the family's declared problem. Their auntie Bisi runs the household — the children's mother trades in another state, their father died when Ada was nine. No real family is described; the details accumulate week by week as each theory meets them.

Worked example 1.1 — Three definitions on one file

Task. Kelvin, sixteen, is charged as an adult-equivalent under one statute, treated as a child under the children's statute for care purposes, married in no law but expected in his community to contribute as a man, and biologically post-pubertal since thirteen. Write the three definition lines and state which governs your work this month.

Solution. Biological: post-pubertal three years; brain reorganisation mid-course; sleep phase delayed (week 3). Social: expected to earn and to be a man; granted no moratorium; his "irresponsibility" is judged against an adult role he carries economically but not juridically. Legal: criminal responsibility as charged; care and protection as a child; no voting, no contract. The governing definition for counselling this month: the social one, because the maintaining transactions run through the role-gap — he is treated as a man when he earns and as a boy when he decides, and the inconsistency is precisely what his risk behaviour negotiates. The file records all three lines and names the governor, so that when the court letter arrives the formulation does not have to be reinvented under pressure.

Worked example 1.2 — Storm and stress, audited

Task. Auntie Bisi says of Kelvin: "boys this age are madness itself; it will pass." Audit the claim against the three corrections.

Solution. Not universal: Kelvin's co-rumination-free cousin Ada is turbulent in a different register (withdrawal, sleep), and most of their peers are neither arrested nor withdrawn — the claim generalises from the loudest case. Not uniform: Kelvin's conflict and risk peaked at fifteen to sixteen, consistent with the group curve; Ada's internalising presentation is on a later-rising curve, so "it will pass" applied to her would be a missed depression (week 7). Not inevitable: the transactions maintaining Kelvin's risk are nameable — unsupervised evenings, a

deviancy-prone peer set, a household whose monitoring collapsed into snooping then into surrender (week 8) — each changeable, and the change is the work. The counsel to Bisi honours her sentence and corrects its grammar: "You are right that much of this is the age. You are also right that it passes — for most boys, because most boys have what Kelvin lost: an adult who knows where they are at nine o'clock. We are going to put that back, and then we will see what the age is doing and what it was never doing."

SKILLS LABORATORY

Practical 1 — the three-line opening. Take two adolescent cases you know (anonymised) or the supplied pair. Write the three definition lines (biological, social, legal) for each, then one sentence naming which definition governs your work this month and why. Exchange with a partner and defend the governor sentence against one objection. 300 words total; the mark is for the governor sentence.

ASSESSMENT

Assessed task. A reading response of 600 words: choose one claim in this week's core text about what is universal in adolescence, state its sample, and argue whether it travels to the adolescents you will counsel — ending with one practice change the argument compels.

Criterion	Weight
Claim stated precisely with its sample	30%
Universality argued, not asserted	40%
Practice change concrete	30%

Formative. Submit the three-line opening for both cases.

UNIT SYNTHESIS

Synthesis. Adolescence is bounded by biology at one end and by society at the other, which is why its length is history's variable; storm and stress survives only as three corrections — not universal, not uniform, not inevitable; and the period is best understood as a specialisation for becoming someone, rehearsed in the safest theatre available, which is what the counsellor is employed to keep safe.

READING (APA 7TH)

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- Hall, G. S. (1904). *Adolescence: Its psychology and its relations to physiology, anthropology, sociology, sex, crime, religion and education*. D. Appleton.

- Mead, M. (1928). *Coming of age in Samoa: A psychological study of primitive youth for Western civilisation*. William Morrow.
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Seminar questions

1. Which of the three definitions governs your own society's treatment of a married fourteen-year-old, and which should?
2. Mead versus Hall: what does the dispute teach about the sample behind every universal?
3. "It will pass." Under which of the three corrections does the sentence become dangerous, and for whom?
4. If adolescence lengthens because adulthood recedes, what does a twenty-three-year-old client owe the adolescent framework?
5. What was your own adolescence's theatre, and who kept it safe?

Next week

Week 2 follows the body: the axis that wakes, the stages it drives, the clocks of timing, and the psychological consequences of maturing early or late in a particular school.

2 LECTURE UNIT 2 Teaching week 2 4 notional hours

Puberty I: Bodies, Timing and Their Consequences

LEARNING OUTCOMES

By the end of this week you will be able to:

1. **Outline** the hypothalamic–pituitary–gonadal axis and its feedback, and state why puberty's first changes are invisible and nocturnal.
2. **Describe** the sequence of pubertal changes in girls and boys, and use stage language carefully in files and with families.

3. **Explain** the secular trend in pubertal timing and its principal drivers, without overclaiming any single cause.
4. **Analyse** the psychological consequences of early and late maturation in each sex, in context: the same timing, different meanings in different schools and peer groups.
5. **Counsel** a family through an off-timing puberty — early, late, or discordant with gender identity — with accuracy and without shame.

Where this week sits

Adolescence begins in the body, and the body's timetable is the first thing a counsellor must know because it sets the stage for everything else: the child whose body races ahead of the peer group meets a different social world from the child whose body lags, and neither world is the one the child's age would suggest. This week is endocrinology for counsellors: enough mechanism to be accurate, enough context to be humane, and the timing literature that turns "early" and "late" from adjectives into formulations.

Key concepts

HPG AXIS
Hypothalamus, pituitary, gonads (with the adrenals contributing the first androgens): a feedback system whose pulse pattern changes in sleep years before anything is visible, so that puberty is under way long before anyone can see it — and long before the child can name what is happening. In the room: the reason a nine-year-old's mood can be pubertal before any adult would use the word.

SECULAR TREND
The century-scale fall in pubertal onset, steepest in the early twentieth century with nutrition and infection control, continuing more slowly since; drivers debated across nutrition, body fat, stress and endocrine-disrupting exposures, with no single cause established. In the room: the reason "she is too young for this" is often false, and the reason the gap of week 1 keeps widening at its early end.

OFF-TIMING
Maturing markedly earlier or later than one's peer group; the consequences run through the social meaning of the difference — early-maturing girls face sexualised attention they did not seek, early-maturing boys gain status that recruits them upward in age among peers, late-maturing boys lose size in a size-valuing peer culture, late-maturing girls are largely spared the early girl's sexualisation and largely silent about the relief. In the room: timing effects are context effects, and the context is where the work is.

PUBERTY AND GENDER

For a child whose gender identity does not match the body puberty is building, pubertal changes are not development but injury; the clinical conversation includes the existence of pause-and-pathways care where law and service permit, and always includes the child's own words first. In the room: the week's hardest counselling, and the week's clearest duty to accuracy without shame.

Lecture I — The axis that wakes

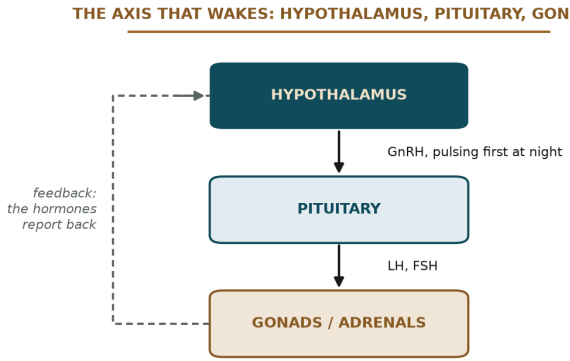


Figure 2.1 The hypothalamic-pituitary-gonadal axis with its feedback loop: GnRH pulsing first at night, gonadotrophins, gonadal and adrenal hormones, and the hormones reporting back to the brain. *Source:* prepared for this edition.

Proposition 1. Puberty is a change in a conversation, not the arrival of a substance. The hormones were always present; what changes is the hypothalamus's pulse pattern, released from childhood inhibition, first at night — which is why growth hormone and the early gonadotrophin pulses arrive in sleep, and why the first pubertal evidence a family sees is often a change in sleep and growth rather than in shape.

Proposition 2. The sequence is orderly; the timing is not. Breast development or testicular enlargement first, then pubic hair, then the growth spurt, then menarche or voice-change late in the sequence — the order holds, the ages scatter across several years, and menarche arrives after the peak of the height spurt, which is why the tall girl in SS1 may still be years from cycles and the short one may not. Files that record "puberty complete" on shape alone are files that will misdate everything downstream.

Proposition 3. The adrenals start their own clock. Adrenarche — the adrenal androgen rise with its body odour, skin and hair changes — runs on a separate schedule from the gonadal axis, and it is usually the first thing the household notices; the child who "smells like a person now" at eight is not precocious on the gonadal clock, and the reassurance is worth a sentence in the consultation.

> **PRACTICE NOTE**
> **Clinical implication.** Date puberty in the file by stage and informant, not by impression: what has been observed, by whom, since when — and where the child is a transgender or gender-questioning child, record that the staging conversation follows the child's lead and the safeguarding and medical pathways of week 13.

Lecture II — Timing and its meanings

The secular trend is real and uneven: onset fell dramatically as nutrition and infection control improved, and continues to fall more slowly, with obesity, early-life stress and some chemical exposures each carrying partial evidence and none carrying the whole effect. The honest sentence to a family: "bodies start earlier than they used to, for reasons science has not finished arguing about; your daughter is not abnormal, and she is not behind — she is on today's curve."

The off-timing literature is the counsellor's part. **Early-maturing girls** face attention from older peers and adults that sexualises a child; their elevated rates of internalising difficulty and of early substance use track that attention and the peer company it recruits, not the hormones alone — which is why the intervention is the environment's conduct, never the girl's clothing. **Early-maturing boys** gain stature and status, are recruited upward in age by peers and by coaches, and carry risks that look like privilege: older company, older substances, older offences. **Late-maturing boys** lose the size economy of the peer group and show elevated teasing and, in some samples, later-recovering self-esteem. **Late-maturing girls** report the least distress of the four groups, and the finding is a window into what early maturation actually costs: the relief of the late girl is the measure of the early girl's burden.

All four patterns are context-dependent: a school that groups by age and prizes size amplifies; a school that groups by skill and prizes work dampens; a household with an adult who notices and names protects. Timing sets the stage; the cast decides the play.

> **SAFEGUARDING AND DUTY TO REPORT**
> Two safeguarding edges attach to pubertal timing. First, the sexualised attention to an early-maturing child is adult and peer conduct, and where it crosses into harassment or abuse the child is a victim and the record must say so in those words

— no formulation of "early maturity" may drift into implying invitation. Second, where a family seeks to "protect" an early-maturing daughter by withdrawing her from school or hastening marriage, the child's right to education and to childhood governs, and the counsellor's duty is to the child with the family in the room, not to the family's fear.

Lecture III — Counselling the off-timing body

The early girl. Accuracy first: what is happening, in what order, over what months, so the body stops being a rumour. Conduct second: the family's and school's obligations named plainly — no adult comments on her body, no older-peer contact unsupervised, the uniform and sport questions solved with her rather than for her. Meaning third: the sentence that protects the self — "your body is early; your childhood is not over; nothing about this makes you older than you are" — repeated by every adult in the house, because she will hear the opposite daily.

The late boy. The work is smaller and real: the peer economy of size named as an economy rather than a verdict; one competence domain where he is visibly good and publicly so; and the forecast, honestly given, that the size gap closes and usually reverses — with the dates of his own father's or uncle's late growth if the family knows them, because a family story outperforms a statistic.

The child whose gender and body disagree. The conversation begins with the child's words and ends nowhere in a single session. Three duties: accuracy about what puberty will do if it proceeds, because the child deserves the map; accuracy about what care exists — pause-and-pathways where law and service permit, and the referral route with its waiting times, because false hope is a harm; and the immediate work that needs no pathway at all — the social affirmation the family can give now, the school's conduct, and the child's own naming of themselves, which is protective in the evidence and costs nothing but courage.

> **PRACTICE NOTE**
> **Clinical implication.** Rehearse the puberty conversation in your counselling language until it is plain: axis, sequence, timing, meaning, conduct. Families do not forget the consultation in which a professional named the body without shame; they forget everything else about that month.

Worked example 2.1 — Ada at nine-and-a-half

Task. Ada's development began at nine-and-a-half: breast development and odour, then pubic hair; menarche at eleven-and-a-half, in a school where most girls began at twelve-and-a-half or later. She is now fourteen and says she "hates being looked at". Formulate the timing strand.

Solution. On-timing by population norms, off-timing by peer group: the distinction that organises everything. Between nine-and-a-half and twelve she was the earliest body in her class for two and a half years — the precise window in which the early-maturing girl's risks concentrate: sexualised comment (an uncle's joke, recalled verbatim in session three), older-boy attention at the gate, and the choir's withdrawal when her voice and shape changed before her friends'. The maintaining transactions now: she dresses to disappear, which reads as sullenness and recruits correction; she sleeps late, which the household reads as laziness and recruits conflict; both are protections she cannot name without naming the looking. The formulation's timing strand therefore reads: early-relative-to-peers maturation with sexualised attention history; current maintenance by concealment strategies misread as conduct problems; intervention aimed at the conduct of the environment (a school conversation about gate conduct, with Ada's consent and without her exposure), the household's reading of her strategies (week 8′s reframing), and one domain where her body is an instrument rather than an object — she chooses it, and the choir, if it returns, must return on her terms. Falsifier, dated: if the "hated looking" sentence broadens into global self-worth collapse or eating restriction (week 6, week 13), the timing strand is not the governing strand and the formulation reorders.

Worked example 2.2 — Kelvin's late cousin, and the family story

Task. Chuka (Kelvin's friend, fifteen) is the smallest boy in SS1, teased as "pikin", and has begun refusing sport. Counsel in the register of this week.

Solution. Three moves. The economy named: "In your school, size is money in the boys' market. That is a fact about the market, not about you." The competence domain: he is the best goalkeeper the junior team had two years ago and left when the size teasing began; the return is engineered not by persuasion but by a role the team needs now — penalty practice specialist, a public competence that does not require winning a tackle. The forecast with a family story: his uncle, present at the conversation, tells his own fifteen-year-small, twenty-year-tall history in ninety seconds, with the dates; the boy's face changes at the dates, not at the adjectives. The record notes the peer-economy sentence, the role, the story, and the review date at term's end with one observable: whether he stays after practice twice. The safeguarding note: teasing that becomes organised humiliation is bullying with a power asymmetry, and the school's duty is engaged the week it is named — this week.

SKILLS LABORATORY

Practical 2 — the timing audit. For one adolescent case (supplied or your own, anonymised): date pubertal onset and current stage with informant; locate the child

against their peer group's timing, not the population's; list the social meanings their timing has carried in their school and household; and write one environmental intervention and one meaning intervention. 400 words. The mark is for the peer-group comparison, which most audits omit.

ASSESSMENT

Assessed task. A timing analysis of 900 words on a supplied case: stage and informant, population versus peer-group timing, the social meanings carried, the maintaining transactions, and two interventions (environment, meaning) each with a dated falsifier.

Criterion	Weight
Stage dated with informant; population v. peer group distinguished	30%
Social meanings specified, not assumed	25%
Transactions maintaining the current difficulty	25%
Interventions concrete, dated, falsifiable	20%

Formative. Write the puberty conversation's first three sentences in your counselling language, plain enough for a frightened eleven-year-old.

UNIT SYNTHESIS

Synthesis. Puberty is a change in a feedback conversation that begins in sleep; its sequence is orderly and its timing is not; the secular trend lengthens adolescence at its early end; and off-timing consequences run through social meaning — the attention, the status, the teasing — so the counsellor dates the body accurately, locates it against the peer group rather than the population, aims at the environment's conduct and the child's meaning, and holds the gender-discordant child's map and hope with equal accuracy.

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- Blakemore, S.-J., Burnett, S., & Dahl, R. E. (2010). The role of puberty in the developing adolescent brain. *Human Brain Mapping, 31*(6), 926–933.
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Mahon, J., McGovern, T., Mokdad, A. H., Patel, V., Petroni, S., Reavley, N., Taiwo, K., ... Viner, R. M. (2016). Our future: A *Lancet* commission on adolescent health and wellbeing. *The Lancet, 387*(10036), 2423–2478.

- Steinberg, L. (2014). *Age of opportunity: Lessons from the new science of adolescence*. Houghton Mifflin Harcourt. — **core text**; chapter 2.

Seminar questions

1. Why does the first pubertal evidence arrive in sleep, and what does that teach about what families notice first?
2. An early-maturing girl's risk runs through other people's conduct. What follows for where the intervention sits?
3. Late-maturing girls report the least distress. What exactly does that finding measure?
4. Where your law and service permit pause-and-pathways care, what does the child deserve to know, and when?
5. Which adult named your own body without shame at puberty — and what did they say?

Next week

Week 3 follows the hormones into the skull: pruning, myelination, the dual systems of reward and control, and the sleep storm that makes the first bell of the morning an act of institutional jet lag.

3 LECTURE UNIT 3 Teaching week 3 4 notional hours

Puberty II: The Adolescent Brain and the Perfect Storm of Sleep

LEARNING OUTCOMES

By the end of this week you will be able to:

1. **Describe** adolescent brain development in its three movements: synaptic pruning, myelination, and the differential maturation of reward and control systems.
2. **State** the dual-systems account and its critics, and use the model as a hypothesis about vulnerability windows rather than as an excuse.
3. **Explain** the adolescent sleep phase delay as biological, and compute the mismatch between biological sleep and school bells for a given timetable.
4. **Critique** brain-based overclaiming in popular discourse: what the neuroscience does and does not license a counsellor to say.

5. **Advise** a school or family on three sleep-protective changes with evidence behind each.

Where this week sits

The hormones of week 2 reach a brain that is mid-renovation. This week is the neuroscience a counsellor actually needs: not to excuse anyone, but to locate the vulnerability windows, to explain to a parent why the same child reasons like an adult at nine in the morning and like a stranger at eleven at night, and to make the case — in evidence, not in sentiment — for the later school bell.

Key concepts

PRUNING AND MYELINATION

Two simultaneous movements: the elimination of unused synapses (use it or lose it, on an adolescent schedule) and the insulation of the connections that remain, which speeds and coordinates them. The adolescent brain is therefore not an unfinished adult brain but a specialised one: highly plastic, rapidly specialising to whatever the adolescent actually does. In the room: the scientific warrant for filling the years with practice rather than with waiting.

DUAL SYSTEMS

Reward-sensitivity rises steeply with puberty and peaks in mid-adolescence; cognitive control rises more slowly into the mid-twenties; the gap between the curves is the window of elevated risk-taking — and of elevated learning, because the same reward sensitivity that funds the dare funds the mastery. In the room: a hypothesis about windows, never a verdict about character.

SLEEP PHASE DELAY

At puberty the circadian clock shifts later: melatonin onset moves towards the night, and the adolescent body wants to sleep around eleven and wake around eight. Early school bells therefore impose chronic partial sleep deprivation on the youngest adolescents, with costs in mood, attention, memory consolidation and road risk on the morning commute. In the room: the most evidence-backed, least expensive intervention in adolescent mental health, and the hardest to win.

HOT-COLD GAP

Adolescent decision-making approximates adult performance in cold cognition (alone, unhurried, unaroused) and diverges sharply in hot cognition (peers present, emotion high, time short). In the room: why the same adolescent who analyses a

dilemma wisely in your office makes the disastrous choice at the party, and why the intervention is the situation rather than the lecture.

Lecture I — Three movements of renovation

Proposition 1. Pruning is specialisation, and specialisation is political. The synapses that survive adolescence are the ones the adolescent uses; the ones that do not, go. A decade spent in fear prunes a fear-specialised brain; a decade spent in music, sport, argument or care prunes accordingly. The counsellor's interest is therefore not only in what the adolescent suffers but in what the adolescent **does**, because the doing is the sculpting.

Proposition 2. Myelination coordinates, and coordination is what judgement is. Judgement is rarely one region's work; it is the timed coordination of many, and myelination of the long tracts — prefrontal to limbic, across hemispheres — is what makes coordination fast enough to matter in a hot moment. The slow maturation of these tracts is the biological grain inside the hot-cold gap.

Proposition 3. The dual-systems gap is a window with two faces. The same reward sensitivity that elevates risk elevates learning: adolescence is the peak period for skill acquisition, for love of novelty, for the courage to leave the compound and try the stage. A discourse that reads the gap only as danger has misread a specialisation period as a defect, and has missed the intervention: fill the window with mastery, and the window fills with mastery.

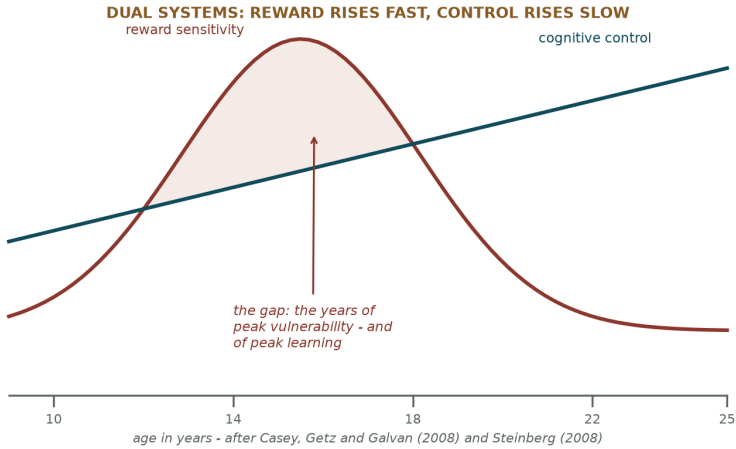


Figure 3.1 Dual systems across ages 9-25: reward sensitivity peaking in mid-adolescence while cognitive control rises slowly; the shaded gap is the window of peak vulnerability and of peak learning. After Casey, Getz and Galvan (2008) and Steinberg (2008). *Source:* prepared for this edition.

PRACTICE NOTE

Clinical implication. Ask the pruning question in every adolescent intake: what does this adolescent actually do, most days, for hours? The answer names the brain being built, and it names the material any intervention has to work with.

Lecture II — The model and its critics

The dual-systems account has been usefully attacked, and the attacks improve it. **Timing critique:** control systems mature earlier in cold laboratory tasks than the model's rhetoric suggests; the gap is smaller in the cold and larger in the hot, which is precisely the hot-cold finding. **Social critique:** the "peer effect" is not mere presence but evaluation — adolescents take more risks when they believe they are being watched by peers whose opinion matters, which relocates the mechanism from arousal to social evaluation, and social evaluation is something a counsellor can work with. **Determinism critique:** the curves are group averages with enormous individual and contextual variance; sleep, stress, substance use and training move an individual's control function materially.

The disciplined use follows: the model licenses **window-talk** (these years carry elevated risk and elevated learning under evaluation and arousal), **situation-talk** (change the heat, the audience and the hour, and the same mind performs differently), and **no excuse-talk** (the brain account explains; it does not exempt; and an adolescent who hears their prefrontal cortex cited as their alibi has been handed a script for helplessness).

SAFEGUARDING AND DUTY TO REPORT

Brain-talk in files and courts carries risk: "his prefrontal cortex is immature" reads, in a hearing, as "not responsible", and in a family, as "cannot help it". Neither reading serves the child. The sentence that serves: "the adolescent brain explains elevated vulnerability under heat and audience; it does not remove capacity to learn from consequences delivered fairly, and it makes the arrangement of situations — not the abolition of expectations — the treatment."

Lecture III — Sleep: the perfect storm, and the bell

At puberty the circadian phase delays: melatonin onset shifts later by roughly one to two hours across the transition, and sleep pressure builds more slowly, so the adolescent body at ten at night is physiologically where the child's body was at eight. Add early bells — seven-thirty in many secondary schools — and the result is chronic partial deprivation: the adolescent sleeps late from biology, wakes early from institution, and repays the debt at weekends with a nine-hour collapse that further delays the clock. The costs are not subtle: mood and irritability, attention and working-memory loss (volume 2, week 5), impaired consolidation of the

day's learning, elevated depressive symptoms in several cohorts, and the morning commute run on a sleep-deprived attention system.

The interventions, in order of evidence and cheapness: **later bells** where any flexibility exists — the single change with the strongest returns in attendance, mood and attainment in the school-start literature; **light and dark hygiene** — morning light outside, screens dimmed and out of the bed, because light is the clock's hand; **homework and chore architecture** — the evening's demands moved earlier or reduced, because a phase-delayed child cannot do algebra at midnight and call it discipline; and **weekend debt limits** — lie-ins capped at about two hours past weekday waking, because larger shifts re-jet-lag the week.

The counsellor's role is advocacy with arithmetic: compute the mismatch for the actual timetable, present it with the costs, and offer the cheapest change first. Where the bell cannot move this year, the evening can, and the family's evening is the counsellor's jurisdiction.

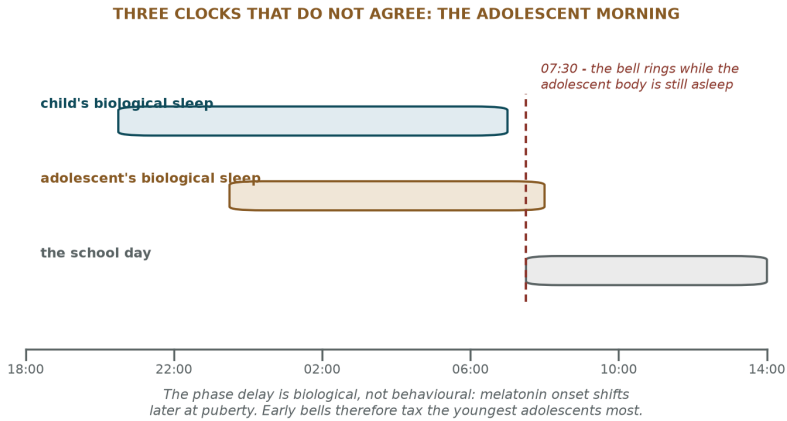


Figure 3.2 Three clocks that do not agree: the child's biological sleep window, the adolescent's delayed window, and the school day beginning at 07:30 while the adolescent body is still asleep; the phase delay is biological, not behavioural. *Source:* prepared for this edition.

PRACTICE NOTE

Clinical implication. In every adolescent intake, one sleep line: bedtime, wake time, bell time, weekend lie-in, screens in bed. Five numbers that explain a surprising share of what the file will otherwise call mood disorder, laziness or defiance.

Worked example 3.1 — Ada's "laziness", computed

Task. Ada sleeps at 23:30 on school nights (body willing), wakes at 06:15 for a 07:30 bell, and sleeps to 11:00 on Saturdays. Compute the mismatch and write the family sentence.

Solution. Weeknight sleep about six hours three-quarters against a biological need nearer nine: a daily debt of about two and a quarter hours, five days a week — eleven hours a week, repaid partly on Saturday with a four-and-a-half-hour lie-in that delays Sunday night's onset and guarantees Monday's worst morning. The household reads the Saturday collapse as laziness and the Monday misery as attitude; both are arithmetic. The family sentence, plain: "Her body's clock moved at puberty, the way bodies do. The bell did not move. Between them she loses eleven hours a week, and every one of them comes out of her mood, her memory and her mornings. We are not going to win against her biology with punishment; we are going to take two hours back from the evening, cap the Saturday lie-in at two hours past her weekday waking, and put the phone outside the room at ten — and in six weeks we will compare the mornings." The school sentence, for the advocacy file: the same arithmetic with the attendance and attainment literature attached, and the cheapest ask first — move the first period's hardest subject later in the morning, which costs nothing and returns the second period.

Worked example 3.2 — The party and the office: hot cognition in one case

Task. Kelvin reasons carefully in session about the phone-snatch episode — consequences, victims, his own fear — and eleven days later is in a fight at a party with his peers watching. Reconcile without excusing.

Solution. The two Kelvins are one mind in two weathers. In the office: cold cognition — alone, unhurried, unwatched, and his reasoning approximates an adult's, which the session record shows. At the party: hot cognition — peers evaluating, alcohol present, provocation in the moment — and the same reasoning function is outperformed by the evaluation-audience mechanism the dual-systems literature names. The reconciliation sentence for the file and for Kelvin: "Your thinking in this room is real and it is yours; at the party, the audience borrowed it. The work is not to grow a new brain but to arrange the situations — who is with you, what is in your hand, when you leave — so the brain you already have gets to the party." Consequences stand: the fight has victims and a school process, and fairness requires they proceed; the formulation changes the **plan**, not the accountability. The falsifier is behavioural and dated: if, with two agreed situation-arrangements in place (a leaving time and a peer pair), the next eight weeks pass without a hot-cognition incident, the situation hypothesis holds;

if incidents recur inside arranged situations, the formulation turns to the peer set's function and to week 9's deviancy questions.

SKILLS LABORATORY

Practical 3 — the sleep audit and the ask. Take one adolescent case or a supplied timetable. Compute the weekly sleep debt from five numbers; list three changes in evidence order (bell or subject-timing, evening architecture, weekend cap, light and screens); and write the two sentences — family version and school version — with which you would ask for the cheapest one. 300 words. The mark is for the arithmetic being visible in both sentences.

ASSESSMENT

Assessed task. A dual-systems critique of 800 words: state the model, one timing critique and one social critique, then argue — with one case — what the model licenses a counsellor to say and what it forbids, ending with the no-excuse sentence in your own words.

Criterion	Weight
Model stated accurately, curves and window	30%
Critiques engaged, not name-dropped	30%
Licensed and forbidden sentences distinguished	25%
No-excuse sentence present and usable	15%

Formative. Submit the sleep audit with both ask-sentences.

UNIT SYNTHESIS

Synthesis. The adolescent brain is renovating: pruning specialises to what the adolescent does, myelination coordinates what judgement needs, and reward and control mature on different clocks whose gap is a window of risk and of learning alike; sleep's phase delay makes early bells an institutional jet lag with measurable costs; and the disciplined use of all this is window-talk, situation-talk and no excuse-talk — the brain explains, the situation treats, and the child remains a person accountable inside both.

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Seminar questions

1. Pruning specialises to use. What is your service asking adolescents to specialise in, by what it gives them to do?
2. The peer effect is evaluation, not mere presence. What changes in an intervention once you accept that?
3. Compute your own adolescent sleep debt from memory. Which of the four interventions would have recovered the most hours, cheapest?
4. Where is the line between explaining and excusing, in a sentence you would actually say to a court?
5. A school says bells cannot move. What is your cheapest ask, and what evidence do you carry to the meeting?

Next week

Week 4 turns to thinking: formal operations in practice, adolescent egocentrism's two mirrors — the imaginary audience and the personal fable — and the hot-cold gap as it appears in the decisions that reach your desk.

4 LECTURE UNIT 4 Teaching week 4 4 notional hours

Thinking in Adolescence: Formal Operations, Egocentrism and Decisions Under Heat

LEARNING OUTCOMES

By the end of this week you will be able to:

1. **Describe** formal-operational thought in adolescence — hypothesis, abstraction, the ideal against the real — and its uneven arrival across domains and schooling.
2. **Explain** adolescent egocentrism's two constructions: the imaginary audience and the personal fable, and use each to read a clinical sentence.
3. **Distinguish** hot from cold cognition in a decision analysis, and locate the divergence point for one case.

4. **Counsel** with the idealism of formal operations rather than against it: the adolescent's newly discovered ideals as therapeutic material.
5. **Design** one decision-support arrangement that changes the heat rather than the lecture.

Where this week sits

The adolescent mind acquires a new instrument — the ability to think about thought, to hold the hypothetical, to compare what is with what could be — and the instrument has side-effects: an audience that is always watching, a fable of personal exception, and an idealism that finds every adult arrangement wanting. This week is the cognitive adolescence of the series: what changes in thinking, what the changes cost, and how the counsellor recruits the new instrument to the work instead of arguing with its side-effects.

Key concepts

FORMAL OPERATIONS
Thought about the hypothetical and the ideal: reasoning from possibilities rather than only from objects, holding variables in mind and testing them, and — decisively for practice — comparing the real against the possible, which is the root of adolescent critique of parents, schools, religions and selves. In the room: the reason the fifteen-year-old can dismantle your argument and cannot yet weigh it against tomorrow.

IMAGINARY AUDIENCE
The construction that others are as preoccupied with the self as the self is: the audience that notices the shirt, the stumble, the silence. Not vanity but a cognitive over-extension of the new ability to model other minds — modelled, now, relentlessly, upon the self. In the room: the mechanism under the shame spiral, the refused assembly, the deleted photograph.

PERSONAL FABLE
The construction of personal uniqueness and exception: my experience is unlike anyone's, and the ordinary consequences do not apply to me — the fable that funds both the dare and the solitude ("no one has ever felt this"). In the room: the sentence beneath "it won't happen to me" and beneath "no one understands", which are the same sentence in two weathers.

HOT-COLD DIVERGENCE
The gap between decision performance in cold conditions (alone, unhurried, unaroused) and hot conditions (peers, emotion, immediacy); in adolescence the gap

widens sharply, and the divergence point — the moment the decision moved from cold to hot — is usually identifiable in the narrative and is where the intervention sits. In the room: the analytic question "at which sentence did the room get hot?"

Lecture I — The new instrument and its uneven arrival

Proposition 1. Formal operations arrive as a capacity and mature as a practice. The adolescent who can hold a hypothesis in a chemistry argument may reason concretely about their own future in the same hour; the capacity is domain-sensitive and schooling-sensitive, and it is exercised where a culture exercises it — in argument, in examination, in faith instruction, in market negotiation. The counsellor therefore tests the instrument in the domain of the problem, not in the abstract.

Proposition 2. The ideal becomes a tool, and tools are dangerous. With the possible in hand, the adolescent measures the real: the parent against the ideal parent, the school against the ideal school, the self against the ideal self. The critique that follows is not disrespect but development doing its work — and the self-measurement is the strand that, unmoderated, becomes the perfectionism and body-comparison of week 6.

Proposition 3. Metacognition makes the self an object of study. The adolescent can now think about their own thinking, which is the precondition of every reflective therapy — and the precondition of rumination, which is reflection without an exit. The same instrument that powers the therapeutic conversation powers the two-a-morning loop; the difference is structure, and structure is teachable.

PRACTICE NOTE

Clinical implication. Locate the instrument before using it: one hypothesis question in the domain of the problem ("if your belief about the party is true, what would we see on the video?"). If the adolescent can hold it, the therapy can be collaborative; if not, the work is enactment and experience first, and reflection later.

Lecture II — Two mirrors: audience and fable

Elkind's constructions explain a family of clinical sentences. **The imaginary audience** reads: "everyone saw my hands shake"; "I cannot go back to that class"; "the whole church was looking". The audience is a cognitive over-extension — the new mind-modelling turned upon the self — and it is treatable as a hypothesis rather than as a fact: who, exactly, was looking? what did they see? what did they do in the next minute? The deconstruction is Socratic and brief, because the audience rarely survives its own headcount.

The personal fable reads two ways. As exception: "that pregnancy talk is about other girls"; "the bike without lights is fine, I know that road"; the fable here is a hypothesis about base rates that can be tested with the adolescent's own data. As solitude: "no one has ever felt this"; the fable here is a grief about uniqueness, and it is met not by headcount but by witness — the sentence "I hear that it feels unlike anything anyone has felt; I am here, in it, with you" precedes any cognitive work, because a fable of solitude dismantled before it is witnessed becomes proof of itself.

The two mirrors share a root and a remedy: the new ability to model minds, over-applied to the self, corrected by **evidence about real minds** (the headcount) and by **one real mind staying present** (the witness). Counselling supplies both, in that order, in the weather the sentence arrives in.

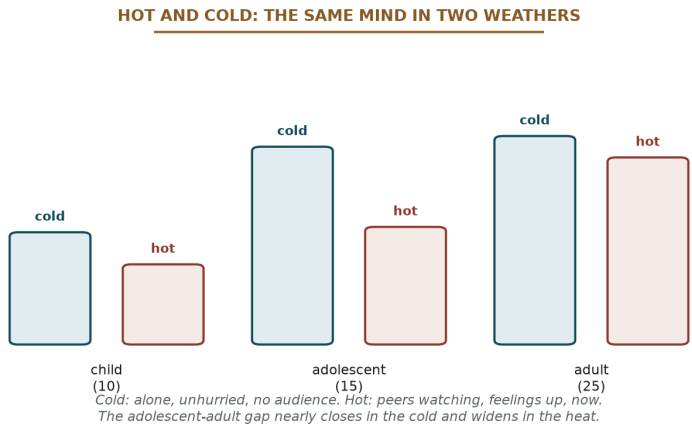


Figure 4.1 Hot and cold cognition: decision quality by age in cold conditions (alone, unhurried) and hot conditions (peers watching, feelings up); the adolescent-adult gap nearly closes in the cold and widens in the heat. *Source:* prepared for this edition.

Lecture III — Decisions under heat: the divergence point

Adolescent decision research converges on a pattern the counsellor can use forensically: in cold conditions adolescents' reasoning approaches adults'; in hot conditions it diverges, and the divergence is greatest where peer evaluation is present. The clinical method is to locate the **divergence point** in the narrative — the sentence at which the decision left the cold: "then Tunde looked at me", "then she said my name in that voice", "then the group went quiet". Before the point, the adolescent's own reasoning is usually sound and quotable; after it, the audience and the arousal govern.

Three interventions follow, in order. **Reconstruct the cold:** have the adolescent narrate their own pre-point reasoning aloud, in their words, and record it —

the file now contains proof of competence that the post-point disaster obscured, and the adolescent hears their own cold mind, which is the strongest anti-fable evidence available. **Arrange the heat:** identify the two or three situational variables that moved the decision (audience, substance, hour, phone in hand) and engineer them for the next equivalent situation — a leaving time, a peer pair, a phone rule, a route; the plan is written with the adolescent, because an arrangement imposed is an arrangement evaded. **Rehearse the hinge:** the single sentence the adolescent will say at the divergence point next time ("I'm leaving at ten"), rehearsed aloud twice in session, because a sentence rehearsed in the cold is retrievable in the heat and a sentence invented in the heat is not.

> **SAFEGUARDING AND DUTY TO REPORT**
> Hot-cognition analysis must never become consent analysis in reverse: where an adolescent's "decision" occurred under coercion, exploitation or an adult's grooming, the heat was manufactured by another person and the child is a victim, not a decision-maker. The divergence-point method applied to grooming locates the adult's engineering — and the record must say so in those words, because the file may one day be the child's evidence.

Worked example 4.1 — The assembly refusal, headcounted

Task. Ada (14) refuses to attend morning assembly because "everyone will see me walk in late and look at my skin". Work the imaginary audience as hypothesis, in order.

Solution. Witness first: "Being looked at has become a kind of pain for you. I am not going to argue you out of it today." Then the headcount, as three testable questions rather than a challenge: (i) *Who, exactly, is everyone?* — the assembly has four hundred pupils; Ada names three who might look. (ii) *What would they see?* — a girl walking in late; Ada's own prediction includes "they will see my face shining", and the question "shining how, at eight in the morning, in that light?" begins the evidence work about the skin itself (week 6's strand joins here). (iii) *What do they do in the next minute?* — Ada's answer, after thought: "they look at the person singing at the front." The audience survives the headcount as three names and one minute, which is bearable; the four-hundred abstraction was not. The arrangement: entry by the side door with the late-book for two weeks (the heat reduced while the evidence accumulates), and one rehearsed hinge sentence for the day she walks in the main door: "I'm late; I'm here." The falsifier, dated: if the refusal generalises beyond assembly to classrooms within three weeks, the audience is not the governing mirror and the formulation turns to week 7's internalising strand.

Worked example 4.2 — Kelvin's divergence point

Task. Reconstruct the phone-snatch narrative to the divergence point and write the arrangement plan with Kelvin.

Solution. Cold segment, in Kelvin's words: "I knew the plan was stupid from the start; I said I would only carry the bag." The competence is on the record. Divergence point, located at one sentence: "then the owner shouted and the boys looked at me to move." Audience plus arousal plus a role ("the one who moves") — the hot trio. Post-point, the reasoning function is absent from the narrative, which is the signature, not a moral verdict. The arrangement plan, written **with** him and signed: a leaving time from any gathering where the set assembles after dark (ten, with a code message to the auntie that costs him no face); a peer pair — one named cousin who walks his route; the bag rule stated as his own sentence ("I don't carry for anybody; my hands stay empty") rehearsed twice aloud; and the hinge for the shout-moment: "I'm not the one; I'm going." Consequences for the offence proceed separately and fairly, and the file holds both: the accountability and the divergence map. Review at eight weeks against one observable — hands empty, messages sent — and against the falsifier: an incident inside an arranged situation reopens the peer-set question of week 9.

SKILLS LABORATORY

Practical 4 — the divergence interview. In pairs, one narrates a real adolescent decision from a supplied transcript while the other interviews for the divergence point using three questions only: what were you thinking just before? who was there, and what could they see? what changed in your body at that sentence? Record the point, the two situational variables, and one rehearsed hinge sentence. Swap. 250 words each; the mark is for locating the point at a sentence, not at a mood.

ASSESSMENT

Assessed task. A decision case analysis of 900 words: for a supplied hot-cognition incident, reconstruct cold reasoning verbatim, locate the divergence point at a sentence, name the heat variables, and write the three-part plan (reconstruct, arrange, rehearse) with a dated falsifier — plus one paragraph on whether the heat was manufactured by another person, and what changes if it was.

Criterion	Weight
Cold reasoning quoted, competence visible	25%
Divergence point located at a sentence with evidence	25%
Heat variables named; plan in three parts, rehearsed hinge included	30%

Criterion	Weight
Coercion question asked and answered	20%

Formative. Write your own adolescent personal fable in one sentence, and the witness sentence you needed at fifteen.

UNIT SYNTHESIS

Synthesis. Formal operations hand the adolescent the hypothetical and the ideal, and with them the critique of everything including the self; egocentrism's two mirrors — the imaginary audience and the personal fable — are the new mind-modelling over-applied, corrected by headcount and by witness; and decisions diverge from the adolescent's own cold reasoning at an identifiable hot point, so the work is to reconstruct the cold, arrange the heat and rehearse the hinge — unless the heat was manufactured by another person, in which case the child is a victim and the file says so.

READING (APA 7TH)

- Elkind, D. (1967). Egocentrism in adolescence. *Child Development, 38*(4), 1025–1034.
- Gardner, M., & Steinberg, L. (2005). Peer influence on risk taking, risk preference, and risky decision making in adolescence and adulthood: An experimental study. *Developmental Psychology, 41*(4), 625–635.
- Piaget, J., & Inhelder, B. (1969). *The psychology of the child*. Basic Books. — the formal-operational chapters, re-read for adolescence.
- Steinberg, L. (2014). *Age of opportunity: Lessons from the new science of adolescence*. Houghton Mifflin Harcourt. — **core text**; the decision-making chapters.

Seminar questions

1. An adolescent dismantles your argument with formal logic and then acts against it at night. Which week's material explains the gap, and which explains the bridge?
2. The personal fable as solitude requires witness before headcount. Why is the order clinical and not merely kind?
3. Locate a divergence point in your own adolescence at one sentence. What were the two heat variables?
4. Where does hot-cognition analysis shade into victim-blaming, and what sentence marks the border?
5. Adolescent idealism finds every arrangement wanting. What in your service deserves the critique?

Next week

Week 5 follows the ideal into identity: Erikson's crisis, Marcia's statuses, and the ethnic, religious, sexual and digital identities an adolescent must assemble into one self.

5 LECTURE UNIT 5 Teaching week 5 4 notional hours

Identity: The Crisis That Is Not a Crisis

LEARNING OUTCOMES

By the end of this week you will be able to:

1. **Explain** Erikson's identity versus role confusion as a developmental task with a social precondition — the moratorium — and state who is granted one and who is not.
2. **Apply** Marcia's four statuses to one adolescent across three domains, and use status-language as description rather than rank.
3. **Describe** ethnic and religious identity development and their protective function under discrimination, and counsel across a difference you do not share.
4. **Hold** sexual orientation and gender identity development with accuracy: the diversity of trajectories, the minority-stress mechanism, and the evidence on affirmation.
5. **Interview** an adolescent about identity in their own registers — faith, work, friendship, digital self — without importing the textbook's domain list.

Where this week sits

Identity is adolescence's signature task: the assembly of the child's identifications, talents, loyalties and shames into a self that can hold under pressure and make promises. This week moves from Erikson's crisis to Marcia's statuses to the identities that carry the most weight and the most risk in real adolescent lives — ethnic, religious, sexual, gendered, digital — and installs the interviewing discipline that lets a counsellor hear which identity is actually in crisis, because it is rarely the one the referral names.

Key concepts

IDENTITY V ROLE CONFUSION

Erikson's fifth crisis: the integration of childhood identifications and new capacities into a coherent self with commitments, against the confusion of a self that cannot cohere or commit. Its virtue is fidelity — the capacity to be loyal to people and to promises. In the room: the question beneath most adolescent distress — not "what is wrong?" but "who am I, and who will let me be it?"

MORATORIUM
The socially granted pause in which identity may be explored without penalty: the gap-year, the apprenticeship, the permitted doubt. Moratoriums are distributed unequally — by class, gender, culture and economy — and where none is granted, identity forecloses early or confuses long. In the room: the structural sentence behind "why has she not decided?" — because nothing around her can afford the question.

IDENTITY STATUSES
Marcia's crossing of exploration and commitment: diffusion (neither), foreclosure (commitment without exploration), moratorium (exploration without commitment), achievement (both). Statuses are positions within domains, not traits of persons: the same adolescent may be achieved in friendship, foreclosed in vocation and in moratorium on faith. In the room: a map fine-grained enough to counsel with.

MINORITY STRESS
The chronic excess stress carried by members of a stigmatised identity — enacted, anticipated and internalised — over and above ordinary stress; the mechanism beneath the elevated distress of discriminated-against adolescents, and the reason their distress is not evidence of identity pathology but of social conduct. In the room: the sentence that relocates the treatment from the child to the environment.

Lecture I — Erikson's task and its social precondition

Proposition 1. Identity is assembled, not discovered. The materials are the child's identifications (the mother's voice, the father's trade, the teacher's standard), the adolescent's new capacities (week 4′s instrument), and the society's available roles; the work is integration into a self that can keep a promise across situations. Role confusion is not rebellion but incoherence: a self whose parts cannot be in one room.

Proposition 2. The moratorium is a privilege with a price list. Societies grant pauses unevenly: the apprentice boy, the university-bound girl, the novice in the church; and deny them to the child who must earn at thirteen, marry at fifteen, or care for siblings at twelve. Where no moratorium exists, foreclosure is not a failure of exploration but an adaptation to necessity — and the counsellor who pathologises foreclosure in a child with no pause has blamed the child for the economy.

Proposition 3. Fidelity is the virtue, and fidelity is testable. Erikson's strength of this stage is the capacity for loyalty — to people, to causes, to a self-description held across pressure. The adolescent's fierce loyalties (to the group, the

faith, the friend, the team) are therefore not symptoms to moderate but the stage's product in formation; the work is widening the object of fidelity, not cooling the capacity.

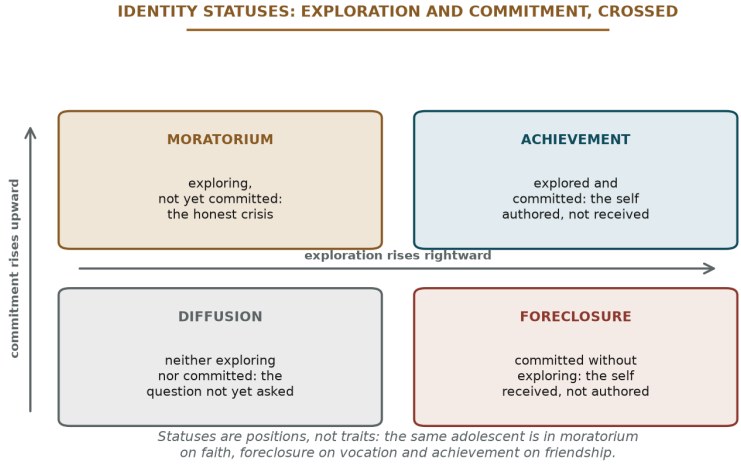


Figure 5.1 Marcia's identity statuses: exploration and commitment crossed, yielding moratorium, achievement, diffusion and foreclosure; positions within domains rather than traits of persons. After Marcia (1966). *Source:* prepared for this edition.

PRACTICE NOTE

Clinical implication. Map status in three domains per adolescent — vocation, faith or meaning, belonging — and write the domain beside each status. "Foreclosed" alone is an adjective; "foreclosed in vocation, moratorium in faith, achieved in belonging" is a formulation.

Lecture II — The identities that carry weight

Ethnic and racial identity develops through Phinney's sequence — unexamined, search, achieved — and under discrimination it carries a protective function: a achieved ethnic identity buffers the internalising cost of enacted and anticipated stigma, which is why the work with a discriminated-against adolescent includes the identity's pride strand and not only the wound strand. The counsellor across a difference they do not share does not claim the experience; they claim the obligation to know its shape: what the child is called, by whom, at what hour, and which adult in the building knows.

Religious identity in communities of faith is often the first available moratorium — the permitted doubt inside instruction — and the adolescent's religious questioning is frequently the safest form their identity work can take. Counsel that treats religious doubt as risk, or as compliance depending on the counsellor's

own position, has misread the domain; the clinical question is whether the doubt is explored (moratorium, healthy) or foreclosed in either direction by fear.

Sexual orientation and gender identity develop on diverse trajectories with no single sequence and no required disclosure; what the evidence supports firmly is the cost of rejection and the benefit of affirmation — family and school acceptance associate with markedly lower depression, self-harm and suicide risk among sexual- and gender-minority adolescents, and minority stress explains the elevated distress without recourse to any identity pathology. The counsellor's duties are ordered: safety first (who knows, and what happens to the child if others know), the child's own words and timetable for naming, accuracy about what care and community exist locally, and the family work that converts rejection into protection at the family's own pace — because the family is usually the child's only home.

Digital identity is not a separate identity but a new theatre for the same task: the curated self, the audience metrics, the permanence of the posted moment. The clinical grain is the gap between the curated self and the felt self — where the gap widens into shame, the theatre stops being rehearsal and becomes a mirror with a score (week 6).

> **SAFEGUARDING AND DUTY TO REPORT**
> Identity disclosures carry safety geometry: a sexual or gender disclosure in a session creates an immediate question — who else knows, and what happens at home if the wrong person learns it first? The counsellor's confidentiality sentence (week 14) is stated before disclosures are likely, not after; and where the child's safety requires a family conversation, the child is in the room for it, in their own words, at a time they help choose — except in the one limit where life governs and the rule is said plainly.

Lecture III — Interviewing identity

The textbook domain list is a prompt, not a questionnaire. The interviewing discipline has four moves. **Open in the child's registers:** "who are you, when you are most yourself?" — and follow the answer's vocabulary (football, choir, the market stall, the game clan) rather than translating it into domains. **Locate the commitments:** "what would you defend, even against your friends?" — fidelity's objects appear quickly and they are the self's load-bearing walls. **Locate the explorations:** "what are you still deciding about, that nobody is allowed to rush?" — the moratorium's contents, and the place the counselling can protect. **Locate the confiscations:** "what have you had to stop being, or hide, to stay safe or stay loved?" — the identity work that is not crisis but casualty, and usually the true referral beneath the referral.

The record carries the child's own words for each of the four, because identity formulations written in professional vocabulary are identity formulations about a stranger.

Worked example 5.1 — Ada's three domains

Task. Map Ada (14) in Marcia's statuses across vocation, meaning and belonging, from the semester's accumulating record, and name the governing strand.

Solution. *Belonging:* achieved until the senior-school move — choir, two named friends, a pew — and now under active loss: the choir left, one friend moved classes, the pew unchanged but "the looking" makes it hard to walk in; status slipping from achieved toward diffusion under attack, which is why the loss reads as bereavement rather than transition. *Meaning:* foreclosed-in-the-good-sense until this year (faith received and held), now quietly in moratorium — two questions in session about whether God "sees the looking too", which is exploration, not collapse, and is to be protected rather than answered. *Vocation:* diffusion, age-appropriate at fourteen, except that the household's economics make foreclosure likely within two years (trade apprenticeship assumed); the file notes the assumption as a future foreclosure to keep in view, not a present problem. Governing strand: belonging under attack, because its loss is recent, concrete and reachable — the choir's return on her terms (week 2′s formulation) and one friendship deliberately re-watered; the meaning moratorium is protected by not being rushed; the vocation question is diarised for SS3. The falsifier: if the belonging work succeeds and the low mood persists at six weeks, the governing strand was internalising all along and week 7′s assessment opens.

Worked example 5.2 — Kelvin's fidelity, widened

Task. Kelvin's loyalties are to his peer set — the same set whose evenings carry his risk. Counsel without demanding disloyalty.

Solution. The set is not a mistake to remove but the stage's product in formation: fidelity itself, attached to the only people who have reliably chosen him. An intervention that demands betrayal of them demands betrayal of the capacity his adulthood will run on. The work widens the object rather than cooling the capacity: (i) name the fidelity aloud and honour it — "you don't leave people; that is the best thing about you, and it is going to matter at thirty"; (ii) add objects rather than subtract them — the auntie's household as a loyalty he already carries but has never named as such, the repeating class as a debt to his own fourteen-year-old self who passed; (iii) give the fidelity a test it can pass without the set: the code-message leaving time reframed not as obedience but as keeping a promise to the auntie — "she waits up; your message lets her sleep; that is loyalty, not reporting"; (iv) protect the set-relationship from counselling's gossip: nothing about individual members is discussed with the family, so his trust in the room

does not become another betrayal. Review at eight weeks against one observable: messages sent, and one sentence from him about who else he is loyal to. The falsifier: if the set's evenings escalate to carrying (week 4's bag rule broken twice), the widening has failed and the conversation turns to exit with face — a route out that lets him leave without disloyalty, which exists in every set and must be found with him, not for him.

SKILLS LABORATORY

Practical 5 — the identity interview. In pairs, conduct the four-move interview on a supplied adolescent transcript or a peer in role: most-self register, commitments, explorations, confiscations. Record four verbatim sentences. Then write the three-domain status map with domains named, and one sentence naming the governing strand. 300 words plus the four quotations. The mark is for the child's words surviving into the map.

ASSESSMENT

Assessed task. An identity-status interview record: your four verbatim quotations, the three-domain map, the governing strand with its falsifier, and 400 words on which moratorium this adolescent is and is not granted, by whom, and what your service can do about the denial.

Criterion	Weight
Child's words verbatim in all four moves	30%
Statuses mapped per domain, not globally	25%
Governing strand argued with falsifier	25%
Moratorium audit structural, not sentimental	20%

Formative. Write your own adolescent identity in one sentence of each move — and note which move was hardest to answer. That is the move your clients will hide.

UNIT SYNTHESIS

Synthesis. Identity is the assembly of a self that can keep promises; its crisis requires a moratorium that societies grant unevenly, so foreclosure is often economics rather than failure; Marcia's statuses map it finely enough to counsel with; ethnic, religious, sexual, gendered and digital identities carry the weight and the risk, with minority stress relocating distress from the child to the environment and affirmation carrying the evidence; and the interview that reaches any of it runs in the child's registers — most-self, commitments, explorations, confiscations — with their words kept verbatim into the file.

READING (APA 7TH)

- Erikson, E. H. (1968). *Identity: Youth and crisis*. W. W. Norton.
- Marcia, J. E. (1966). Development and validation of ego-identity status. *Journal of Personality and Social Psychology, 3*(5), 551–558.
- Phinney, J. S. (1990). Ethnic identity in adolescents and adults: Review of research. *Psychological Bulletin, 108*(3), 499–514.
- Steinberg, L. (2014). *Age of opportunity: Lessons from the new science of adolescence*. Houghton Mifflin Harcourt. — **core text**; the identity chapter.
- Patton, G. C., Sawyer, S. M., Santelli, J. S., Ross, D. A., Afifi, R., Allen, N. B., Arora, M., Azzopardi, P., Baldwin, W., Bonell, C., Kakuma, R., Kennedy, E., Mahon, J., McGovern, T., Mokdad, A. H., Patel, V., Petroni, S., Reavley, N., Taiwo, K., ... Viner, R. M. (2016). Our future: A *Lancet* commission on adolescent health and wellbeing. *The Lancet, 387*(10036), 2423–2478.

Seminar questions

1. Which moratorium were you granted at fifteen, and who paid for it?
2. Foreclosure in a child with no pause: why is "identity foreclosed" the wrong adjective, and what is the right sentence?
3. Minority stress relocates distress to the environment. What does that make the counsellor's client list?
4. An adolescent's religious doubt is exploration. What would tell you it was fear instead, in either direction?
5. The confiscation question usually finds the true referral. What will you do with the answer when it names an adult in the building?

Next week

Week 6 follows the ideal into the self's mirror: esteem trajectories, body image, and the comparison machine that scores the adolescent against strangers all day.

6 LECTURE UNIT 6 Teaching week 6 4 notional hours

Self, Esteem and the Body Under the Comparison Machine

LEARNING OUTCOMES

By the end of this week you will be able to:

1. **Describe** self-concept differentiation in adolescence and the self-esteem trajectory with its early-adolescent dip and its gender gap.
2. **Explain** the comparison machine: social comparison, curated feeds and audience metrics as a developmental instrument turned hostile, and name what it measures and what it cannot.

3. **Assess** body-image difficulty and its gradients, distinguishing normative dissatisfaction from clinical presentation, and locate the eating-disorder red flags.
4. **Counsel** with esteem's two levers — competence in valued domains and relationship that does not score — rather than with praise that inflates and then collapses.
5. **Design** one household or school change that reduces metric exposure without confiscation battles.

Where this week sits

Week 4 gave the adolescent the ideal; week 5 gave the ideal a name — identity. This week asks what happens when the ideal is aimed at the self: the self-concept splits into selves for each audience, esteem dips as the mirrors multiply, the body becomes the most public and most scored of all the selves, and a machine arrives — the feed — that industrialises comparison at a scale no previous adolescence met. The counsellor's work is to restore the two levers esteem actually runs on, and to disarm the machine without confiscating the phone, because the phone is also the child's village.

Key concepts

SELF-CONCEPT DIFFERENTIATION
The adolescent's discovery that they are different selves in different relationships — with mother, with peers, with the teacher, online — and the early distress of the inconsistencies ("which one is me?"). Integration across audiences is the task; fragmentation under incompatible audiences is the risk. In the room: the sentence beneath "they don't know the real me" — sometimes true, sometimes the true me not yet assembled.

ESTEEM DIP
Self-esteem falls for many children in the early-adolescent transition — new school, new mirrors, puberty's timing — and recovers across the teens; the dip is deeper on average for girls, and the gap tracks bodies, audiences and domains valued rather than any difference in worth. In the room: the pattern, not the level, is the finding — a low level that is stable is a different formulation from a falling one.

COMPARISON MACHINE
The industrialisation of social comparison: curated selves, algorithmic feeds, and countable audiences (likes, views, streaks) that convert the imaginary audience of week 4 into a dashboard. The machine measures engagement, not worth; but the adolescent's developing system reads the dashboard as the audience's verdict, hour

by hour. In the room: why the two-a-morning loop now arrives with numbers attached.

ESTEEM LEVERS

The two processes that actually build esteem: competence in domains the adolescent values (not the domains adults value), and relationships that do not score — being known and held without metric. Praise that inflates ("you are the best") collapses at the first comparison; praise that describes effort and specific competence survives, and relationship outlasts both. In the room: the counsel to parents who have been feeding the machine with scores.

Lecture I — The differentiated self and its dip

Proposition 1. Differentiation precedes integration and costs distress. The child's unitary self-concept splits in early adolescence into audience-relative selves; the inconsistencies are felt as falseness until integration arrives later in the teens. Where audiences are compatible the integration is ordinary; where they are hostile to each other — the home self and the peer self that cannot meet, the faith self and the online self — the adolescent carries incompatible selves and the cost is shame or exhaustion, not confusion alone.

Proposition 2. The dip is contextual and the gap is meaningful. The early-adolescent esteem dip tracks the transition's new mirrors; its greater depth for girls tracks which bodies and behaviours the mirrors score, and the domains in which girls' competence is publicly valued. The pattern-level finding counsels against panic at a single low score and for attention to a falling trajectory across two terms.

Proposition 3. Domains are weighted by the child, not by the adult. Esteem is domain-specific and weighted by personal importance: a girl whose esteem rests on choir and friendship loses more in the choir's collapse than any report card can restore. Assessment therefore maps the child's own domain weights before any intervention, because an intervention in an unweighted domain is an intervention in a stranger's self.

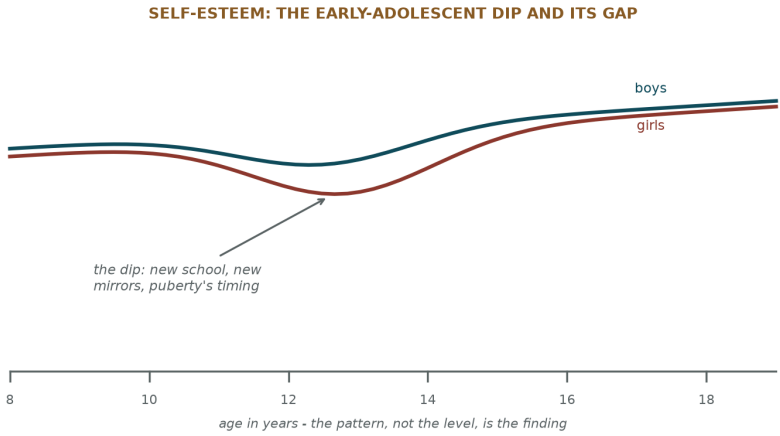


Figure 6.1 Self-esteem trajectories by gender across ages 8-18: the early-adolescent dip and its gender gap; the pattern, not the level, is the finding. *Source:* prepared for this edition, schematic of the cohort pattern.

PRACTICE NOTE

Clinical implication. Map the adolescent's esteem domains and weights in their own words — "what would hurt most to lose?" — before any esteem work. The list is the self's load-bearing wall schedule.

Lecture II — The comparison machine, precisely

The machine has three parts and each has a different intervention. **Curation:** the feed presents idealised selves — filtered bodies, staged moments, selected successes — as ordinary life; the adolescent compares their interior with others' exteriors, which is a comparison no human can win. Intervention is literacy, not confiscation: the feed deconstructed item by item in session ("who took this? how many were deleted? what was happening one minute later?"), because a deconstructed image loses its verdict-power. **Metrics:** counts convert the week-4 imaginary audience into a dashboard with numbers; the numbers measure engagement and algorithmic timing, not worth, but the developing system reads verdict. Intervention is architectural: notifications off during homework and after a set hour, the counts hidden where the platform allows, and one metric-free zone daily — the meal, the choir, the pitch — where no audience exists because no device does. **Algorithm:** the feed optimises for engagement and therefore for emotion, and negative comparison is engaging; the adolescent experiences the algorithm's business model as their own unworthiness. Intervention is the sentence that relocates the cause: "you are not the problem the feed found; you are the product it is selling attention around" — which, said once with evidence, is durable in adolescents

because it recruits their formal-operational critique (week 4) on the machine's behalf rather than their own.

The machine is not only harm: it is also the village — the diaspora cousin, the choir group, the study thread, the identity community a small town cannot supply. Confiscation removes the village with the verdict; the work is architecture that keeps the village and starves the dashboard.

Lecture III — The body: normative dissatisfaction and its red flags

Body dissatisfaction in adolescence is normative in the statistical sense and harmful in the developmental one: most adolescents, girls markedly more, report wishing something about their body different, and the dissatisfaction tracks the mirrors rather than the body. The clinical line is not dissatisfaction versus none but **grip**: dissatisfaction that organises the day — food restriction, avoided rooms, abandoned sport, the deleted photograph, the refused assembly — has grip, and grip is the referral criterion.

The red flags that end waiting: restriction with weight loss or growth faltering; purging or compensatory exercise; the adolescent who will not eat in company; exercise that continues through injury and fever; and, in boys, the muscularity-directed variant — the protein powders, the mirror hours, the rage at missed sessions — which is under-recognised because it wears the costume of discipline. Comorbidity is the rule: body grip with depression, with perfectionism, with the trauma history that makes the body a scene rather than a self.

The counsel to families runs on the two levers and three prohibitions: no commentary on anyone's body in the house, including the parents' own; no weighing as punishment or reward; no food policing at the table — the table is relationship, and relationship is the lever that outlasts the others. Where grip is present, the referral pathway of week 13 opens with medical review first, because eating difficulty is the one adolescent presentation where the body's state can outrun the counselling.

> **SAFEGUARDING AND DUTY TO REPORT**
> Body and feed material carries two safeguarding edges: image-based abuse — the shared intimate image, the edited humiliation — is conduct by others with legal edges, and the child is a victim whatever the image's origin; and pro-harm communities (restriction, self-harm techniques) recruit through the same feeds, so a feed audit is part of assessment where grip or self-harm is present, conducted with the adolescent's collaboration rather than by seizure, because a seized phone is a lost village and a lost disclosure route.

Worked example 6.1 — Ada's domain weights and the choir

Task. Map Ada's esteem domains, locate the machine's contribution, and write the two-lever plan.

Solution. Weights, in her words: choir ("where I am my voice"), friendship ("Blessing only"), school ("I am average and it is fine"), home ("I am the quiet one"). The load-bearing walls are choir and one friendship — and both are currently damaged: the choir by the looking (week 2), the friendship by class separation and Ada's withdrawal. The machine's contribution, audited with her: an hour nightly on a feed of choir pages and school confession pages; the counts watched, not posted — she is a reader, not a poster, and the reader's injury is comparison without the village's reply. Plan, two levers: competence — the choir's return engineered on her terms (entry from the back, one named friend beside her, the solo declined this term and accepted next, her choosing); relationship — Blessing re-watered by one standing weekly errand together at the market, the auntie's household named aloud as a wall ("you are the quiet one **here**; here you are also the one Bisi calls first"). Machine architecture, without confiscation: the confession pages unfollowed together in session (she laughs at the third one — the deconstruction working), notifications off after nine, and the market errand as the daily metric-free zone. Falsifier, dated: if at six weeks the choir has returned and the mood has not moved, the governing strand is internalising (week 7) and the formulation reorders; if the feed audit finds pro-harm communities, week 13 opens the same week.

Worked example 6.2 — The father's scores

Task. Kelvin's late father's brother visits monthly and ranks the boys' results aloud at the family meal. Kelvin's esteem in school domains is low and falling; he has stopped bringing books home. Counsel the household.

Solution. The ranking is the machine in its oldest form: a metric, delivered publicly, by a person the child loves and cannot answer. Three moves with the household, the uncle present. First, honour the intention and name the mechanism: "You rank them because you want them to rise. The ranking does the opposite — it teaches Kelvin that school is a place where he is read aloud and found small, so he has stopped bringing the evidence home." Second, replace the metric with the two levers: competence in a domain Kelvin weights — the goalkeeper's return of week 2 is now the family's public pride, announced at the meal in the ranking's old slot, so the ritual's force is recruited rather than fought; and relationship without score — one monthly walk with the uncle in which results are forbidden and football talk is mandatory, because the boy needs the man more than the man's table needs the numbers. Third, the prohibition stated once and kindly: no child's result read aloud in this house again; results are the

child's to tell, in their own time, to whom they choose. The falsifier is behavioural and dated: books home, or not, within four weeks; and one sentence from Kelvin about the walk, which is the lever that will still be working at twenty-five.

SKILLS LABORATORY

Practical 6 — the feed audit, collaborative. With a supplied case record or role-play: conduct a collaborative feed audit — what is followed, what is watched, what is posted, which hours, which communities; deconstruct two curated items item-by-item in session language; and write the architecture plan (notifications, counts, metric-free zone, village preserved). 300 words. The mark is for the village surviving the architecture.

ASSESSMENT

Assessed task. A self-concept map and machine plan of 1,000 words: domain weights in the child's words, esteem trajectory (level versus pattern), the machine's three parts audited with an intervention each, the body grip assessment with red flags checked, and the two-lever plan with a dated falsifier.

Criterion	Weight
Domains and weights in the child's words	25%
Trajectory read as pattern; gap explained contextually	20%
Machine audited in three parts, village preserved	25%
Body grip assessed, red flags checked	15%
Two-lever plan concrete with falsifier	15%

Formative. Write the one sentence you would say to a parent who posts their child's results and photographs publicly, and loves them.

UNIT SYNTHESIS

Synthesis. The adolescent self differentiates into audience-relative selves whose integration is the task; esteem dips in the early transition with a gender gap that tracks mirrors and valued domains; the comparison machine industrialises the imaginary audience into a dashboard that measures engagement and is read as verdict; body dissatisfaction becomes clinical at grip, with red flags that end waiting; and esteem is rebuilt on its two levers — competence in the child's valued domains and relationship that does not score — with architecture that starves the dashboard while keeping the village.

READING (APA 7TH)

- Harter, S. (1999). *The construction of the self: A developmental perspective*. Guilford Press.
- Odgers, C. L., & Jensen, M. R. (2020). Annual Research Review: Adolescent mental health in the digital age: Facts, fears, and future directions. *Journal of Child Psychology and Psychiatry, 61*(3), 336–352.
- Rosenberg, M. (1965). *Society and the adolescent self-image*. Princeton University Press.
- Steinberg, L. (2014). *Age of opportunity: Lessons from the new science of adolescence*. Houghton Mifflin Harcourt. — **core text**; the self chapters.

Seminar questions

1. Which audience-relative self of your own adolescence could never meet the others, and what did the incompatibility cost?
2. The machine is also the village. Where is the line in an architecture plan, and who draws it — you or the adolescent?
3. Body dissatisfaction is normative and harmful. How do you say both sentences to a parent without cancelling either?
4. Praise that inflates collapses at the first comparison. Write one inflating sentence and its describing replacement.
5. What does your service score, publicly, that it should stop?

Next week

Week 7 follows the self into feeling: the internalising gap, emotion regulation under new weather, and the conversations about self-harm and suicide that save lives when they are had plainly.

7 LECTURE UNIT 7 Teaching week 7 4 notional hours

Emotion, Internalising, and the Conversations That Save Lives

LEARNING OUTCOMES

By the end of this week you will be able to:

1. **Explain** the internalising gap — depression's and anxiety's emergence and gender divergence in adolescence — as timing, weather and treatment of weather rather than as weakness.
2. **Describe** adolescent emotion regulation: the intensities of week 3's weather with its regulatory instrument still under construction, and the strategies that are adaptive in adolescence.

3. **Assess** depression, anxiety presentations, and self-harm function in an adolescent, distinguishing normative intensity from clinical presentation and naming the red flags.
4. **Conduct** the risk conversation: asking about suicide directly, in plain language, without planting and without flinching, and documenting what is done with the answer.
5. **Build** a safety plan with an adolescent that they can use at two in the morning, and know the limits of your role.

Where this week sits

Adolescence's most consequential clinical event is the first internalising episode: the majority of lifetime depression and anxiety disorders begin before adulthood, and adolescence is their peak onset window. This week supplies the epidemiology, the regulation science, the assessment and — the reason the week exists — the conversations: the direct risk question, the function-seeking inquiry about self-harm, the safety plan built with rather than for the adolescent, and the family sentences that turn a household from an audience into a support. These are the most teachable hours in the programme, because they are the ones most often not had.

Key concepts

INTERNALISING GAP
The epidemiological fact of adolescence: depression and anxiety emerge and rise sharply from early adolescence, and from that point prevalence is roughly twice as high among girls as boys — a gap that opens at puberty and tracks timing (earlier transitions), weather (rumination, co-rumination), body scoring and treatment of distress rather than any difference in capacity to feel. In the room: why week 3's storm matters clinically, not just developmentally.

RUMINATION
The repetitive, passive focus on distress and its causes and consequences — the style that converts weather into climate, predicted by adolescence's new capacity for sustained self-focus; it is more common among adolescent girls and is a robust predictor of depression's onset and persistence. In the room: the two-a-morning loop of week 3, and the one habit that most reliably converts a bad month into a disorder.

SELF-HARM FUNCTION
Non-suicidal self-injury's usual functions: regulation of unbearable feeling, punishment of a hated self, communication to an audience, or escape from numbness —

functions assessed by asking, not assumed; distinct from suicidal behaviour in intent while sharing risk, with a history of self-harm among the strongest single predictors of later suicide. In the room: the question that turns a scar from a scandal into a symptom with a grammar.

DIRECT RISK QUESTION
Asking about suicide plainly and without euphemism — "have you thought about killing yourself?" — which does not plant the idea (evidence consistently finds asking is safe and often relieving) and is the only reliable way to assess it. In the room: the sentence counsellors most fear and that saves the most lives; its absence, not its presence, is the risk.

Lecture I — The gap: what opens, when, and why

Proposition 1. Adolescence is the onset window. The bulk of lifetime depression and anxiety disorders have their first episode before adulthood, with incidence rising steeply from about the early teens; the disorders that will define many adult lives arrive while the brain is still assembling its brakes. This is the clinical sentence behind week 3′s construction site: the instrument is plastic, and plastic cuts both ways — it is the window of opportunity and of vulnerability.

Proposition 2. The gap opens at puberty and its causes are social-developmental, not intrinsic. From early adolescence, girls' rates of depression and anxiety run roughly twice boys'. The tracks: earlier and more off-timed transitions (week 2′s meaning machinery); rumination and co-rumination styles that convert weather into climate; the body's new public scoring (week 6); and a treatment of distress — in girls, talk and analysis; in boys, distraction and suppression — in which the first two can deepen the hole before they drain it. Boys' internalising is under-detected rather than absent: it presents as anger, conduct, substance and absence, and is recorded in other people's categories.

Proposition 3. Comorbidity and masking are the rule. Internalising rarely travels alone: anxiety and depression overlap heavily with each other, with trauma reactions, with the sleep debt of week 3, and — in boys especially — with conduct presentations that mask it. The assessment therefore never stops at the presenting register; it asks what lives underneath anger, absence and achievement alike.

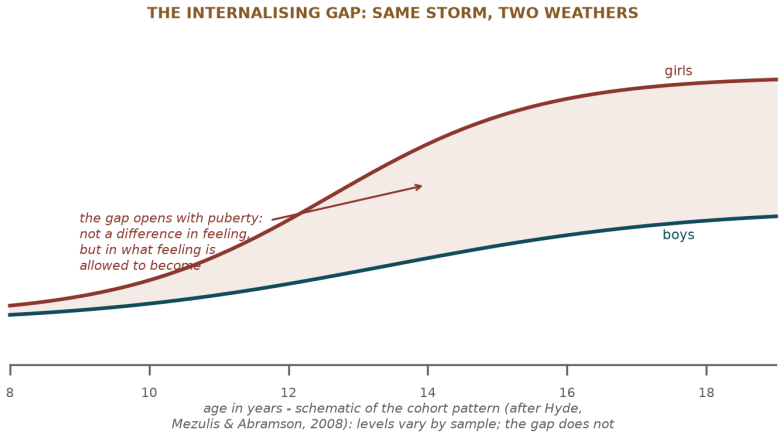


Figure 7.1 The internalising gap: schematic trajectories of girls' and boys' distress from age 8 to 18, the gap opening at puberty. *Source:* prepared for this edition, schematic of the cohort pattern (after Hyde, Mezulis & Abramson, 2008).

PRACTICE NOTE

Clinical implication. In every adolescent assessment, ask the internalising questions underneath the presenting category — including in the angry boy and the high-achieving girl, whose presentations are the two the gap hides best.

Lecture II — Regulation, and what helps

Regulation in adolescence runs on three instruments at unequal maturity: the behavioural repertoire learned in childhood (distraction, seeking, problem-solving), the new but still-developing cognitive instrument of week 3 (reframing, reappraisal, perspective-taking), and the peer instrument — co-regulation, which adolescents use more than children or adults and which is powerful in both directions: co-rumination deepens, co-action and companionship relieve.

What helps, in order of leverage: *sleep first* — the debt of week 3 is not background; irregular and short sleep predicts and maintains adolescent depression, and no regulation strategy works well on a sleep-deprived brain. *Behavioural activation* — the scheduled, valued, mastery-or-connection-bearing activities that depression cancels first and recovery needs first; in adolescence the schedule must recruit the domains the child weights (week 6), not the domains the adult would choose. *Rumination interruption* — the loop broken by doing rather than by arguing: movement, company, a task with hands; argued-against rumination becomes more rumination. *Cognitive work with the new instrument* — the divergence-point analysis of week 4 (what actually happened, what the loop added) now works because formal operations has arrived; before that it is consolation,

after it, it is a tool. *The relationships that do not score* — week 6′s second lever, which in depression is the load-bearing wall: one adult who knows, one peer who stays.

What does not help: advice-giving in the first ten minutes; minimising ("at your age, what is there to be sad about?" — which teaches the child the weather is a verdict); the interrogation of the loop rather than its interruption; and, above all, waiting for it to pass because adolescence is a storm. Some storms are weather; this week exists to teach which are climate.

Lecture III — The conversations

The risk conversation, directly. Ask plainly, without euphemism, in the adolescent's own language once you have it: "when it is at its worst, do you ever think about killing yourself?" Asking does not plant the idea — the evidence is consistent that direct asking is safe and is often met with relief that the question was finally asked. Then assess in the order of lethality: thoughts (how often, how long, how controllable), plans (how specific, how available the means), intent (what stops you — and the answer to "what stops you" is the protective list the safety plan is built from), and history (previous attempts, self-harm, family suicide — the strongest predictors). The answer is documented in the record plainly: what was asked, what was said, what was done. The limit of your role is stated in the service's escalation policy and to the child before it is needed: life governs the room; if the answer requires it, other adults will be involved, how and when will be told to the child first, and the child is never handed over like an object — they are accompanied.

The self-harm conversation, function-seeking. "Tell me what it does for you" — asked without shock, after the wound is cared for. Function governs intervention: regulation gets the interruption repertoire and the sleep work; punishment gets the self-relationship work of week 6′s levers; communication gets the family conversation the behaviour has been standing in for; escape from numbness gets the trauma assessment of week 13 beneath it. Means restriction is discussed with the household in language that does not shame the child: it is not confiscation of trust but the same principle as the bag on the windowsill in week 4 — heat needs friction removed, and the household removes it together with the child knowing.

The safety plan, built with. The adolescent's own plan, in their own words, on a card in their pocket: the early signs (theirs — "when the music stops sounding like anything"); the things that work alone (the loop-breakers: the walk, the cold water, the drill of a song); the people to contact in order (peer, adult, service) with numbers written, not remembered; and the professional contacts including the crisis line, with the one sentence rehearsed aloud in session so that using it at two in

the morning is not a first draft. The plan is reviewed and rewritten as the weather changes; a plan that is never revised was never used.

> **SAFEGUARDING AND DUTY TO REPORT**
> Where risk is present the record carries: the direct question asked and the answer given; the lethality assessment; the means-restriction conversation and with whom; the safety plan and its review date; the escalation performed and to whom; and the child's knowledge of every step. Where the child is at imminent risk, they are not left alone and the escalation is immediate — the accompaniment principle: the child goes with an adult, not to one.

Worked example 7.1 — The question Ada has been waiting for

Task. Ada's file now carries: six weeks of low mood, the choir loss, sleep to two a.m., one friend remaining, and — disclosed today, quietly, without being asked — "some nights I think it would be easier not to be here." Conduct and document the risk conversation.

Solution. *The direct question, in her language:* "When you think it would be easier not to be here — have you thought about killing yourself?" Answer: yes, sometimes, at night; "I would not do it to Bisi" — the protective list arrives in one name, and the plan will be built on it. *Lethality assessment:* thoughts present most nights, controllable "until about two"; no plan ("I have not thought about how"); no intent (Bisi; also, "I want to see SS3"); no attempts; no self-harm history; no family history known — to be checked with the auntie this week, framed as health history. *Function of the nights:* rumination + sleep debt + the looking (week 2) + two losses; the formulation writes climate-on-weather, and the intervention order is sleep first, choir restoration, Blessing re-watered, rumination interruption for the two-a.m. slot (the cold-water walk to the kitchen she already uses — named, scheduled, and the light left on for her). *Safety plan, with her, in her words:* signs ("when the music stops"); alone ("water, kitchen, sing anything quietly"); order ("Blessing first — but at two a.m. she sleeps — so Auntie Bisi, and the card has the service number"); rehearsed sentence said aloud twice in session. *Accompaniment:* the auntie is told this week — with Ada in the room, Ada's words used first ("she told me herself; this is what she said"), means conversation gentle (nothing to restrict; medicines locked as ordinary household practice, said as ordinary), and Ada's knowledge of every step recorded. *Documentation:* question asked, answer given, lethality assessed, plan built, review date in two weeks, auntie informed with Ada present. Falsifier: at two weeks, the nights are counted — if the two-a.m. slot has moved to four a.m., the plan is revised and escalation reviewed; if thoughts persist at six weeks despite sleep and restoration work, week 13 opens the clinical pathway with medical review.

Worked example 7.2 — Kelvin's scar and its grammar

Task. Kelvin, 16, shows the counsellor two healed cuts on his forearm: "everybody does it." Assess function; intervene without scandal.

Solution. *Function-seeking, after care and without shock:* "Tell me what it does for you." Answer, eventually: "when the heat is too much, it is something to do with it" — regulation; plus a communication edge: "at least somebody asks about this." The grammar is now known: unbearable feeling with no repertoire, and a household where distress is not spoken. *Intervention, function by function:* regulation — the interruption repertoire built with him from what already works (the pitch, the walk home the long way, cold water, drill — chosen by him, written on the card); sleep and substance audit (week 3's debt and the evenings of week 4 both raise the heat); communication — the family conversation the cuts have been standing in for, prepared in session and held with the auntie present, Kelvin's words first; and the self-relationship lever — one adult in the house who now knows, so the function "somebody asks" is met by a person rather than a wound. *Means:* discussed with the household plainly, without shaming him — the razor is not hunted but the household agrees to the ordinary: medicines and blades stored as stored, and the sentence said to Kelvin aloud: "this is not because we do not trust you; it is because heat needs friction removed, and we are removing it together." *Documentation and limits:* function assessed, plan built with review date, auntie informed with Kelvin present, no current suicidal intent reported — the direct question still asked, and its answer recorded, because "everybody does it" is a sentence that has covered both. Falsifier: fresh marks within eight weeks reopen the assessment at medical review; the plan's use — one card sentence Kelvin repeats back unprompted — is the sign it is working.

SKILLS LABORATORY

Practical 7 — the risk conversation, rehearsed. In triads, rehearse on the supplied transcripts until the sentences are fluent: the direct question in the adolescent's language; the lethality sequence (thoughts, plan, intent, history); "what stops you" and building the plan's first line from the answer; the function question after a self-harm disclosure; and the accompaniment sentence to the family. Each counsellor rotates through all three roles. 400-word record of the rehearsal with the sentences you would keep verbatim. The mark is for fluency under the adolescent's silence and the family's panic — the two conditions under which unpractised counsellors lose the sentence.

ASSESSMENT

Assessed task. A risk conversation record and safety plan of 1,200 words from a supplied case: the direct question and its documentation; lethality assessment in

order; the function-seeking inquiry; the safety plan in the adolescent's words with the rehearsed sentence; the family/accompaniment steps with the child's knowledge of each; and 300 words on the internalising gap's meaning for your service's intake questions.

Criterion	Weight
Direct question asked plainly, documented	25%
Lethality sequence complete and ordered	20%
Function assessed by asking, not assumed	15%
Safety plan in the adolescent's words, rehearsed	20%
Accompaniment and family steps, child informed	10%
Gap applied to service intake	10%

Formative. Write the one sentence you would use to open the risk question with a fifteen-year-old who has just said "it would be easier not to be here". Read it aloud. Revise it until it does not flinch.

UNIT SYNTHESIS

Synthesis. Adolescence is internalising's onset window: the gap opens at puberty and tracks timing, rumination, body scoring and treatment of distress, while boys' internalising hides in other people's categories; regulation runs on instruments of unequal maturity with sleep as the first lever and rumination interruption by doing rather than arguing; self-harm has a grammar whose functions are assessed by asking; and the conversations that save lives are the direct risk question, the function-seeking inquiry, the safety plan built with the adolescent in their words, and the accompaniment that informs the child of every step — documented plainly, rehearsed until fluent, and reviewed until the weather passes.

READING (APA 7TH)

- Hyde, J. S., Mezulis, A. H., & Abramson, L. Y. (2008). The ABCs of depression: Integrating affective, biological, and cognitive models to explain the emergence of the gender difference in depression. *Psychological Review, 115*(2), 291–313.
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- Nolen-Hoeksema, S. (2001). Gender differences in depression. *Current Directions in Psychological Science, 10*(5), 173–176.
- Patton, G. C., Sawyer, S. M., Santelli, J. S., Ross, D. A., Afifi, R., Allen, N. B., Arora, M., Azzopardi, P., Baldwin, W., Bonell, C., Kakuma, R., Kennedy, E., Mahon, J., McGovern, T., Mokdad, A. H., Patel, V., Petroni, S., Reavley, N.,

Taiwo, K., … Viner, R. M. (2016). Our future: A *Lancet* commission on adolescent health and wellbeing. *The Lancet, 387*(10036), 2423–2478.
- Steinberg, L. (2014). *Age of opportunity: Lessons from the new science of adolescence*. Houghton Mifflin Harcourt. — **core text**; the emotional-health chapters.

Seminar questions

1. Why is the absence of the direct question a greater risk than its presence? What makes counsellors fear it?
2. "What stops you" is the safety plan's first line. Whose name would have stopped you at fifteen, and what does that tell you about building plans?
3. Boys' internalising hides in anger and absence. Which intake question of your service would miss it?
4. Means restriction without shame: what exactly does the household say, and to whom first?
5. A safety plan never revised was never used. How will you know yours was?

Next week

Week 8 turns to the adolescent's first institutions: the family under renegotiation, autonomy and conflict's changed shape, and the counsellor's place at a table where everyone is right.

8 LECTURE UNIT 8 Teaching week 8 4 notional hours

The Family Under Renegotiation: Autonomy, Conflict and Connectedness

LEARNING OUTCOMES

By the end of this week you will be able to:

1. **Explain** the adolescent family transition as renegotiation rather than separation: autonomy and connectedness rising together, with individuation as the healthy form.
2. **Apply** the domain model of conflict — moral, conventional, prudential, personal — and use jurisdiction as a lever in family sessions.
3. **Describe** parenting styles and the developmental evidence for authoritative parenting, including the cultural qualifications, and counsel a household toward it without importing a foreign family.
4. **Conduct** a first family session with an adolescent present: seating, speaking order, the jurisdictional reframe, and the one agreement that survives the room.

5. **Recognise** the family presentations that end counselling-as-usual: maltreatment, loss, separation, parental illness, displacement, and household economies under strain.

Where this week sits

The adolescent does not develop inside a skull; they develop inside a household under renegotiation. This week takes the family from week 1′s widening gap — where it was an object of study — and makes it the room's second client: autonomy's real shape, conflict's changed grammar and its jurisdictional levers, parenting's evidence and its cultural qualifications, and the first-session discipline that lets an adolescent be present in their own family's counselling without becoming the exhibit. It closes the developmental half of the semester; weeks 9 to 12 widen outward to peers, aspirations, risk and culture, and weeks 13 to 16 gather everything into clinical practice.

Key concepts

RENEGOTIATION NOT SEPARATION
The correction to detachment theories: healthy adolescent development raises autonomy and connectedness together — individuation — rather than trading one for the other; the adolescent who separates completely has not individuated but withdrawn, and the household that permits no autonomy has not preserved connection but frozen it. In the room: the question that is never "how to let go" but "how to renegotiate".

DOMAIN MODEL
Smetana's finding that adolescents and parents agree on the legitimacy of parental authority in moral, conventional and prudential domains and dispute the personal domain — and that conflict concentrates exactly there: hair, room, music, messages, friends' names. Jurisdiction, once located, is the lever: most family conflict is not about values but about whose question it is. In the room: the map that turns a shouting match into a negotiation with an agenda.

AUTHORITATIVE PARENTING
High warmth and high demand: responsiveness with standards — the style associated across many samples with the best adolescent outcomes (competence, lower risk behaviour, better mental health), with cultural qualifications: in some communities higher directiveness carries the same warmth and the same outcomes, and "demandingness without warmth" (authoritarian) is the reliable risk, not structure as such.

In the room: the household's two dials, and the sentence that structure is not the enemy — coldness is.

CONNECTEDNESS AS PROTECTION

Family connectedness — being known, counted on, and mattering to the household — is among the strongest protective factors in adolescent mental health and risk behaviour, stronger than monitoring tactics and surviving conflict; conflict in a connected household is renegotiation, while conflict in a disconnected one is erosion. In the room: the variable to protect first, before any behavioural program.

Lecture I — Autonomy's real shape

Proposition 1. Individuation, not detachment. The separation-individuation tradition (Blos) captured a real process — the adolescent's second individuation, working through the childhood internal objects — but the detachment reading of it was wrong: the evidence shows emotional autonomy (de-idealising the parents, deciding for oneself) rising **with** connectedness, not instead of it. The adolescent who cannot argue with a parent has not become independent; they have given up on being known.

Proposition 2. Autonomy is three things and develops at three speeds. *Emotional* autonomy (the parents seen as people), *behavioural* autonomy (decisions made and owned), and *cognitive* autonomy (opinions formed and defended) — with behavioural autonomy's pace set culturally and economically as much as developmentally: the fourteen-year-old running a market stall carries decisional authority her university-bound cousin will not hold for eight years. The counsellor assesses all three separately, because the household usually grants or refuses them in bundles that no one has chosen.

Proposition 3. Monitoring works through knowledge, and knowledge through willingness. The parental-knowledge finding: what protects adolescents is not surveillance but parents' actual knowledge of the child's whereabouts, company and activities — and most of that knowledge is supplied voluntarily by the child, in households where telling is safe. Surveillance that damages connectedness destroys the supply of the very information it seeks; the code-message of week 4 works because it is a willing transmission, not a tracked one.

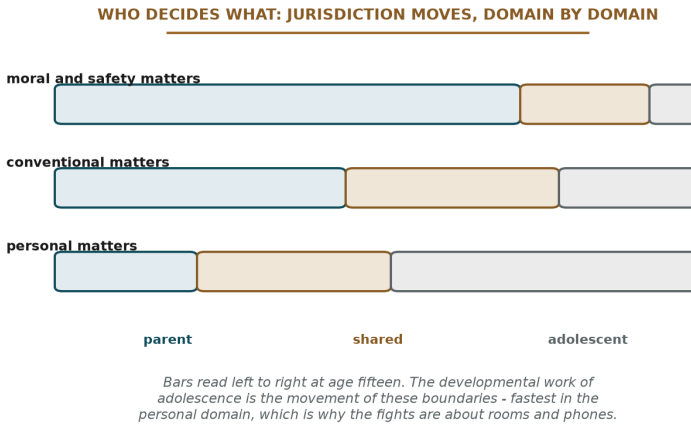


Figure 8.1 Family jurisdictions: moral, conventional, prudential and personal domains with authority concentrated in the first three and conflict concentrated in the fourth. After Smetana. *Source:* prepared for this edition.

PRACTICE NOTE

Clinical implication. In every family case, assess the three autonomies separately and ask where the child's knowledge-supply has stopped: what has the adolescent stopped telling, and what happened the last time they told?

Lecture II — Conflict's grammar and the jurisdictional lever

Adolescent-parent conflict rises in frequency in early adolescence, peaks in the early-to-mid teens, declines thereafter — and stays mild in most families: the "storm" reading of conflict was another exaggeration (week 1), though the rise is real and its timing tracks the domain dispute. The grammar: conflict concentrates in the **personal domain** — the body, the room, the music, the messages, the friends' names — because that is where the adolescent's jurisdiction claim has outrun the household's grant. Moral questions (harm, fairness) are not disputed; conventional questions (manners, respect forms) are disputed but negotiable; prudential questions (safety: the ride, the hour, the water) are disputed fiercely and conceded slowly, and **should** be, because they concern life.

The jurisdictional lever, in session: locate each disputed item's domain aloud, with the family, and negotiate the grant explicitly — the personal domain's items transferred on a schedule with a review, the prudential items kept with reasons stated in the language of protection rather than control, and the conventional items traded. "Whose question is this?" asked once, calmly, in a family session,

does more than an hour of communication-skills coaching, because it converts a values war into a boundary negotiation in which both parties can win.

The evidence qualifications, stated honestly: conflict frequency is a weak predictor of adjustment; conflict **quality** — hostility, contempt, withdrawal, unrepairable rupture — predicts; and repair predicts better than either, because the household that repairs teaches the adolescent that rupture is survivable, which is the single most transferable lesson of family life.

Lecture III — Parenting's evidence, its cultures, and its casualties

The two dials. Warmth/responsiveness and demandingness/structure crossed: authoritative (high-high) associates with the best adolescent outcomes across many samples; authoritarian (low warmth, high demand) with compliance and with internalising distress and covert behaviour; permissive (high warmth, low demand) with poorer self-regulation; neglectful (low-low) with the worst outcomes of all. The cultural qualification matters and is not decorative: directiveness carries different meanings in different communities — in many African, Asian and diaspora households, high structure with high warmth is normative and produces the same outcomes as "authoritative" measured with Western instruments, and importing a foreign family into a counselling room is a form of malpractice dressed as evidence. The counsellor assesses the two dials in the household's own idiom: where is the warmth, and is the structure warm? — not whether the style matches a scale.

The family presentations that end counselling-as-usual — where the developmental frame must give way to protection, grief or crisis work, and the week 13 pathway opens: *maltreatment* (abuse and neglect: the child's safety governs, the report follows the jurisdiction's law, and the counselling that pretends the household is a negotiation partner is a betrayal); *loss and separation* (death, divorce, migration splits — the adolescent's grief with its anger-mask and its school-collapse); *parental illness* (including the adolescent as carer: the child running the household at fourteen is not "mature", and the file says so); *displacement* (refugee, internally displaced, the twice-moved child whose belonging portfolio is all losses); and *household economies under strain* (the hunger in the house, the school fees, the work that competes with school — week 10's material, arriving early and governing everything else). In every one of these, the developmental renegotiation continues underneath, and the counselling that ignores either level — the crisis or the adolescence — fails the child twice.

> **SAFEGUARDING AND DUTY TO REPORT**
> Family work with adolescents carries the confidentiality geometry the adolescent must know before the first joint session: what each party has said in individual

sessions is not the counsellor's to release; joint sessions are prepared with each participant beforehand, and nothing is ambushed in the room. Where maltreatment is disclosed, the jurisdiction's child-protection law governs, the child is told what must happen and in what order, and the accompaniment principle of week 7 applies: the child goes with an adult, not to one.

Worked example 8.1 — The Ada household at the table

Task. First joint session: Auntie Bisi, Ada (14), and the counsellor. Bisi's opening statement: "She does not talk to me any more. I have done everything for her since her mother left." Plan the session: seating, order, lever, agreement.

Solution. *Preparation, before the room:* Ada seen first, alone; her words gathered and her permission taken for what may be said ("the choir, the nights — yes; the SS3 plan — not yet"); Bisi seen second, alone, and given the same rule: nothing ambushed. *Seating and order:* not across a table but beside and angled; Ada speaks first in the joint session — not because she is the client-of-record but because the household's story ("she does not talk") must be answered by the person it describes, in the room, once, before the adults' account organises everything. *The lever, located aloud:* the disputed items surface — the phone at night (prudential-personal boundary: the hour is negotiable, the charging outside the bedroom is the household's sleep rule for **everyone**, which Bisi accepts for herself in the room, converting control into shared practice); the SS3 plan (personal domain, deferred: Ada's jurisdiction, granted in principle with a review at the term's end, which Bisi hears as a schedule rather than a loss); the mother (nobody's jurisdiction to negotiate: loss, and the session names it once — "this table has three people and a fourth who is missing" — because the renegotiation cannot proceed around an unspoken hole). *The one agreement that survives the room:* the market errand — one standing weekly errand together, chosen because it is connection without interrogation, knowledge-supply without surveillance: what Ada tells on the walk home is voluntary, and voluntary telling is the monitoring that works. *Documentation:* jurisdictions located; the one agreement; Ada's knowledge of what was said about her; review in three weeks; and the sentence the file keeps — Bisi's "everything for her" and Ada's silence are both accurate, and the counselling is for the table, not the diagnosis.

Worked example 8.2 — Kelvin's household: structure without warmth, warmth without structure

Task. Kelvin (16, repeating SS1, one arrest) lives with Auntie Bisi and younger cousins. Bisi is warm and exhausted; the late father's brother supplies monthly rankings (week 6) and no warmth; the peer set supplies both structure and warmth outside the house. Assess the dials; write the household plan.

Solution. *Dial assessment, in the household's idiom:* warmth — present but stretched thin across four children and a trade, and Kelvin's share arrives as worry rather as pride; structure — outsourced: the rankings supply standards without warmth (the reliable risk), the peer set supplies both (why it governs his evenings), and the household supplies neither consistently for Kelvin specifically — not from neglect but from exhaustion and from the cultural assumption that a sixteen-year-old boy is already grown. *The three autonomies:* behavioural granted early and unhelpfully (he runs his own evenings at sixteen — authority without scaffolding); emotional under-developed toward the household (Bisi is loved but not confided in: the knowledge-supply stopped when the repeating began and the rankings made telling dangerous); cognitive autonomy healthy — he argues well, which the rankings punish and the room recruits. *Plan:* structure returned to the house in warm form — one weekly meal at which Kelvin's **effort** is read aloud (the rankings' slot, week 6′s substitution) and the football's pride announced; knowledge-supply reopened by one walk per month with Bisi in which results are forbidden (week 6′s uncle walk transplanted to the person who is actually warm); the code-message kept as willing transmission (week 4); the peer structure honoured rather than fought — one set member invited to the house for the match, converting the set from rival institution to guest; and the arrest's meaning held at the level it belongs: prudential domain, the household's authority legitimate, Kelvin's ownership of it the work — with the bag-on-the-windowsill principle stated to Bisi once: heat needs friction removed, and the removal is a household act, not a punishment. *Falsifier, dated:* books home within four weeks (week 6′s marker), and one voluntary telling — something Kelvin reports unprompted — within six. If the voluntary telling does not come, the knowledge-supply is blocked at the rankings and the uncle conversation reopens before anything else.

SKILLS LABORATORY

Practical 8 — the first family session. In triads (adolescent, parent, counsellor) with supplied case material: prepare each party separately, seat the room, run twenty minutes with the jurisdictional lever located aloud and exactly one agreement reached, then debrief against the record: whose story organised the room, what was ambushed, what survived. Rotate all roles. 400-word session record. The mark is for the adolescent having spoken first and the agreement being one the adolescent chose.

ASSESSMENT

Assessed task. A family case analysis of 1,200 words: the three autonomies assessed separately; the knowledge-supply located (what has the child stopped telling, and why); the disputed items mapped by domain with the jurisdictional lever written as you would say it aloud; the two dials assessed in the household's idiom with

cultural qualifications stated; the crisis presentations screened; and the first-session plan with seating, order, one agreement, and the confidentiality geometry stated to the adolescent.

Criterion	Weight
Autonomies separate; knowledge-supply located	20%
Domains mapped; lever phrased aloud	25%
Dials in the household's idiom, culture honoured	20%
Crisis screen complete	10%
Session plan concrete; confidentiality geometry stated	25%

Formative. Write the sentence you would say aloud, in a family session, to locate the jurisdiction of a sixteen-year-old's hair. Then write the parent's likely answer, and your next sentence.

UNIT SYNTHESIS

Synthesis. The adolescent family renegotiates rather than separates: emotional, behavioural and cognitive autonomy develop at three speeds, granted and refused in unchosen bundles; monitoring works through knowledge and knowledge through willing telling; conflict concentrates in the personal domain and its jurisdictional location is the lever that turns a values war into a negotiation, with conflict quality and repair predicting adjustment rather than frequency; parenting runs on two dials assessed in the household's own idiom, warmth the non-negotiable one; connectedness is the protection to preserve first; and where maltreatment, loss, illness, displacement or hunger governs, the crisis work opens and the adolescence continues underneath — the counselling that ignores either level fails the child twice.

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- Steinberg, L. (2014). *Age of opportunity: Lessons from the new science of adolescence*. Houghton Mifflin Harcourt. — **core text**; the family chapters.
- Patton, G. C., Sawyer, S. M., Santelli, J. S., Ross, D. A., Afifi, R., Allen, N. B., Arora, M., Azzopardi, P., Baldwin, W., Bonell, C., Kakuma, R., Kennedy, E., Mahon, J., McGovern, T., Mokdad, A. H., Patel, V., Petroni, S., Reavley, N., Taiwo, K., … Viner, R. M. (2016). Our future: A *Lancet* commission on adolescent health and wellbeing. *The Lancet, 387*(10036), 2423–2478.

Seminar questions

1. "She does not talk to me any more." Who speaks first in the joint session, and why does the order matter more than the technique?
2. Locate the domain: a girl's hair; a boy's ride home at midnight; a child's church; a daughter's career. Which negotiations does your list make possible?
3. Authoritative parenting's cultural qualification: what is imported when a counsellor teaches it uncritically, and what is the household's own idiom for warm structure?
4. Knowledge comes mostly from willing telling. What has your service done that teaches adolescents not to tell?
5. The adolescent as carer: at what point is "mature" the wrong word, and what does the file say instead?

Next week

Week 9 moves outward: peers, crowds, romance and sexual development — the second institution of adolescence, with its own map, its own risks and its own counsel.

9 LECTURE UNIT 9 Teaching week 9 4 notional hours

Peers, Crowds, Friendship and Romance

LEARNING OUTCOMES

By the end of this week you will be able to:

1. **Describe** the structure of the adolescent peer world — crowds, cliques, friendships, romantic dyads — and state what each layer supplies and what it costs.
2. **Distinguish** selection from socialisation in peer similarity, and explain why "they are a bad influence" is usually half of a true sentence.
3. **Explain** co-rumination and friendship quality as mechanisms: why the same friendship that protects can also transmit distress.
4. **Describe** romantic and sexual development as normative sequences with diverse timings, and counsel romance's endings and its dangers — coercion, control, image-based abuse — without moral panic.
5. **Work with** the peer group rather than against it: friendship repair, set-exit with face, and the digital village's etiquette.

Where this week sits

Week 8 placed the adolescent in the household; this week places them in the second institution: the peer world, which supplies belonging, identity material, rehearsal for intimacy, and a substantial share of the semester's risk. The counsellor who

treats the peer group as the enemy will lose the adolescent, because the peer group is where the adolescent lives; the counsellor who treats it as harmless will miss the mechanisms — selection, socialisation, co-rumination, coercion — by which friendships and romances carry both the cure and the wound.

Key concepts

PEER LAYERS
The nested structure of the adolescent peer world: the crowd (a reputation and a label, loose and public), the clique (three to nine chosen companions, daily), the friendship (a dyad of disclosure, tested over time), and the romantic dyad (two, time, body, risk). Intimacy and risk both deepen toward the centre. In the room: locate the presenting wound's layer before choosing the intervention.

SELECTION VS SOCIALISATION
The two engines of peer similarity: adolescents choose companions like themselves (selection), and companions then make each other more alike (socialisation). Both are real; their share varies by behaviour — strong for substance use and school engagement, weaker for personality. In the room: why removing a friend rarely removes the behaviour, and why the sentence "they are a bad influence" is half true.

CO-RUMINATION
Rose's construct: the excessive, repetitive discussion of problems within a friendship — high in disclosure, high in contagion; more common among girls' friendships and a mechanism by which close friendship simultaneously predicts support and internalising symptoms. In the room: the difference between a friend who listens and a friendship whose only language is the wound.

ROMANTIC SEQUENCE
The normative ordering of romantic development — group-based mixed-sex activity, then dyadic dating, then romantic relationships with commitment and sexual intimacy — with wide individual and cultural variation and no required timetable; early and off-sequence involvement carries risk chiefly where supervision and support are absent, not because romance is itself pathology. In the room: the calendar question ("where are they in the sequence, and who knows?") rather than the moral one.

Lecture I — The peer world's structure and its two engines

Proposition 1. Each layer supplies a different nutrient. The crowd supplies a public identity and a place to be seen; the clique supplies daily belonging and a behavioural norm; the friendship supplies disclosure and the first experience of

being known; the romantic dyad supplies intimacy, desire and the first negotiation of body and boundary. A deficit at any layer produces a different wound: crowd-exclusion reads as shame, clique-loss as loneliness, friendship-betrayal as grief, romantic loss as catastrophe — and the referral letter will say "low mood" for all four.

Proposition 2. Similarity is manufactured twice. Selection places like with like before any influence occurs; socialisation then amplifies. The practical consequence is exact: an intervention that separates friends attacks socialisation and leaves selection untouched — the adolescent will re-select within a week unless the underlying need (the set's warmth, the crowd's label) is met elsewhere. Hence week 4′s bag rule and week 8′s widening: add objects of loyalty rather than confiscating them.

Proposition 3. Friendship quality, not friendship presence, is the variable. A high-quality friendship — reciprocal, trusting, low in conflict — protects against victimisation and distress; a high-conflict or coercive "friendship" carries risk worse than solitude. Assessment therefore audits quality per named friend: who listens, who keeps secrets, who scores, who punishes. The audit is also the intervention's map, because one good friend is the most repairable asset in adolescent work.

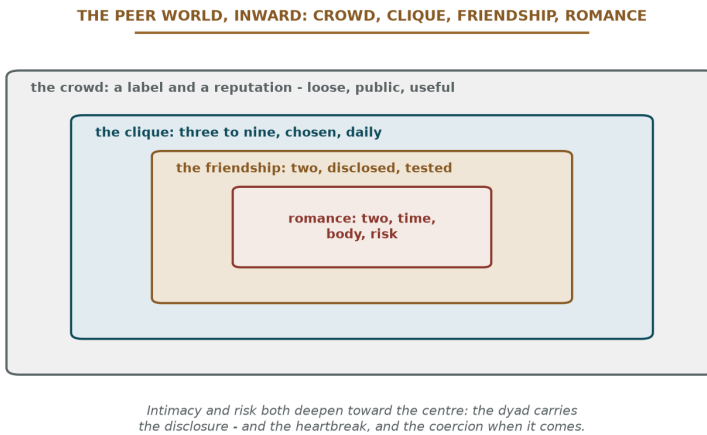


Figure 9.1 The peer world inward: crowd, clique, friendship and romance as nested layers, with intimacy and risk deepening toward the centre. *Source:* prepared for this edition.

PRACTICE NOTE

Clinical implication. In every case, name the layer the wound lives in — crowd, clique, friendship or romance — and audit one named relationship per layer for

> quality. "Peer problems" is not a formulation; "clique-loss with one coercive friendship remaining" is.

Lecture II — Romance, sexuality and their dangers

Romantic development is normative and, on the evidence, developmentally significant: romantic experience in adolescence contributes to identity, to the capacity for intimacy, and to the regulation of emotion in relationships — which is why counselling that treats adolescent romance as a distraction from schoolwork has mispriced it. The sequence runs from mixed-group activity through dyadic dating to committed relationships, with sexual intimacy's timing varying widely by culture, faith and individual; the counsellor's calendar question is where this adolescent is in the sequence and which adults know, because risk concentrates where involvement outruns support rather than where it begins.

The dangers have names and they are assessable. *Coercion and control:* the partner who monitors the phone, forbids the friendship, dictates the clothing — control behaviours escalate in adolescent relationships as in adult ones, and the adolescent vocabulary for them is often love. *Image-based abuse:* the intimate image shared, or the threat of sharing, which is conduct with legal edges and a victim, whatever the image's origin and whatever the child's shame says. *Sexual health and pregnancy:* accurate local information, contraception and services, stated plainly, without the moral lecture that ends disclosure. *Consent:* the capacity to refuse and to be refused, taught as a skill with sentences, not as a slogan.

Diverse orientations, same duties. Romantic development runs on the same sequence for sexual- and gender-minority adolescents, with two additions: a community that may exist only online, and a disclosure geometry in which the wrong person knowing first can cost the child their home. The week 5 safeguard governs: safety first, the child's words and timetable, the family work that converts rejection into protection at the family's pace.

Lecture III — Counselling the peer world

Friendship repair is the most cost-effective intervention in adolescent practice: one re-watered friendship moves esteem, disclosure and monitoring-knowledge at once. The method is behavioural and small — a standing errand, a shared task, a message script rehearsed in session — and it is evaluated by contact counts, not by sentiment.

Co-rumination is treated by widening the friendship's language, not by ending the friendship: the pair is given a shared doing (the walk, the drill, the project) so that the wound stops being the only topic; where co-rumination is the friendship's entire substance, the individual work of week 7 (rumination interruption) runs in parallel.

Set-exit with face is the route out of a peer group that must be left: every set contains an exit that does not read as betrayal — the injury, the apprenticeship, the auntie's shop, the team selection — and the counsellor's job is to find it with the adolescent and dress the leaving in it, so that fidelity (week 5) is honoured even in departure.

The digital village's etiquette is counselled as etiquette, not surveillance: what is forwarded, what is screenshotted, what is owed an answer tonight and what is not; the group chat's cruelty is named as conduct, and the bystander's sentence ("that is not how we talk about people here") is rehearsed, because bystander speech is the only regulation the village respects.

> **SAFEGUARDING AND DUTY TO REPORT**
> Romantic disclosures carry three safeguarding edges: coercion and control by a partner (assess safety and means of contact; the child's phone may be the abuser's instrument); image-based abuse (the child is a victim; preserve evidence, report per jurisdiction, and never let shame organise the response); and age-asymmetry that constitutes an offence under the jurisdiction's law (where an adult or much older partner is involved, protection law governs and the accompaniment principle applies).

Worked example 9.1 — Ada and Blessing, at six weeks

Task. Evaluate the friendship-repair plan of week 6 (the standing market errand with Blessing) and decide what changes.

Solution. The record: five errands in six weeks (one missed for rain), two voluntary tellings to the auntie arising on the walk home (knowledge-supply reopened, week 8), one choir rehearsal attended with Blessing beside her and entry from the back (week 2′s engineering), mood diary: two-a.m. nights down from six per week to two. The friendship audit per layer: crowd — Ada remains unlabelled and unbothered; clique — the old choir trio has not reformed, and Ada names no clique, which at fourteen is acceptable but thin; friendship — Blessing: listens, keeps secrets, does not score: one high-quality dyad, restored; romance — none, and no wish for any yet, stated without shame: normative. Co-rumination check: the errands' talk is prices, choir, the auntie — the wound is not the friendship's only language: healthy. Decision: the plan continues unchanged except one addition — the choir's next-term solo is accepted (week 6′s deferred competence), because competence in a valued domain now has a witness, which is what converts achievement into esteem. Falsifier kept: if the two-a.m. nights return with the solo, the governing strand reorders to internalising (week 7) and the formulation is rewritten, not the plan.

Worked example 9.2 — Kelvin's loyalty, and Ngozi

Task. Kelvin (16) has a girlfriend of four months, Ngozi, who is in SS2 at another school. She has asked him twice to stop the evening runs with the set; he has refused twice, saying "I cannot leave my people." The set has begun mocking her. Counsel the triangle.

Solution. The layers: the set is clique-plus-history (fidelity's oldest object, week 5); Ngozi is the first friendship-quality dyad with romance in it — the audit finds she listens, keeps secrets, and does not score: the highest-quality relationship in his life, and the only one asking him toward school. The mock-campaign is the set defending its boundary: exit-readiness is being punished, which is exactly the mechanism set-exit-with-face exists for. The intervention runs on three tracks. *With Kelvin:* name the collision aloud — "two loyalties, both real; the set wants all of you and she wants the best of you; that is not a choice between good and bad, it is a scheduling war" — and locate the exit with face: the goalkeeper's return (weeks 2 and 6) gives him evening training three nights a week that the set already accepts as football, not betrayal; the remaining two nights keep the code-message (week 4) and the auntie's meal. *With the triangle:* one session with Ngozi present in which the mock-campaign is named as conduct and Kelvin is given his bystander sentence to say to the set — rehearsed twice in session, because the sentence is his status cost and it must be fluent before it is spent. *With the household:* the auntie is told of the relationship with Kelvin present and in his words (week 8′s geometry), and is asked for one thing only: that Ngozi is welcome at the Sunday meal — a loyalty object added inside the house, which is where widening works. Falsifier, dated: if within eight weeks the evening runs have not fallen to two nights, or the mock-campaign has escalated to Ngozi's route home, the exit-with-face has failed and the conversation turns to a clean break with the set — planned with Kelvin, dressed in the football, and honoured rather than hidden.

SKILLS LABORATORY

Practical 9 — the peer audit. From a supplied case record: build the layer map (crowd, clique, friendship, romance) with one named relationship per layer; audit each named relationship for quality (listens / keeps secrets / scores / punishes); locate the presenting wound's layer; and write one friendship-repair or set-exit-with-face plan with a dated falsifier. 400 words. The mark is for names, not categories: an audit without named people is a theory, not an assessment.

ASSESSMENT

Assessed task. A peer-world case analysis of 1,100 words: the layer map with named relationships and quality audits; selection versus socialisation argued for the presenting behaviour with the half-true sentence completed; co-rumination assessed

where a close friendship exists; the romantic-sequence calendar with the support question answered; and one intervention plan (repair, widening, exit-with-face or bystander sentence) with its falsifier.

Criterion	Weight
Layer map with named relationships and quality audits	25%
Selection and socialisation distinguished and applied	20%
Co-rumination and friendship quality assessed	15%
Romantic calendar and support question	15%
Intervention plan concrete with falsifier	25%

Formative. Name the friend who carried your own adolescence, and write the one sentence that tells you whether the friendship was nourishment, co-rumination, or both.

UNIT SYNTHESIS

Synthesis. The peer world is layered — crowd, clique, friendship, romance — with intimacy and risk deepening inward; similarity is manufactured twice, by selection and socialisation, so separating friends treats half the mechanism; friendship quality rather than presence is the protective variable, and co-rumination is the tax close friendship can levy; romantic development is a normative sequence whose risks concentrate where involvement outruns support, and its dangers — coercion, image-based abuse, untaught consent — have names and assessments; and the counsellor works with the peer world by repairing one friendship, widening a friendship's language, finding the set-exit with face, and teaching the village's etiquette rather than policing it.

READING (APA 7TH)

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- Rose, A. J. (2002). Co-rumination in the friendships of girls and boys. *Child Development, 73*(6), 1830–1843.
- Steinberg, L. (2014). *Age of opportunity: Lessons from the new science of adolescence*. Houghton Mifflin Harcourt. — **core text**; the peers and romance chapters.

Seminar questions

1. "They are a bad influence." Complete the sentence with the half that is missing, and say what changes in the plan.
2. Which layer does your service's intake form actually ask about — and which layer do your adolescents' wounds live in?
3. Co-rumination: when is ending the friendship the right call, and who decides?
4. Set-exit with face: name one exit route in a set you have known, and why it preserved fidelity.
5. The bystander sentence is the village's only regulation. What is yours, and have you rehearsed it aloud?

Next week

Week 10 follows the adolescent into the third institution: school, work and the long horizon of aspiration — Super's stages, and the counselling of horizons that economies bend.

10 LECTURE UNIT 10 Teaching week 10 4 notional hours

School, Work and the Long Horizon: Aspiration and Its Economies

LEARNING OUTCOMES

By the end of this week you will be able to:

1. **Describe** school as a developmental context: climate, belonging, transitions, and the achievement–identity loop, and read absence and refusal as signals with a differential.
2. **Explain** adolescent work and apprenticeship as both harness and hazard, and assess the schooling–work trade-off in a household economy.
3. **Apply** Super's life-span stages to adolescent vocational development, distinguishing aspiration from expectation and locating where each is bent by gender, class and economy.
4. **Counsel** aspiration without inflation or deflation: the horizon conversation, the plan's rungs, and the household sentences that widen or narrow a child's future.
5. **Audit** one service or school practice that narrows horizons, and write its replacement.

Where this week sits

The adolescent's third institution is the one that schedules their body and prices their future: school, and beside it — for many of the adolescents of this

programme — work. This week treats both as developmental contexts rather than backdrops: the school's climate and belonging as mental-health variables, absence as a symptom with a differential, apprenticeship as a real vocational pathway with real costs, and aspiration as the construct where identity (week 5), esteem (week 6) and economy meet. Super's stages give the horizon its grammar; the counsellor's work is to keep the horizon honest — neither inflated into fantasy nor deflated into fate.

Key concepts

SCHOOL CLIMATE
The school's social-emotional weather: whether students feel known, safe and counted; a strong predictor of adolescent mental health, attendance and achievement, and more malleable than any individual trait. In the room: the variable a counsellor can move with a head teacher, when the child cannot be moved at all.

ABSENCE DIFFERENTIAL
School absence is a signal, not a diagnosis: its differential includes anxiety and depression (week 7), victimisation in the building (week 9), household labour and economics (this week), illness and sleep debt (week 3), and conduct-oriented avoidance (week 4's heat). The pattern — total refusal versus partial drift, mornings versus afternoons, term-onset versus mid-term — separates them. In the room: the attendance record is an assessment instrument; read it before interviewing.

ASPIRATION EXPECTATION GAP
The distance between what an adolescent hopes for (aspiration) and what they believe probable (expectation); the gap is where economies, gender and class do their work, and a wide gap predicts disengagement rather than effort. In the room: ask both questions separately — "what do you want?" and "what do you think will happen?" — because the distance between the answers is the counselling target.

VOCATIONAL EXPLORATION
Super's exploration stage: the adolescent's first real trials — tentative choices, transitions, part-time work, apprenticeship — in which vocational identity is assembled the way personal identity is (week 5), by exploration and commitment together. In the room: why "what will you be?" is a developmental task and not an interrogation.

Lecture I — School as a developmental context

Proposition 1. The school is a mental-health variable. Climate and belonging predict adolescent distress and persistence independently of family factors; the transitions that damage belonging — primary to junior secondary, junior to

senior, school to school — are the same transitions week 6 located in the esteem dip. The counsellor's levers inside a school are small and real: one adult who knows the child by name, one club or team that counts the child as a member, one timetable adjustment that removes a daily humiliation.

Proposition 2. Absence has a differential and the record discriminates. Total morning refusal with Sunday-night somatic complaints points to anxiety or victimisation; partial afternoon drift points to peer economy or work; mid-term onset after a result points to esteem and the rankings household (week 6); term-onset absence after a move points to belonging. The attendance pattern is read first, because interviewing without it produces the story the child can tell rather than the one the term shows.

Proposition 3. Achievement and identity run in a loop. Results feed the self-concept's school domain (week 6), and the self-concept feeds effort and examination weather; the loop turns vicious where results are read aloud at home or where the domain is weighted heavily and scored publicly. Breaking the loop rarely starts at the studying: it starts at the reading-aloud.

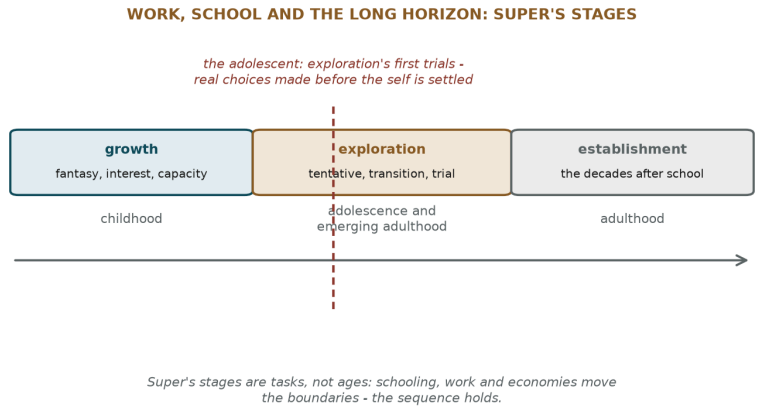


Figure 10.1 Super's stages: growth, exploration and establishment across the life span, with adolescence located in exploration's first trials. *Source:* prepared for this edition, after Super (1980).

PRACTICE NOTE

Clinical implication. Pull the attendance record before the second session of any adolescent case, and chart it by week against the case timeline: onset, pattern, mornings versus afternoons. The chart is free, and it argues with the referral letter.

Lecture II — Work, apprenticeship and the household economy

Adolescent work is two things at once and the balance is empirical, not ideological. **As harness:** apprenticeship and family-enterprise work supply competence in a valued domain (week 6's lever), adult mentorship, income that buys autonomy, and a vocational identity that school-failure would otherwise foreclose; for many adolescents of this programme the trade is the horizon, and counselling that treats it as a consolation prize insults the client. **As hazard:** work that competes with school hours, that carries injury or exploitation, that is the household's income rather than the child's training, converts exploration into foreclosure and adolescence into labour — and the file says so plainly, because the child-as-carer and child-as-earner are safeguarding presentations (week 8), not maturity.

The **schooling–work trade-off** is assessed in the household's own economy: what does the child's work buy, who else would earn it, and what does school cost the household this term? The counsellor who cannot answer those three has no standing to advise on the trade; the counsellor who can answer them can often find the rung — evening classes, the deferred apprenticeship, the term-by-term fee plan, the scholarship application done together in session — that keeps both doors open one more year, which is usually all the horizon needs.

Lecture III — Aspiration, expectation and the horizon conversation

Super's sequence — growth (fantasy, interest, capacity), exploration (tentative, transition, trial), establishment — locates the adolescent in exploration's first trials: real choices made before the self is settled, which is precisely why the choices must be real and many. Vocational development runs on the same engine as identity (week 5): exploration and commitment, in domains, at statuses — the fourteen-year-old foreclosed into the trade by economics and the sixteen-year-old diffused about everything are the same map's two casualties.

The horizon conversation has four moves. *Aspire:* "what do you want, if nothing stops you?" — recorded verbatim. *Expect:* "what do you think will happen?" — recorded verbatim; the gap between the two sentences is the target. *Audit the gap's owners:* who and what stands between the sentences — fees, gender, the household's assumption, the school's streaming, the child's own evidence — named one by one, because a gap with owners is a plan and a gap without owners is despair. *Build the rungs:* the next visible step inside the child's reach this term — the application, the evening class, the trade's first tool, the subject choice — chosen by the child, dated, and reviewed; the rung is the intervention, never the speech.

Gender and class bend horizons early and quietly: the daughter whose science is praised at twelve and steered away at fifteen; the son whose repeating year is read as termination rather than delay. The counsellor's discipline is to say

the bend aloud in the room where it happens — with the household, in the household's idiom (week 8) — because a horizon narrowed in silence is a horizon the child believes they chose.

> **SAFEGUARDING AND DUTY TO REPORT**
> Where adolescent work is the household's income rather than the child's training, or carries injury, exploitation or hazardous hours, the presentation is child labour and the jurisdiction's protection law governs: the counsellor reports per policy, tells the child what must happen and in what order, and continues to counsel — the accompaniment principle (week 7) applies to protection work as much as to risk work.

Worked example 10.1 — Ada's SS3 plan, arrived early

Task. The vocation foreclosure watch of week 5 has matured: the household assumes Ada will leave school after SS3 for the trade apprenticeship; Ada's aspiration sentence is "I want to finish university and sing"; her expectation sentence is "I will go to the apprenticeship because Bisi cannot pay." Conduct the horizon conversation and write the rungs.

Solution. *The gap:* university-and-song versus apprenticeship — a wide gap with three owners: fees (real, quantified this term: the SS3 fee and the examination fee), the household's assumption (unstated until this session, therefore unargued), and Ada's own evidence (her results are mid-band, which she reads as verdict rather than position). *The owners, one by one:* fees — the scholarship list of the diocesan board and the state bursary, applications done together across two sessions, with the auntie's signature line explained so the household is inside the plan rather than ambushed by it; assumption — the household conversation of week 8′s method, in which the assumption is named as an assumption and dated ("after SS3 results, not before"), which converts a fate into a decision with a calendar; evidence — the results chart re-read as position and slope, with the two subjects whose slope is rising named aloud, because rising slope is the argument against verdict. *The rungs, chosen by Ada and dated:* this term — the bursary applications and one choir solo with a witness (week 9); next term — the subject choice for SS3 kept open to the science combination rather than closed to the trade track; after results — the decision meeting with all three sentences on the table. *The sentence the file keeps:* the apprenticeship is not removed from the table — it is dated, because a dated option is a plan and an undated assumption is a ceiling. Falsifier: if the bursary applications are not submitted by the term's sixth week, the fees owner has won silently and the session returns to the applications as the agenda, not to the mood.

Worked example 10.2 — Kelvin's repeating year as exploration, not verdict

Task. Kelvin (16) repeats SS1. The uncle's rankings (week 6) have named the repeat "the end of school"; the set names school "not for people like us"; the trade (the uncle's shop) offers an apprenticeship now. Write the horizon conversation and the rung.

Solution. *Aspire:* "I want my own thing — a shop, or the team; something mine." *Expect:* "the shop now, because school has finished with me." The gap is narrow but inverted: his aspiration is vocational and alive, his expectation is foreclosure dressed as realism — and both the household and the set are supplying the dress. *Reframe in Super's grammar, aloud:* the repeat is a transition inside exploration, not an exit from it — sixteen in SS1 is two years inside the exploration stage, not outside it; the trade is a legitimate exploration trial, and the question is sequence rather than either/or. *The rung, negotiated with the household and the uncle present:* the apprenticeship begins **now** — Saturdays and school holidays only, in the uncle's shop, with the uncle as master and the ranking ritual replaced by the trade's own standards (which are warm: the trade praises work, not position); school continues to the SS1 examination with the football pride announced at the meal (weeks 2, 6, 8); and the decision meeting is dated after the examination result, with all three sentences — school, trade, team — on the table and none removed. *Why this rung:* it gives the set's narrative ("school is not for us") nothing to fight, gives the uncle's standards a warm channel, and keeps the school door open on a hinge the household itself holds. Falsifier, dated: attendance chart read at week six — if afternoon drift exceeds two sessions per fortnight, the trade is absorbing the school day and the hours are renegotiated with the uncle directly; if attendance holds and the result rises, the hinge stays open to SS2 and the horizon has widened by one year, which is the unit this work trades in.

SKILLS LABORATORY

Practical 10 — the horizon conversation. In pairs on a supplied case: conduct the four moves (aspire, expect, audit the gap's owners, build the rungs) with both sentences recorded verbatim and at least three owners named; then write the rung calendar (this term, next term, after results) and the household sentence that must be said aloud for the rung to survive. 400 words. The mark is for verbatim sentences and dated rungs — an aspiration without a date is a wish, and this course does not grade wishes.

ASSESSMENT

Assessed task. A school–work–horizon analysis of 1,100 words: the attendance chart read against the timeline with the differential argued; school climate and

belonging located with one in-school lever named; the work assessment in the household economy (what it buys, who else would earn it, what school costs this term); the horizon conversation with verbatim aspiration and expectation, the gap's owners named, and the rung calendar dated; and one audit of a horizon-narrowing practice in your service or school with its replacement sentence.

Criterion	Weight
Attendance chart and differential argued	20%
School climate lever concrete	15%
Work assessed in household economy	20%
Horizon conversation verbatim, owners named, rungs dated	30%
Narrowing practice audited with replacement	15%

Formative. Write the sentence an adult said about your own horizon at fifteen, and the sentence you would say instead to a child holding the same report.

UNIT SYNTHESIS

Synthesis. School is a developmental context whose climate and belonging are mental-health variables, whose transitions feed the esteem dip, and whose absence records are assessment instruments with a differential; adolescent work is harness and hazard at once, assessed in the household's own economy before any advice is given; Super locates the adolescent in exploration's first trials, where vocational identity assembles by the same engine as personal identity; aspiration and expectation are two different sentences whose gap has owners; and the horizon conversation — aspire, expect, audit the owners, date the rungs — keeps a child's future honest, with the apprenticeship dated rather than deleted and the decision meeting on a calendar the household holds.

READING (APA 7TH)

- Patton, G. C., Sawyer, S. M., Santelli, J. S., Ross, D. A., Afifi, R., Allen, N. B., Arora, M., Azzopardi, P., Baldwin, W., Bonell, C., Kakuma, R., Kennedy, E., Mahon, J., McGovern, T., Mokdad, A. H., Patel, V., Petroni, S., Reavley, N., Taiwo, K., … Viner, R. M. (2016). Our future: A *Lancet* commission on adolescent health and wellbeing. *The Lancet, 387*(10036), 2423–2478. — the education and work sections.
- Steinberg, L. (2014). *Age of opportunity: Lessons from the new science of adolescence*. Houghton Mifflin Harcourt. — **core text**; the school and work chapters.
- Super, D. E. (1980). A life-span, life-space approach to career development. *Journal of Vocational Behavior, 16*(3), 282–298.

Seminar questions

1. Read an attendance record you remember from practice: what did the pattern say that the referral letter did not?
2. The apprenticeship is dated, not deleted. What does that sentence protect in the child, and in the household?
3. Aspiration minus expectation: whose names usually own the gap in your caseload, and which owner can you actually move?
4. Work as harness, work as hazard: where is the line in your jurisdiction's law, and where is it in the household's economy?
5. Name one horizon-narrowing sentence your institution says routinely. What is its replacement?

Next week

Week 11 turns from risk's list to resilience's mechanics: ordinary magic, cumulative risk, turning points, and positive youth development's five Cs — what programmes must supply to grow them.

11 LECTURE UNIT 11 Teaching week 11 4 notional hours

Risk, Resilience and Positive Youth Development

LEARNING OUTCOMES

By the end of this week you will be able to:

1. **Explain** why risk behaviour concentrates in adolescence without being universal or inevitable, integrating the dual-systems account (week 3) with peer context (weeks 4, 9).
2. **Describe** resilience as ordinary processes rather than rare traits — Masten's "ordinary magic" — and list the protective factors with the strongest evidence.
3. **Apply** cumulative-risk and turning-point thinking to a case: counting risks, locating the one factor that can move, and naming the turning point's mechanics.
4. **Describe** positive youth development and the five Cs, and state the programme features the evidence requires.
5. **Design** one PYD intervention for a real peer group, converting a risk group into a contribution group.

Where this week sits

Weeks 3, 4 and 9 supplied risk's mechanics; this week supplies the other half of the ledger — why most adolescents come through the interval intact, what protects them, and how services can build protection rather than only intercept failure. Resilience research reframes the counsellor's list from deficits to processes;

positive youth development reframes the service from clinic to setting. The week ends with a design task, because PYD is not a theory to recite but a programme to run.

Key concepts

ORDINARY MAGIC
Masten's finding: resilience in development arises from ordinary adaptive systems — a capable caregiver, a close relationship, school engagement, self-regulation skills, faith or meaning community — rather than from rare individual toughness. In the room: the assessment question is not "is this child resilient?" but "which ordinary systems are still operating, and which have been lost?"

CUMULATIVE RISK
The dose-response pattern: adverse outcomes track the **number** of risks more than any single risk, and protection works the same way in reverse — each added protective factor shifts the curve. In the room: count. A case with nine risks and one protection is a different plan from a case with three risks and four protections, whatever the presenting complaint.

TURNING POINT
A discontinuity in a trajectory: a new relationship, a new setting, a new role (the team, the apprenticeship, the choir, the birth of a child, a migration) that changes the course rather than the moment. Turning points work by supplying a new identity narrative and a new peer set, not by insight. In the room: the mechanism behind every "and then everything changed" — and the thing a counsellor can sometimes help arrive.

FIVE CS
Lerner's positive youth development model: competence, confidence, connection, character, caring — and, when the five are supplied by good settings, the sixth C, contribution, which turns outward toward community. The five are products of settings, not traits of children. In the room: the audit that converts "what is wrong with this adolescent?" into "what is missing from this adolescent's settings?"

Lecture I — Risk, counted honestly

Risk behaviour's adolescent peak is real — the elevated rates of accident, substance experimentation, unprotected sex and offending in the mid-teens — and it is explained without recourse to defect: the dual-systems gap (week 3) supplies the engine, the peer context (weeks 4, 9) supplies the accelerator, and inexperience supplies the rest. Three corrections keep the ledger honest. **Most adolescents do**

not: the majority pass through the interval without serious risk behaviour, and the majority of those who experiment desist — adolescent-limited patterns are the norm, not the prelude. **Risk is concentrated:** a small share of adolescents carries a large share of the risk behaviour, and that share overlaps heavily with cumulative adversity rather than with adolescence itself. **Risk and opportunity share the engine:** the same reward-sensitivity and peer-orientation that carry the hazard carry the courage, the exploration and the learning of the interval — which is why the goal is steering rather than suppression, and why a service that only suppresses will also suppress the adolescent.

The counsellor's risk assessment therefore counts in both directions: the risk list (substance, weapons, sexual risk, offending, self-harm, exploitation, online conduct) and the protection list (one adult who knows, school belonging, a valued competence, a faith or meaning community, a future orientation with a date, a friendship of quality) — because the plan is built from the difference, and the protection list is usually the shorter document and the more movable one.

Lecture II — Resilience as process

Proposition 1. The short list of ordinary magic. Across decades and samples, the protective factors recur: at least one stable, committed relationship with a capable adult; self-regulation skills (week 3′s instrument, trained); school or work engagement with a belonging niche; a meaning or faith community; and a future orientation with concrete plans. None is exotic; all are intervenable; and the first — the committed adult — is the one the counselling relationship itself can sometimes supply for a season, which is both the hope and the limit of the role.

Proposition 2. Cumulative risk changes the plan's arithmetic. Single-risk interventions fail in high-count cases because the dose is the number: removing one of nine risks moves the curve negligibly. The work in high-count cases is therefore sequential and structural — add protections before subtracting risks (the relationship before the substance conversation, the meal before the monitoring), and recruit institutions (school, church, trade, health service) because a counsellor alone cannot move a count of nine.

Proposition 3. Turning points are settings, not insights. The mechanisms by which trajectories bend are documented: a new role that supplies identity and routine (the team, the apprenticeship, the choir, parenthood reframed), a new relationship that supplies the committed adult late, a new place that breaks the cue-context of old behaviour (the move, the migration, the new school). Counselling's contribution to a turning point is usually logistical and narrative: helping the role arrive, helping the story of the self change tense — from "I am the one who failed" to "I am the one who is training" — because the narrative is what lets the new setting hold.

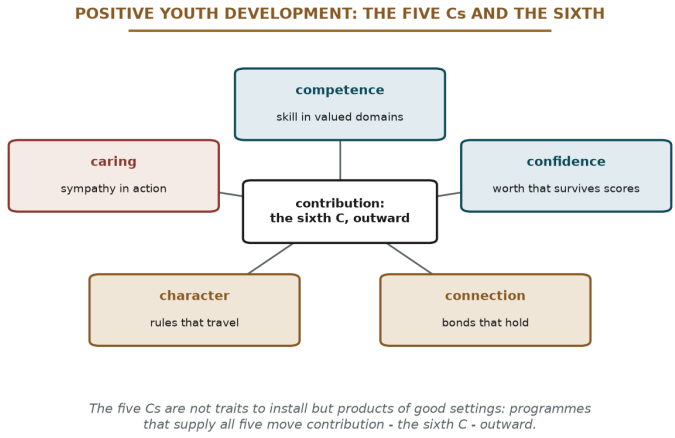


Figure 11.1 The five Cs and the sixth: competence, confidence, connection, character and caring as products of settings, with contribution turning outward. After Lerner. *Source:* prepared for this edition.

PRACTICE NOTE

Clinical implication. Keep two lists per case from the first session: risks and protections, counted. Review the counts at every review date; the plan's success is visible as a change in the difference before it is visible in the presenting symptom.

Lecture III — Positive youth development as service design

PYD's claim is structural: adolescents develop well where settings supply the five Cs — **competence** in domains they value, **confidence** that survives scoring, **connection** to adults and peers who know them, **character** as rules that travel across situations, **caring** as sympathy practised in action — and where the settings then invite **contribution**, the sixth C, outward to family and community. The evidence on programmes is specific about features: sustained rather than episodic contact; an adult relationship rather than a curriculum alone; skill-building with real standards; opportunities for contribution with real consequences; and alignment across settings (home, school, club) rather than a single heroic hour per week.

For this programme's services the design consequences are concrete. The **peer group is recruited as the unit**: the set that carries risk also carries loyalty and skill (week 5's fidelity); a PYD conversion gives the set a contribution task with real consequences — the team's coaching of the juniors, the stall that funds the kit, the night-watch rota during the floods — because contribution supplied to a set converts its internal economy from daring to keeping. The **church and the**

market are settings, not obstacles: the choir, the youth fellowship, the apprenticeship bench are the five Cs' native habitats in this context, and a service that cannot name its adolescents' settings cannot supply the Cs. And the **counsellor's own room** is audited by the same list: which C does a session supply — and which does it accidentally tax?

> **SAFEGUARDING AND DUTY TO REPORT**
> PYD work with high-count cases does not replace protection work: where exploitation, labour, abuse or offending are present, the safeguarding and legal pathways of weeks 7, 8 and 10 govern first, and the PYD plan runs beside them. Contribution tasks must never place an adolescent in unsupervised charge of younger children where any safeguarding concern exists about the adolescent themselves — the rota is designed with the institution's child-protection officer, not around them.

Worked example 11.1 — Ada's setting audit on the five Cs

Task. Audit Ada's current settings against the five Cs at the week-11 review, and name the one Cs-supplying change the service can make this term.

Solution. *Competence:* choir (rising — the solo accepted, week 9) and school mid-band with two rising subjects (week 10): supplied, thinly but really. *Confidence:* fragile — the comparison machine audited and architected (week 6), the results chart re-read as slope (week 10): improving, still the weakest C. *Connection:* Blessing restored, the auntie's knowledge-supply reopened, the counsellor known: three names, which is the protective factor with the strongest evidence, present. *Character:* intact and unexamined — she keeps the choir's rules and the errand's promise; the C nobody has named to her, and naming it is free. *Caring:* present but inward — she cares for the auntie silently; no outward channel since the choir's withdrawal. *Contribution:* absent — and its absence is the finding: every other C has a holder, contribution has none. *The one change the service can make this term:* the choir's junior section needs a helper for the under-tens' rehearsal on Saturdays; Ada is asked by the choirmaster (not the counsellor — the setting must own the invitation) with the counsellor's prior rehearsal of the yes-and-no sentence so refusal stays safe. The change supplies contribution, reweights competence with a witness, and places her in a room where the looking of week 2 cannot reach, because the under-tens do not look. Falsifier: attendance at four of six Saturday rehearsals by term's end; if she declines twice, the invitation is withdrawn without comment and re-routed through Blessing as a pair task, because contribution coerced is not contribution.

Worked example 11.2 — Converting Kelvin's set

Task. Design a PYD conversion for Kelvin's peer set (five boys, 15–17, evening runs, one arrest) using the programme features the evidence requires.

Solution. *The unit is the set, not Kelvin:* the loyalty is the asset (weeks 5, 9); the plan recruits all five or none. *The contribution task with real consequences:* the ward's junior football league has no referees' assistant and no kit fund; the set is approached — through Kelvin and through the ward's sports officer, not through the counsellor — to run the Saturday-under-14s: two as linesmen (the uncle's trade supplies the flags and the repair of the posts, which puts the uncle's standards inside the task), two as the kit fund's stewards (money with a ledger is character with a consequence), one as the under-tens' coach, which is the role that changes a self-narrative fastest. *Sustained contact:* the league is a season, not an event; the sports officer is the committed adult the design supplies, with the counsellor in the background and the auntie's Sunday meal as the household anchor. *Skill-building with real standards:* the league's rules are the standards; the set's existing competence (football, nerve, organisation) is the curriculum, so nothing is remedial and nothing is a favour. *Alignment across settings:* the school knows (the football pride is already announced at the meal, weeks 6 and 8), the uncle's shop supplies Saturdays' apprenticeship hours around the fixtures (week 10′s hinge), and the code-message (week 4) now reports the fixture rather than the run. *Risk count reviewed, not ignored:* the evening runs are not banned; they lose two nights to fixtures and the bag-rule conversation stands (week 4). Evaluation is dated and counted: fixtures staffed per month, one voluntary telling per boy per month to any adult in the design, and the attendance chart for Kelvin at week six (week 10′s falsifier). If the league declines the set, the fallback with equal features is the ward's night-watch rota during the rains — contribution with consequences, supervised, and older than football in this community.

SKILLS LABORATORY

Practical 11 — the two lists and the design. From a supplied high-count case: write the risk list and the protection list with counts; then design a PYD conversion for the adolescent's peer group against the five evidence features (sustained contact, adult relationship, skill with standards, contribution with consequences, cross-setting alignment). 450 words. The mark is for the design recruiting the group's existing loyalty and skill — a design that asks a set to become a choir has designed nothing.

ASSESSMENT

Assessed task. A resilience and PYD analysis of 1,100 words: the two lists with counts and the plan's arithmetic stated; the ordinary-magic audit (which adaptive systems operate, which are lost); cumulative-risk sequencing (add protections before subtracting risks, with the first two additions named); one turning-point candidate with its mechanics (new role, relationship or place, and the narrative change it

carries); and a PYD design against the five evidence features with dated, counted evaluation.

Criterion	Weight
Two lists counted; arithmetic stated	20%
Ordinary-magic audit concrete	20%
Sequencing argued (protections first)	15%
Turning point with mechanics and narrative	20%
PYD design against five features, evaluation dated	25%

Formative. Name the committed adult of your own adolescence who was not a parent. Write the one thing they did repeatedly. That is the intervention.

UNIT SYNTHESIS

Synthesis. Risk concentrates in adolescence without being universal, concentrated or permanent: the dual-systems engine, the peer accelerator and inexperience explain the peak, and most adolescents desist; resilience is ordinary magic — the committed adult, self-regulation, engagement, meaning, a dated future — assessed as operating systems rather than traits; cumulative risk makes the count the target, so protections are added before risks are subtracted and institutions are recruited because counsellors alone cannot move a count of nine; turning points are settings with new narratives, helped logistically rather than insightfully; and positive youth development supplies the five Cs through sustained settings with real standards and real contribution — the peer group recruited as the unit, the church and market named as settings, and the counsellor's own room audited by the same list.

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- Patton, G. C., Sawyer, S. M., Santelli, J. S., Ross, D. A., Afifi, R., Allen, N. B., Arora, M., Azzopardi, P., Baldwin, W., Bonell, C., Kakuma, R., Kennedy, E., Mahon, J., McGovern, T., Mokdad, A. H., Patel, V., Petroni, S., Reavley, N., Taiwo, K., ... Viner, R. M. (2016). Our future: A *Lancet* commission on adolescent health and wellbeing. *The Lancet, 387*(10036), 2423–2478. — the resilience and promotion sections.
- Steinberg, L. (2014). *Age of opportunity: Lessons from the new science of adolescence*. Houghton Mifflin Harcourt. — **core text**; the risk and resilience chapters.

Seminar questions

1. Count a case you remember: how many risks, how many protections — and which single protection was actually movable that term?
2. "Add protections before subtracting risks." When is that order wrong?
3. Name a turning point in your own life and its mechanics: role, relationship or place — and the sentence in which your self-narrative changed tense.
4. Which of the five Cs does your service supply best, and which does it accidentally tax?
5. A contribution task coerced is not contribution. How does a design keep refusal safe?

Next week

Week 12 widens the lens to the world: one biology and many clocks — adolescence across cultures and adversities, and the WEIRD critique that keeps this volume honest about its own evidence.

12 LECTURE UNIT 12 Teaching week 12 4 notional hours

One Biology, Many Clocks: Adolescence Across Cultures and Adversities

LEARNING OUTCOMES

By the end of this week you will be able to:

1. **State** what is universal in adolescence (puberty, pruning, the absence of universal storm) and what varies (the social clock, the moratorium, the rites), and use the distinction in formulation.
2. **Describe** adolescence under adversity — child marriage, adolescent labour, humanitarian displacement, the adolescent as carer — with the facts, the law and the counselling stance for each.
3. **Explain** the WEIRD critique and its consequences for this volume's evidence base, and practise the correction: sample-aware citation and local validation.
4. **Describe** African and indigenous socialisation accounts of adolescence as theory in their own right, not as local colour.
5. **Audit** one intake instrument or service practice for imported assumptions, and rewrite it for the population actually served.

Where this week sits

Every claim in this volume carries a provenance, and most of the provenance is narrow: the adolescent brain, esteem and identity literatures rest disproportionately on samples that are Western, educated, industrialised, rich and democratic.

This week makes that limitation explicit rather than decorative, surveys what the wider world shows — one biology running on many social clocks — and treats the adversities that reshape adolescence for millions (child marriage, labour, displacement) as core curriculum rather than footnote, because the adolescents of this programme meet them in the first month of practice. It closes the developmental half's outer ring before the clinical weeks begin.

Key concepts

SOCIAL CLOCK
The culturally set timetable of transitions — school leaving, work, marriage, parenthood, household headship — against which the biological clock is read. The same puberty at thirteen means different things under different clocks, and the distress of off-timing (week 2) is a function of the local clock, not of biology alone. In the room: the question "whose clock is this household running on?" precedes any judgement about lateness or earliness.

MORATORIUM VARIANCE
The socially granted pause (week 5) exists on a gradient from the university gap-year to the absent pause of the child earner; much of what the literature calls identity status is moratorium access in disguise. In the room: status language must always be reported with the pause that produced it.

WEIRD CRITIQUE
Henrich and colleagues' demonstration that the behavioural sciences' samples are unusually Western, educated, industrialised, rich and democratic, and that many classic findings do not generalise across populations; for adolescent science the correction is sample-aware citation, replication attention, and local validation before import. In the room: the sentence "this finding comes from a sample unlike this child" is a clinical statement, not a caveat.

SOCIALISATION GOALS
The account, developed in African and cross-cultural psychology (Nsamenang among others), that development is organised by the community's socialisation goals — responsible participation, duty, relational personhood — rather than by individual autonomy alone; adolescence under these goals is induction into responsibility, and its crises are crises of participation rather than of separation. In the room: a second theory of the same years, with its own predictions, and a check on the autonomy-default of imported models.

Lecture I — Universals and variations, precisely

What travels: puberty's biology and its secular trend; the brain's pruning and myelination timetable; sleep's phase delay; the absence of universal storm and stress (week 1); the peer world's layered structure (week 9), found wherever adolescents are in number enough to form one. **What varies:** the social clock's transitions and their order; the moratorium's existence and length; the rites that mark the passage — initiation, confirmation, graduation, marriage — which supply in some cultures the public identity-conferral that Western adolescents must extract from exams and likes; the household's jurisdiction map (week 8), whose personal domain is culturally sized; and the meaning of distress's idioms — somatic, spiritual, behavioural — through which internalising arrives at the clinic door.

The formulation consequence is exact: biology supplies the timing questions (week 2), the social clock supplies the meaning questions, and a counsellor who imports the clock with the biology will pathologise a married fifteen-year-old's grief as regression, or a child earner's foreclosure as failure, when the accurate sentence is that the clock and the biology have been made to disagree by an economy.

Lecture II — Adolescence under adversity

Child marriage remains prevalent in parts of the world this programme serves: a transition that ends the moratorium, removes the peer world and the school clock at once, and carries maternal and mental-health risks that are documented and grave. The counselling stance has three parts and they do not contradict: the law (the jurisdiction's marriage age and protection statutes govern, and the counsellor reports where the law requires); the child (her safety, her voice, her own timetable for any decision, and the accompaniment principle); and the household (worked with rather than indicted, because the household is usually acting inside an economy and a norm, and conversion of the norm is slower work than rescue and is the work that saves the next girl). **Adolescent labour** was assessed in week 10 as harness and hazard; under adversity the hazard end governs and the protection pathway opens. **Humanitarian displacement** breaks every transition at once — school, home, clinic, peer world, language — and the counselling task is belonging-reconstruction in order (one adult, one routine, one peer, one role), because the resilience literature's first factor is the one displacement removes first. **The adolescent as carer** — of siblings, of a sick parent — is an induction into responsibility that socialisation-goal theories can honour and deficit models cannot: the file records the load and its hours, the school is brought into the plan, and the word "mature" is banned from the record, because it is the adjective that hides a childhood.

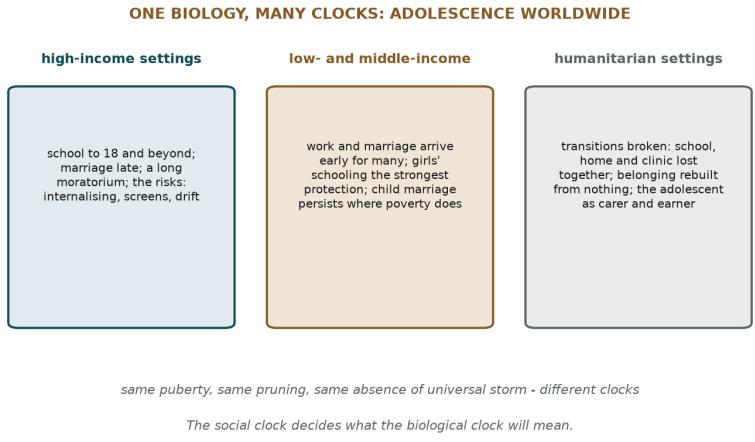


Figure 12.1 One biology, many clocks: three settings with the same puberty and pruning under different social clocks and adversities. *Source:* prepared for this edition.

PRACTICE NOTE

Clinical implication. In every formulation, write two lines: the biological clock's state (week 2) and the social clock's timetable with its owners (household, economy, law, faith). Where the two disagree, the disagreement is a finding, not a footnote.

Lecture III — The WEIRD critique, and theory from elsewhere

Henrich and colleagues showed that the behavioural sciences' convenience samples are unrepresentative of the species on many classic tasks; the adolescent literature inherits the problem — the dual-systems curve, the esteem dip's size, the identity statuses' distribution and the risk peaks' heights are all estimated substantially on WEIRD adolescents, and cross-national work shows meaningful variation in each. The corrections this volume practises and requires of you: **cite the sample** ("in US and European cohorts…") whenever the finding is sample-bound; **prefer the mechanism over the magnitude,** because mechanisms (pruning, phase delay, peer acceleration, minority stress) travel better than effect sizes; **validate locally before importing instruments,** since a scale normed elsewhere measures something slightly different here; and **treat non-Western theory as theory.**

Socialisation-goal accounts — Nsamenang's analysis of African childhood and adolescence as induction into responsible participation, personhood as relational rather than individual — predict things the autonomy-default misses: that conflict in these settings concentrates on duty and participation rather than on the personal domain; that identity achievement may be authored in the first person

plural; that contribution (week 11's sixth C) is not an add-on but the goal. None of this refutes weeks 5 or 8; it bounds them. The counsellor's discipline is to hold both grammars — the individuating self and the participating person — and to notice which one the adolescent in the room is actually using, because the formulation written in the wrong grammar describes a stranger.

SAFEGUARDING AND DUTY TO REPORT

Adversity presentations carry mandatory edges: child marriage and child labour engage the jurisdiction's protection statutes; displacement engages registration and entitlements that are themselves therapeutic (documents restore clocks); and female genital cutting, where present in the population served, is approached with the law stated plainly, the health facts stated plainly, and the community conversion work routed through the institutions that own it — never through the child as informant against her family in session.

Worked example 12.1 — Hauwa, fifteen, and the arrangement

Task. Hauwa (15, SS1) is withdrawn from school mid-term by her uncle for a marriage arrangement to a trader of thirty-four; the household frames it as protection after her father's death; the jurisdiction's law sets the marriage age at eighteen. She presents to the school counsellor on the day of withdrawal with one sentence: "I want to sit my exam." Formulate and plan.

Solution. *The two clocks:* biological — menarche at twelve, development unremarkable; social — the household's clock runs on an economy (the uncle's debt, the norm that marriage protects girls) rather than on the statute; the disagreement between clock and law is the case's first finding. *Formulation in five parts (week 13's form, previewed):* presenting — school withdrawal and the exam sentence; developmental — no prior mental-health contact, strong school belonging, one close friendship, choir absent, faith community present; maintaining — the arrangement removes every protective factor at once (school, peer, routine, future orientation) and supplies none; context — the uncle acts inside debt and norm, the mother is present but silent in the first meeting, the law is eighteen; risk — maternal and mental-health risks of the marriage, loss of the moratorium, and the safeguarding status of a minor in a marriage arrangement. *The plan, ordered:* law first — the protection report made per statute, with Hauwa told what will happen and in what order before it happens (accompaniment principle); child second — her exam sentence is honoured literally: the school is asked in writing to keep her registration and exam entry alive pending the process, because a live exam entry is a live clock; household third — the mother and uncle met with the community's own institutions present (the imam, the ward's women's leader), the conversion argument made in the household's grammar: protection is what the arrangement claims to supply, and the school-plus-bursary route supplies it

with the law on its side and the trader's money replaced by the board's fee plan (week 10's rung); service fourth — Hauwa counselled weekly through the process regardless of outcome, with the belonging-reconstruction order (one adult, one routine, one peer, one role) ready if displacement within the family occurs. *The sentence the file keeps:* her one sentence is the formulation's spine — "I want to sit my exam" is a future orientation intact, the protective factor with the shortest restoration path, and therefore the first thing defended. Falsifier: if the exam entry lapses or the report stalls at four weeks, escalation to the statutory child-protection authority's senior officer is automatic and dated in the file now, not later.

Worked example 12.2 — Auditing the intake form

Task. Audit this programme's model adolescent intake form (supplied) for imported assumptions; rewrite three items.

Solution. *Item 1, "Who lives in your home?"* assumes a nuclear household: rewritten as "Where do you sleep, where do you eat, and who pays your fees? — name the people in each answer," which finds the compound, the auntie's household, the boarding house and the child-as-carer load in three questions instead of hiding them. *Item 2, "What do you want to be?"* assumes an individual vocational self and a moratorium: rewritten as two questions — "What work do you already do, paid or unpaid, and how many hours in a school week?" and "What does your household expect of you this year, and what do you expect of yourself?" — which separates socialisation-goal induction from foreclosure, and surfaces the aspiration–expectation gap (week 10) without importing the gap's default direction. *Item 3, "On a scale of 1–10, how sad are you?"* assumes an internalising idiom of feeling-scales: rewritten as "Since the last rains, what has your body been doing that it did not do before? (sleep, appetite, headaches, energy)" plus "What has stopped, that you used to do?" — because in this population distress arrives somatically and as cessation, and a feeling-scale will return a number where a stop-list returns a formulation. *The audit's general rule, written into the form's header:* every item must be answerable by an adolescent who has never met a psychologist, in the words they already have; where an item cannot be, the item is the assumption and the item changes.

SKILLS LABORATORY

Practical 12 — the two-clock formulation. From a supplied case in a setting unlike your own: write the biological-clock line and the social-clock line with owners; locate the disagreement; then rewrite one imported intake item for the population using the audit rule (answerable in the words the child already has). 400 words. The mark is for owners named on the social clock — a clock without owners is weather, and this course plans against owners.

ASSESSMENT

Assessed task. A culture-and-adversity analysis of 1,200 words: universals and variations listed with the formulation consequence stated; one adversity presentation (child marriage, labour, displacement or caring) analysed with its law, its child, its household and its institution; the WEIRD critique applied to two findings used earlier in this volume, stating what travels and what does not; one socialisation-goal reframing of a week 5 or week 8 concept; and the intake audit with three rewritten items and the rule that governs them.

Criterion	Weight
Universals and variations with formulation consequence	20%
Adversity analysis: law, child, household, institution	25%
WEIRD critique applied to two named findings	20%
Socialisation-goal reframing coherent	15%
Intake audit, three items, rule stated	20%

Formative. Write the one sentence from your own culture's socialisation goals that your adolescence was running on — and say whether this volume's week 5 would have heard it.

UNIT SYNTHESIS

Synthesis. Adolescence runs one biology on many clocks: puberty, pruning, phase delay and the absence of universal storm travel, while the social clock, the moratorium, the rites and the idioms of distress vary, and the disagreement between clock and biology is itself a finding; under adversity — child marriage, labour, displacement, caring — the counselling stance holds law, child, household and institution at once without letting any of the four cancel the others; the WEIRD critique obliges sample-aware citation, mechanism-over-magnitude preference and local validation; and socialisation-goal theory from African and cross-cultural psychology supplies a second grammar of the same years — participation and relational personhood — so that the formulation is written in the grammar the adolescent is actually speaking.

READING (APA 7TH)

- Henrich, J., Heine, S. J., & Norenzayan, A. (2010). The weirdest people in the world? *Behavioral and Brain Sciences, 33*(2–3), 61–83.
- Nsamenang, A. B. (1992). *Human development in cultural context: A Third-World psychology*. Sage Publications.
- Patton, G. C., Sawyer, S. M., Santelli, J. S., Ross, D. A., Afifi, R., Allen, N. B., Arora, M., Azzopardi, P., Baldwin, W., Bonell, C., Kakuma, R., Kennedy, E., Mahon, J., McGovern, T., Mokdad, A. H., Patel, V., Petroni, S., Reavley, N., Taiwo, K., … Viner, R. M. (2016). Our future: A *Lancet* commission on adoles-

cent health and wellbeing. *The Lancet, 387*(10036), 2423–2478. — the global burden and inequity sections.

- World Health Organization. (2014). *Health for the world's adolescents: A second chance in the second decade*. WHO.

Seminar questions

1. Which finding in this volume do you trust least for your population, and what would local validation look like?
2. "The clock and the biology have been made to disagree by an economy." Name one case where that sentence is the whole formulation.
3. Child marriage: how does one hold law, child, household and institution without any of the four cancelling the others?
4. Contribution as goal rather than add-on: what changes in your service's definition of a good outcome?
5. Your intake form: which item could only be answered by someone who has met a psychologist?

Next week

Week 13 opens the clinical half: onset epidemiology, the adolescent formulation on one page, and the red flags that move a case from counselling to medical and statutory pathways.

13 LECTURE UNIT 13 Teaching week 13 4 notional hours

Clinical Onsets and the Adolescent Formulation

LEARNING OUTCOMES

By the end of this week you will be able to:

1. **Describe** the onset epidemiology of mental disorders — the cumulative onset curve, comorbidity and heterotypic continuity — and state why adolescent services are prevention.
2. **Construct** a one-page adolescent formulation in five parts: presenting, developmental history and timing, body and brain state, maintaining mechanisms, context and culture.
3. **Distinguish** normative adolescent intensity from clinical presentation using pattern, grip, function and impairment rather than symptom presence.
4. **Recognise** the red flags that move a case to medical or statutory pathways, and execute the referral with accompaniment.
5. **Write** formulations that are falsifiable: each with a dated test that could prove it wrong.

Where this week sits

The developmental half of the semester built instruments; this week begins using them clinically. Most lifetime mental disorder begins in adolescence and young adulthood, which makes the adolescent counsellor the earliest pair of trained eyes most cases will meet — and makes the formulation, not the label, the unit of work. This week teaches the one-page formulation the rest of the programme assumes, the differential discipline between weather and climate, and the red-flag list whose absence is the commonest serious error in adolescent practice.

Key concepts

ONSET CURVE
The cumulative distribution of first episodes: roughly half of lifetime disorder onset by the mid-teens and three quarters by the mid-twenties, with adolescence the steepest segment of the curve (after Kessler et al., 2005). In the room: the sentence that makes every adolescent contact a prevention opportunity — and the reason "wait and see" is a decision with a cost.

HETEROTYPIC CONTINUITY
The pattern by which an underlying vulnerability changes costume across development — the anxious toddler's inhibition, the child's somatic complaints, the adolescent's avoidance and substance, the adult's disorder — so that different ages present different symptoms of the same trajectory. In the room: why the childhood history is not background but the differential.

FORMULATION FIVE
This volume's one-page form: (1) presenting, in the child's and referrer's words; (2) developmental history and timing — the two clocks (week 12) and the transitions; (3) body and brain state — sleep, puberty timing, substances, medical; (4) maintaining mechanisms — the loops, avoidances and contingencies holding the presentation now; (5) context and culture — household economy, social clock, faith, school, peer layer, adversity. In the room: the document that makes the case teachable, supervisable and falsifiable.

RED FLAGS
The presentations that end counselling-as-usual and open medical or statutory pathways: growth faltering or weight loss with restriction; purging; psychosis-type experience (hallucinations, fixed strange beliefs, dramatic functional collapse); manic-type presentation (days of decreased need for sleep with elevated or irritable drive and risk); suicidal intent with plan; substance dependence with withdrawal;

and any safeguarding disclosure. In the room: the list is memorised, because red flags do not announce themselves as red flags.

Lecture I — Onset, comorbidity and the cost of waiting

Proposition 1. The curve is the argument. With half of lifetime onset by the mid-teens and three quarters by the mid-twenties, the adolescent service is where prevention is cheapest and treatment is earliest; the median delay of years between onset and first contact — documented across health systems — is lived entirely inside this age band, as disorder consolidating, schooling failing and identities forming around symptoms.

Proposition 2. Comorbidity is the expectation, not the exception. Adolescent presentations arrive in bundles — anxiety with depression, depression with substance, conduct with trauma, all with sleep debt (week 3) — and single-diagnosis thinking mis-orders treatment: the bundle's shared maintaining mechanisms (avoidance, rumination, sleep, conflict) are usually the efficient target, and the formulation is the instrument that finds them.

Proposition 3. Heterotypic continuity makes history diagnostic. The trajectory changes costume: inhibition becomes somatic complaint becomes avoidance becomes substance; early-onset conduct with childhood adversity is a different pathway from adolescent-limited conduct with peer onset (week 11), and the two require different plans. The ten-minute developmental history — who raised whom, what changed when, what stopped — is therefore assessment, not courtesy.

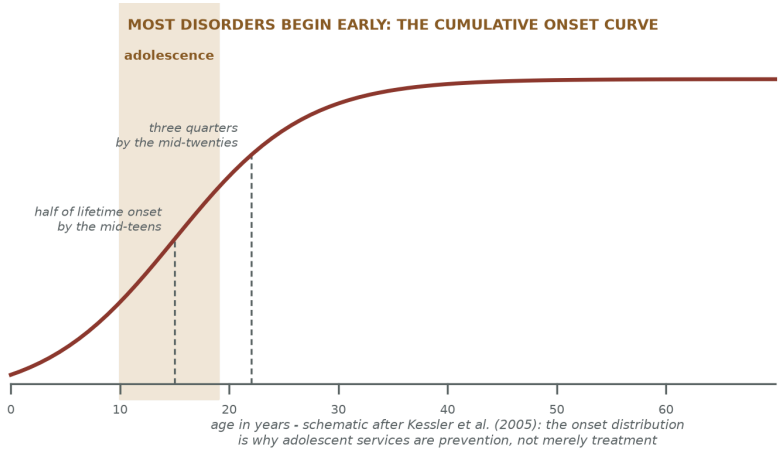


Figure 13.1 The cumulative onset curve: half of lifetime onset by the mid-teens, three quarters by the mid-twenties, with adolescence shaded. Schematic after Kessler et al. (2005). *Source:* prepared for this edition.

PRACTICE NOTE

Clinical implication. Every case file carries the one-page formulation by session three, and every formulation carries a dated falsifier. A formulation without a test is a story; this course grades documents, not stories.

Lecture II — The one-page formulation, part by part

Part 1, presenting: two sentences minimum — the child's own words and the referrer's — because the distance between them is often the case. **Part 2, developmental history and timing:** the two clocks (week 12), the transitions of weeks 2, 6 and 8, the losses and moves, and the childhood costume of the current presentation (heterotypic continuity). **Part 3, body and brain state:** sleep pattern and debt (week 3), puberty timing and its meanings (week 2), substances, menstrual and headache history where relevant, and the medical screen — because thyroid, anaemia and seizure presentations sit in every adolescent differential and are missed by rooms that never ask. **Part 4, maintaining mechanisms:** the loops named precisely — rumination's content, avoidance's list, the household's rankings, the feed's hours, the set's evenings, the sleep's revenge bedtime — each with its short-term payoff and long-term cost, because a mechanism is only a mechanism if it pays something now. **Part 5, context and culture:** household economy and who earns, the social clock and its owners, faith and meaning community, school climate and attendance pattern, peer layer map (week 9), adversity count (week 11) — the page's last part and the first part the room forgets.

The falsifier closes the page: one dated observation that would prove the formulation wrong, written in advance — attendance at week six, nights at week two, the solo accepted or declined — chosen so that it can actually fail. The discipline is not pessimism; it is the only mechanism by which a formulation improves rather than thickens.

Lecture III — Differential discipline and the red-flag list

Normative intensity versus clinical presentation is decided by four questions, never by symptom presence: *pattern* — is this a level or a change (week 6)? *grip* — does it organise the day (week 6's body grip, week 7's climate)? *function* — what is the behaviour doing (week 7's self-harm grammar, week 4's heat)? *impairment* — what has stopped: school, friendship, sleep, play? Two of four positive opens the clinical pathway; the weather conversation continues beside it.

The red flags, memorised and acted on: restriction with weight loss or growth faltering, and purging — medical review first, this week; psychosis-type experience — the hearing of voices, the fixed strange belief, the collapse of function over weeks — psychiatric referral, stated to the family without the word "madness"; manic-type presentation — days of decreased need for sleep

with driving energy, spending, sexual risk — psychiatric referral, because antidepressants and advice both fail it; suicidal intent with plan or means — week 7's pathway immediately; withdrawal phenomena and dependence — medical; and any safeguarding disclosure — the statutory pathway with accompaniment. The counsellor's role at a red flag is not termination but **accompaniment**: the referral is made with the child informed first, the child goes with an adult, and the counselling continues around the medical work, because the referral is a step in the case and not its end.

> **SAFEGUARDING AND DUTY TO REPORT**
> Red-flag referral documentation carries: the flag observed and its date; the medical or statutory contact made and to whom; what the child was told and when; the accompaniment arrangement; the continuing counselling plan; and the review date. Where a family refuses a medical referral for a flagged presentation, the refusal is documented, the risk restated in writing to the family, and the service's escalation policy engaged — the child's life governs the room (week 7).

Worked example 13.1 — Ada's formulation, on one page

Task. Write Ada's complete one-page formulation at the week-13 review, with falsifier.

Solution. *(1) Presenting:* Ada: "the music stopped sounding like anything, and the nights got loud." Referral (school): "withdrawn, declining grades, choir abandoned." The distance between the sentences — anhedonia named in her own idiom versus a behavioural list — is the case's first datum. *(2) Developmental history and timing:* menarche at eleven and a half, earliest in her class (week 2's off-timing meanings); senior-school transition at fourteen with choir and class separation (week 6's transition); father absent since early childhood, mother migrated for work, auntie's household since age nine — belonging portfolio of two moves; no childhood mental-health contact; childhood costume: the quiet compliant child who sings — inhibition in a valued channel. *(3) Body and brain state:* sleep onset two a.m. with six-hour school nights (week 3's debt, counted at seven per week at intake, two at week 9); puberty development normal; no substances; no medical history, menstrual pain moderate — medical screen otherwise unremarkable, documented. *(4) Maintaining mechanisms:* rumination loop at two a.m. on the looking and the mother's absence (content named, payoff: the loop pretends to solve); avoidance list — choir room, front gate, assembly (payoff: shame avoided today); the comparison feed hour nightly (payoff: village; cost: verdict); knowledge-supply to the auntie stopped (payoff: no questions; cost: no witness). *(5) Context and culture:* household economy — auntie's trade, fees secure this year, SS3 assumption dated (week 10); social clock — school-then-trade, owned by auntie and economy; faith community present and re-entered;

school climate — belonging niche restored via choir and one friendship; peer layer — one high-quality friendship, no clique, no romance, no wish yet; adversity count three (parental migration, transition, off-timing puberty) against protections four (auntie, Blessing, choir, faith). *Falsifier, dated:* if at the six-week review the anhedonia sentence persists unchanged despite sleep at midnight-or-earlier on five nights and two choir attendances with the solo, the formulation reorders from situational climate-on-weather to a depressive episode requiring the week 7 clinical pathway and medical review — and the reorder is written, not implied.

Worked example 13.2 — Kelvin: adolescent-limited or early-onset?

Task. Kelvin (16): one arrest (phone snatch, "only held"), evening runs, cannabis "sometimes", repeating SS1, warm-but-stretched household, rankings uncle, set loyalty. Formulate the conduct presentation and choose the pathway.

Solution. *(1) Presenting:* Kelvin: "I am not a thief; I held a phone and the whole world ended." Referral (police liaison): "first offence, cooperative, family present." The distance: ownership absent, minimisation present, shame underneath both. *(2) History and timing:* no childhood conduct history — no cruelty, no fire, no theft before fifteen, school reports describe a sociable average child until SS1; the pathway question answers itself provisionally: adolescent-limited (peer-onset, post-transition) rather than early-onset life-course-persistent, which carries childhood onset and adversity accumulation — and the difference is the plan's spine, because the early-onset pathway demands intensive multi-system work while the adolescent-limited pathway demands that the label not become an identity. *(3) Body and brain:* sleep irregular on run nights; cannabis episodic, no withdrawal signs, no dependence features — monitored, documented, not yet a pathway; no red flags on the list. *(4) Maintaining mechanisms:* the set's evening economy (status via nerve, week 4's heat with audience); the rankings' school-identity damage (week 6) making school a place he is read aloud and found small, so offending supplies the only domain where he is not small; minimisation as shame-management, which blocks the ownership the magistrate's diversion programme requires. *(5) Context:* household warm, structure outsourced (week 8); apprenticeship hinge open with Saturdays in the uncle's shop (week 10); PYD conversion running — the under-14s league, four fixtures staffed of six (week 11); protections now five, risks four and falling. *The plan's spine:* adolescent-limited conduct is treated by **identity protection and role supply**, not by confrontation: ownership built through MI (week 14) toward the diversion programme's requirement, with the sentence "I held a phone" becoming "I took a phone and here is what I am doing about it" at his own pace; the league role deepened to under-tens coach next season (contribution with consequences); the school domain re-opened through the trade's warm standards rather than the rankings. *Falsifier, dated:* a second offence of any kind within twelve months, or league

attendance falling below half of fixtures, reopens the pathway question toward the early-onset model and triggers multi-system referral — written now, so that the kinder formulation is a hypothesis on probation rather than a verdict in reverse.

SKILLS LABORATORY

Practical 13 — the one-page formulation. From a supplied case record: write the five-part formulation in one page (a single sheet, timed at 40 minutes in examination conditions), including the two clocks, the medical screen line, the maintaining mechanisms with payoffs, the context part with adversity and protection counts, and one dated falsifier that could actually fail. The mark is for mechanisms with payoffs and a falsifier that bites — a formulation whose test cannot fail is decoration.

ASSESSMENT

Assessed task. A clinical case analysis of 1,300 words: the onset-curve argument applied to the case's timing; the five-part formulation complete; the four differential questions (pattern, grip, function, impairment) answered explicitly; the red-flag screen documented with flags present or absent named; the pathway decision (counselling, medical accompaniment, statutory) with its accompaniment steps; and the falsifier with its date.

Criterion	Weight
Formulation five parts complete, one page	30%
Differential questions answered explicitly	20%
Red-flag screen documented	20%
Pathway decision with accompaniment	15%
Falsifier dated and capable of failing	15%

Formative. Write the red-flag list from memory. Check it. The item you forgot is the item that will arrive at two in the morning.

UNIT SYNTHESIS

Synthesis. The onset curve makes adolescent services prevention: half of lifetime onset by the mid-teens, comorbidity the expectation, and heterotypic continuity making the childhood history part of the differential; the one-page formulation — presenting in two voices, developmental history and the two clocks, body and brain state with the medical screen, maintaining mechanisms with their payoffs, context and culture with adversity and protection counts — is the unit of clinical work, closed by a dated falsifier that can fail; normative intensity versus clinical presentation is decided by pattern, grip, function and impairment rather than symptom presence; and the red-flag list — eating and growth, psychosis-type and manic-type presentations, suicidal intent, dependence, safeguarding — is memorised and acted

on with accompaniment, because the referral is a step inside the case and the child goes with an adult, not to one.

READING (APA 7TH)

- Kessler, R. C., Berglund, P., Demler, O., Jin, R., Merikangas, K. R., & Walters, E. E. (2005). Lifetime prevalence and age-of-onset distributions of DSM-IV disorders in the National Comorbidity Survey Replication. *Archives of General Psychiatry, 62*(6), 593–602.
- Patton, G. C., Sawyer, S. M., Santelli, J. S., Ross, D. A., Afifi, R., Allen, N. B., Arora, M., Azzopardi, P., Baldwin, W., Bonell, C., Kakuma, R., Kennedy, E., Mahon, J., McGovern, T., Mokdad, A. H., Patel, V., Petroni, S., Reavley, N., Taiwo, K., … Viner, R. M. (2016). Our future: A *Lancet* commission on adolescent health and wellbeing. *The Lancet, 387*(10036), 2423–2478. — the clinical and service-delivery sections.
- Steinberg, L. (2014). *Age of opportunity: Lessons from the new science of adolescence*. Houghton Mifflin Harcourt. — **core text**; the mental-health chapters.
- World Health Organization. (2014). *Health for the world's adolescents: A second chance in the second decade*. WHO.

Seminar questions

1. "Wait and see" is a decision with a cost. Price it for one case you have known.
2. Which part of the five-part formulation does your service currently skip, and what does the skipping hide?
3. A falsifier that cannot fail is decoration. Read your last formulation's test aloud and say what would happen if it failed.
4. Red flags arrive unnamed. Which flag on the list has your room never recorded?
5. Accompaniment: what does your service actually do between the referral call and the medical appointment?

Next week

Week 14 is the craft week: engaging the adolescent in the first ten minutes, confidentiality and consent under Gillick, and motivational interviewing's spirit and skills with adolescents who did not ask to come.

14 LECTURE UNIT 14 Teaching week 14 4 notional hours

Practice I: Engagement, Confidentiality and Motivational Interviewing

LEARNING OUTCOMES

By the end of this week you will be able to:

1. **Engage** an adolescent in the first ten minutes — including the non-voluntary client — using room, seating, language and the opening contract.
2. **State and administer** the confidentiality contract and its limits, and assess Gillick-type competence for consent to care in your jurisdiction.
3. **Apply** motivational interviewing's spirit — partnership, acceptance, compassion, evocation — and its core skills (OARS) with adolescents.
4. **Recognise and elicit** change talk, and avoid the righting reflex that manufactures resistance.
5. **Document** consent, competence and confidentiality decisions so that the record protects the child and the practitioner.

Where this week sits

Everything the semester has taught arrives, this week, in a room with a fourteen-year-old who did not ask to come. Engagement is the precondition of every other skill: nothing works through a closed door. Confidentiality is the door's lock — and its legally-shaped keys. Motivational interviewing is the grammar of conversation with a person who is ambivalent, which is to say with every adolescent. This week is rehearsed aloud in class, because these are mouth-skills, and mouth-skills are not learned by reading.

Key concepts

FIRST TEN MINUTES

The engagement window: room and seating arranged before the child enters (angle, not opposition; exit visible); the practitioner's first sentence about the room rather than the child; the confidentiality contract stated **before** any question; and the child's agenda asked before the referrer's. In the room: the ten minutes that decide whether the next ten weeks exist.

CONFIDENTIALITY CONTRACT

The stated rule and its limits: what is said stays, except where life or serious harm is at stake, and except where the law compels; the child is told **what** would be shared, **with whom**, and that they will know first; the contract is restated when a limit is approached, not only at intake. In the room: the sentence that makes disclosure possible, and the sentence whose absence makes every disclosure a trap.

GILLICK COMPETENCE

The principle (from *Gillick v West Norfolk and Wisbech AHA*, House of Lords, 1986) that a child under the age of majority may consent to their own care where

they have sufficient understanding and intelligence to comprehend the decision proposed; competence is decision-specific, assessed and recorded per decision, and its absence returns consent to the guardian without returning the child's voice to silence. In the room: the assessment that lets a fifteen-year-old consent to counselling in some jurisdictions, and the document that protects the practitioner who accepts it.

MI SPIRIT OARS
Motivational interviewing's spirit — partnership (not authority), acceptance (including absolute worth and autonomy), compassion (the child's interest first), evocation (drawing out the child's own reasons) — and its core skills: Open questions, Affirmations, Reflections, Summaries; with change talk (the child's own arguments for change) elicited and strengthened, and the righting reflex (the urge to fix, warn and persuade) noticed and set down. In the room: the method for ambivalence, which confrontation reliably worsens.

Lecture I — The first ten minutes, and the client who did not come

The room is arranged before the child enters: seats angled rather than opposed, the door and the child's line to it unblocked, the desk not between, water within the child's reach without asking, and — where the service has them — the materials that let hands work (paper, the cards, the walk available). Adolescents talk sideways: the session that begins facing a table begins as an interview, and interviews produce the answers interviews deserve.

The first sentence is about the room, not the child: "the chair by the window is the good one; the fan is loud, I know" — because the child's first task is scanning for threat, and a sentence about the room answers the scan without demanding self-disclosure. **The contract precedes the questions:** confidentiality and its limits stated in plain words, with the child's comprehension checked by asking them to say the rule back in their own words — the teach-back is the contract's signature. **The child's agenda is asked before the referrer's:** "what would make this hour not a waste for you?" — and where the answer is "nothing, I did not choose to come," that answer is accepted as the agenda for today, because agreeing about not wanting to be there is the first true thing the room can share.

The non-voluntary client is engaged by three moves: naming the coercion plainly ("you are here because the magistrate said so; that is real, and it is not your fault, and it is not my fault"); finding the one thing the child wants that the mandate accidentally makes available (the hour off school, the letter for the file, a person who is not a police officer); and contracting small and honestly ("we owe each other six sessions; what shall we put in them so that they are yours as

well as the court's?"). Resistance in this client is not pathology but dignity; the practitioner who argues with it becomes the second magistrate.

Lecture II — Confidentiality, consent and the competence assessment
The contract's words, once, plainly: "what you say here stays here. There are three exceptions, and I will tell you all three now: if you are going to be seriously hurt, if someone else is going to be seriously hurt, and if a court orders me — and even then, you hear it from me first, and you come with me when it is said. Anything else — the pregnancy, the cannabis, the boyfriend, the anger at your mother — stays." The list is given **before** the first disclosure-shaped question, because a contract offered after a disclosure is a confession extracted under false premises.

Gillick-type competence is assessed per decision and recorded: the child's understanding of what the care is, what it is for, its alternatives, its risks and its likely effects; their ability to weigh these and to communicate a choice; the absence of coercion in the choice; and the maturity to grasp the decision's consequences — including that confidentiality has the three limits stated. Where competence is present, the child consents and the record says on what basis; where it is absent or borderline, the guardian consents **and the child's assent is still sought and still recorded**, because consent and voice are separate instruments and losing one must not cost the other. Where the jurisdiction's statute or policy modifies the common-law position, the statute governs and the practitioner knows it — this course teaches the principle, and your jurisdiction supplies its edges.

Information flow inside a family case follows week 8′s geometry: individual sessions' content is not the practitioner's to release; joint sessions are prepared with each party beforehand; nothing is ambushed. The child is told, at intake, exactly what the practitioner will and will not tell their parents — and the sentence is written in the file in the child's own teach-back words.

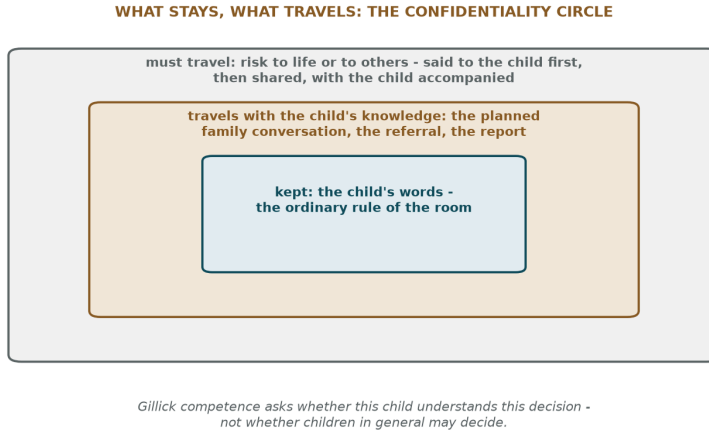


Figure 14.1 The confidentiality circle: what is kept, what travels with the child's knowledge, and what must travel — with the Gillick question stated beneath. *Source:* prepared for this edition.

PRACTICE NOTE

Clinical implication. Rehearse the contract aloud until it is fluent in under forty seconds and survives interruption. The contract delivered haltingly teaches the child that the practitioner does not believe it either.

Lecture III — Motivational interviewing with adolescents

The spirit, in adolescent translation: *partnership* — the practitioner is a consultant to the child's life, not its manager; *acceptance* — including the accurate empathy that repeats the child's sentence before adding anything; *compassion* — the child's interest ahead of the institution's convenience, including the school's and the court's; *evocation* — the reasons for change are extracted from the child, because imported reasons have no owner and no fuel.

OARS, with adolescent examples. *Open questions:* "what is the good of the evenings, and what is the cost?" rather than "you know the evenings are bad for you?" *Affirmations:* specific and true — "you told your auntie about the arrest yourself; that took something" — because inflated praise is the currency of the rankings household and is discounted on sight. *Reflections:* the engine of MI; the simple reflection ("the set is the only place nobody ranks you") and the double-sided one ("part of you wants the league, and part of you knows the league means leaving two of the evenings") — reflections earn the next sentence where questions extract it. *Summaries:* the collecting summary that hands the child their

own change talk back in order, ending with the key question: "and what do you make of all that, yourself?"

Change talk and the righting reflex. Change talk is the child's own argument — desire ("I wish I slept"), ability ("I could do the morning if the phone slept outside"), reasons ("the league needs me sober-ish"), need ("Bisi is tired of worrying"), and the commitment language at the far end ("I will try the phone outside this week"). It is elicited by asking for it ("what would be the good of changing the evenings, if anything?"), strengthened by reflecting it louder than the sustain talk, and never contradicted. The **righting reflex** — the urge to warn, fix, persuade and inform before being asked — is the manufacturer of sustain talk: every argument the practitioner makes for change, the ambivalent child is compelled by dignity to make against it. The discipline is to let the child hold both sides aloud and to sit on the practitioner's own side of the argument, because ambivalence argued **with** hardens and ambivalence explored **aloud** moves.

> **SAFEGUARDING AND DUTY TO REPORT**
> MI is not used to obtain compliance with a practitioner's outcome: evocation means the child's own goals govern, including the goal of not changing today. Where a mandated outcome exists (court, protection plan), the mandate is named honestly and MI works on the child's own goals **beside** it — using MI to disguise a mandate is a breach of the acceptance the method is built on, and adolescents detect it within a session.

Worked example 14.1 — Ada's contract and the competence record

Task. Write the confidentiality contract as delivered to Ada at intake (teach-back included), and the Gillick-type competence record for her consent to continue counselling without parental signature at fifteen in a jurisdiction following the Gillick principle.

Solution. *Contract as delivered, forty seconds:* "Ada, before anything else: what you say in this room stays in this room. Three exceptions, and you will hear all three now — if you are going to be seriously hurt, if someone else is going to be seriously hurt, or if a court orders me to speak. Even then, you hear it from me first and you come with me when it is said. Everything else — the nights, the choir, your mother, anything — stays. Tell me the rule back in your own words, so I know I said it properly." *Teach-back, recorded verbatim:* "It stays unless I am going to be hurt or I will hurt somebody or a court asks; and even then you tell me first and I go with you." *Competence record, per decision (continuing counselling):* understands what counselling is (talk, weekly, no medicines, can stop); understands alternatives (stop now; school counsellor only; medical referral if the week-13 falsifier fails); understands risks and likely effects (some sessions worse before better; the auntie will know attendance but not content); weighs and communicates a

choice (chose to continue, reasons given: the nights, and "somebody who is not family"); choice uncoerced (auntie informed of attendance only, and Ada states the auntie "did not push"); maturity adequate to the decision's consequences, including the three limits (teach-back above). *Decision:* competent to consent to this decision; consent recorded with date; assent-and-voice note added for the file: where any future decision exceeds this competence (medical referral), guardian consent will be sought **and** Ada's assent and teach-back recorded beside it. *The flow sentence given to the auntie, with Ada present and Ada's words first:* "she attends weekly; what she says stays with her, except the three things she will tell you herself now" — and Ada names the three, which is the contract surviving its first family test.

Worked example 14.2 — MI micro-practice: Kelvin's evenings

Task. From the supplied transcript fragment of session four with Kelvin, identify the practitioner's righting-reflex failures, rewrite them as OARS, and mark the change talk.

Solution. *Fragment 1 — practitioner:* "You know the evenings are how the arrest happened, Kelvin." *Failure:* closed, warning, the practitioner's argument — sustain talk compelled. *Rewrite (open + reflection):* "The evenings — tell me the good of them first, because there must be good, or you would not be there." *Fragment 2 — Kelvin:* "Nobody ranks me there. I am not the repeating boy there." *Change talk?* No — sustain talk, and true; the practitioner's next line decides everything. *Original practitioner:* "But the league ranks you as a coach, which is better." *Failure:* contradiction ("but") of the child's truth — the fastest way to close the door. *Rewrite (reflection, doubled):* "There you are just Kelvin — the repeating stays outside the gate. That is not a small thing to give up." *Fragment 3 — Kelvin:* "…Bisi waits up though. And the league man asked me twice already." *Change talk:* reasons and desire, arriving unprompted once the sustain talk was honoured. *Practitioner's correct move (collecting summary + key question):* "So the set is the one room without rankings, and at the same time your auntie waits up, and the league man has asked twice — and somewhere in you those are all true at once. What do you make of it yourself?" *The discipline visible in the rewrite:* the practitioner made no argument for the league; the child supplied two of the four change-talk strands within three sentences of being reflected rather than corrected. Evaluation of the corrected transcript: change-talk count 4 (reasons ×2, desire ×1, ability-adjacent ×1), sustain-talk honoured twice, righting reflex zero — the scoring sheet this course uses in the practical examination.

SKILLS LABORATORY

Practical 14 — the rehearsal. In triads, three rotations: (a) the first ten minutes including the contract with teach-back, on a hostile non-voluntary opening ("I did not choose to come"); (b) the competence assessment conducted as conversation, not interrogation, ending in a recorded decision sentence; (c) ten minutes of MI on a supplied ambivalence transcript, scored live by the observer for OARS counts, change-talk counts and righting-reflex failures. Each counsellor performs all three; observers score on the sheet used in 14.2. 400-word reflection naming your own most frequent reflex. The mark is for fluency under hostility — the contract and the reflection must survive the slammed door, because that is the only door some adolescents have.

ASSESSMENT

Assessed task. A practice portfolio of 1,300 words: the first-ten-minutes plan for a named non-voluntary case (room, first sentence, contract, agenda question, the three moves for the mandated client); the confidentiality contract as you would deliver it verbatim with the teach-back question; a Gillick-type competence record for one real decision in the case, with the assent-beside-consent sentence; an MI transcript rewrite of a supplied fragment scored for OARS, change talk and righting reflex; and 200 words on your own most frequent reflex and its discipline.

Criterion	Weight
First ten minutes concrete, mandated client handled	20%
Contract verbatim, limits complete, teach-back present	20%
Competence record per decision, assent beside consent	20%
MI rewrite scored accurately	25%
Reflex named with discipline	15%

Formative. Record yourself delivering the contract once. Listen for the hesitation. The hesitation is the limit you do not yet believe you will enforce.

UNIT SYNTHESIS

Synthesis. Engagement is arranged before the child enters — angle, exit, water, hands-able materials — and opened with a sentence about the room, the contract before the questions, and the child's agenda before the referrer's, with the mandated client met by naming the coercion, finding the one wanted thing, and contracting small; confidentiality is a stated contract with three limits given before the first disclosure-shaped question, teach-back as its signature, and family information flow governed by week 8's geometry; Gillick-type competence is decision-specific, assessed and recorded per decision, with assent kept beside consent where competence is absent; and motivational interviewing — partnership, acceptance, compassion,

evocation, OARS, change talk elicited and the righting reflex set down — is the grammar by which ambivalence is explored aloud rather than argued with, because imported reasons have no owner and dignity compels the ambivalent child to defend whichever side the practitioner takes.

READING (APA 7TH)

- *Gillick v West Norfolk and Wisbech Area Health Authority* [1986] AC 112 (House of Lords).
- Miller, W. R., & Rollnick, S. (2013). *Motivational interviewing: Helping people change* (3rd ed.). Guilford Press.
- World Health Organization. (2014). *Health for the world's adolescents: A second chance in the second decade*. WHO. — the adolescent-responsive service standards.

Seminar questions

1. Your first sentence is about the room. Why is a sentence about the child a threat in minute one and a gift in month three?
2. The contract offered after a disclosure is a confession extracted under false premises. Which limit have you been leaving out?
3. Competence is decision-specific. Name one decision where the same child is competent and one where they are not, and say what differs.
4. Every argument you make for change, the child is compelled to make against. Recall your last righting reflex: what did it cost?
5. MI beside a mandate, never disguising it: what sentence tells the court-mandated client the difference?

Next week

Week 15 is the practicum: three adolescents — thirteen, fifteen, seventeen — in full panel, with the method's gradient across age and the supervision record that makes practice teachable.

15 LECTURE UNIT 15 Teaching week 15 4 notional hours

Practice II: The Practicum Panel — Thirteen, Fifteen, Seventeen

LEARNING OUTCOMES

By the end of this week you will be able to:

1. **Adjust** the counselling method across the age gradient — session length, opening, language, tools, consent architecture — while keeping the method itself constant.
2. **Conduct** a full first session with a thirteen-year-old presenting with somatic complaints and school refusal, using side-by-side and doing-based technique.
3. **Conduct** a full session with a fifteen-year-old presenting with self-harm, integrating weeks 6, 7 and 14 in one continuous record.
4. **Conduct** a session with a seventeen-year-old presenting with examination anxiety and substance use, in the adult register, with the client's agenda governing.
5. **Write** a supervision record including one rupture and its repair, and use supervision as the method's quality control.

Where this week sits

This is the semester's practicum: three adolescents in full panel, each session planned and recorded end to end, each at a different point on the age gradient of week 14's register. The panel's purpose is integration — every week's instrument used in one continuous record under time pressure — and the supervision record, because practice without supervised review is repetition rather than training. The three cases are fictitious composites, as all cases in this volume are.

Key concepts

METHOD GRADIENT
The method is constant; the register changes: at thirteen, concrete, short, side-by-side and doing-based, with guardian consent plus the child's assent; at fifteen, the peer register — loyalty first, then the worry, hot-and-cold sequencing, the safety card in the pocket; at seventeen, the adult register — their agenda, their words, their plan, the practitioner's questions last, consent their own. In the room: what fails at thirteen is not the therapy but the grammar.

DOING-BASED TECHNIQUE
With younger adolescents, the session's work happens beside rather than across: the walk, the draw, the cards, the task with hands — because disclosure follows activity at thirteen and follows silence at seventeen. The tool is not a game but a shared third object that lets the worry be spoken about at one remove until it can be spoken about directly. In the room: the draw-and-walk session is a full session, not a warm-up.

HOT COLD SEQUENCING
At fifteen, the session is sequenced by temperature: cold material (school, the set, the fixture, the feed) first and at length, hot material (the wound, the scar, the night) later and briefly, with the safety plan closing — because a fifteen-year-old who is asked for

the hot material in minute four learns that the room is an interrogation and returns guarded or not at all. In the room: the agenda's order is a clinical decision, recorded as one.

RUPTURE REPAIR
The alliance break — the missed session, the wrong sentence, the broken promise, the practitioner's irritation — and its explicit repair: named, owned, and re-contracted. Repair predicts outcome better than smoothness, and the supervision record that hides ruptures hides the only material supervision can work on. In the room: the sentence "I got that wrong last week, and here is what I think I got wrong" is an intervention.

Lecture I — The gradient, and the thirteen-year-old with the stomach

Case A: Tunde, 13, JSS3 — six weeks of Monday stomach pains, school refusal rising from one day per fortnight to three, Sunday-night vomiting once, attendance chart showing morning-only absence with afternoons intact; medical review unremarkable (documented, week 13′s screen); referral from the school with the word "manipulative" in it.

Session architecture, thirteen: forty minutes, not fifty; seats beside a table with paper and the ward map from the floods appeal; the walk available and used from minute fifteen; guardian consent recorded with the mother present, and the child's assent recorded separately in his own teach-back words (week 14); the contract delivered at child height: "stays here, three exceptions, say it back."

The session, in order: the room sentence; the contract with teach-back; the agenda question answered with "the stomach" — his word, adopted verbatim as the case's name for the presentation; the draw — "draw the stomach's week": seven boxes, and in his drawing Monday's box is black and Saturday's is a football, which is the formulation's first page without a single question; the walk, in which the peer layer arrives unprompted (the JSS3 class's new teacher who "reads names aloud and laughs at the slow ones" — the humiliation niche, week 6′s loop in a staff member's hands); the doing-based plan — not "feelings work" but two concrete moves: the mother's Monday-morning sentence changed from "stop it, you are late" to "your stomach is loud today; I am still going to work and you are still going to school, and I will ask again at four," removing the audience-payoff without removing the mother; and the school lever of week 10 — one adult in the building (the games master) named as Tunde's person, with the reading-aloud teacher addressed through the head teacher's discipline channel, because a child's somatic refuge is sometimes a staff member's conduct. **Closing:** the stomach diary as a draw, not a form — seven boxes weekly, brought to the walk. Falsifier, dated: Monday attendance at four weeks; if refusal consolidates despite the audi-

ence change and the school lever, the anxiety differential of week 13 reopens with the mother's own history asked, because heterotypic continuity runs in families.

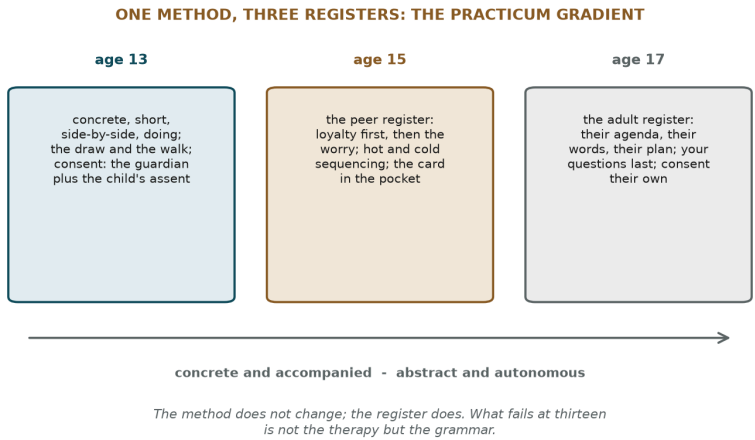


Figure 15.1 The practicum gradient: one method in three registers at ages 13, 15 and 17 — concrete and accompanied to abstract and autonomous. *Source:* prepared for this edition.

> **PRACTICE NOTE**
> **Clinical implication.** At thirteen, plan the session around a third object (draw, walk, cards, task) and a length of forty minutes; write the object and the length into the session plan before the objectives, because the grammar governs what the objectives can be.

Lecture II — The fifteen-year-old with the scar

Case B: Chiamaka, 15, SS2 — healed cuts on the left thigh discovered by the matron at boarding; two episodes, six weeks apart; no suicidal intent on direct question (asked, recorded, week 7); function: regulation ("when the noise in my head is too loud, the pain makes it quiet") plus a communication edge ("at least the matron asked"); sleep debt, comparison feed, parents divorced with the father absent since JSS1; high achievement, choir absent, one friendship of quality at home but not at boarding.

Session architecture, fifteen: fifty minutes; hot–cold sequencing written into the plan as an agenda order — cold first (boarding, the matron, the subjects, the feed, the home weekend), hot later (the scar, the nights), safety plan closing; the contract restated at the top with the three limits and the teach-back, because the matron's discovery has made the child test the lock first ("will you tell my mother?") — and the answer is the contract's own words: not today, not for this; the three exceptions named again; the mother informed of **attendance and the**

safety plan with Chiamaka present and speaking first, per week 8′s geometry and week 14′s flow sentence.

The session, in order: cold material at length — the boarding week hour by hour, the feed audit collaborative (week 6), the friendship-at-home named and its weekly call scheduled as architecture rather than hope; then the hot material, opened by her, in minute thirty-one — the function question asked without shock ("tell me what it does for you"), the grammar recorded (regulation, communication); the interruption repertoire built **from what already works** (the cold shower she already uses at lights-out, the rosary's ten minutes, the walk to the gate) and written on the card; means conversation with the matron and mother in plain, unshaming language — the blade not hunted but the household and boarding store agreeing the ordinary storage, said to Chiamaka aloud as friction-removal, not punishment (week 7); the safety plan in her words with the rehearsed sentence said twice; the school lever — one staff member (the maths teacher she named in the cold hour) as her person in the building. **Closing:** review in two weeks; the card in the pocket; the falsifier dated — any fresh mark reopens assessment at medical review the same week; the nights counted at review, because sleep is the first lever (week 7) and boarding lights-out is where the debt lives.

Lecture III — The seventeen-year-old in the adult register, and supervision

Case C: Emeka, 17, SS3 final year — self-referred (the first in this panel, and the register changes at the door): examination anxiety with insomnia, and cannabis "to sleep, most nights since the mocks"; aspiration–expectation sentences recorded verbatim (week 10): "medicine at the university" versus "I will fail and the house will sell the land"; father's stroke last year, Emeka as the eldest son carrying the household's entire future orientation alone.

Session architecture, seventeen: fifty minutes; his agenda governs and is written first — the sleep and the cannabis, in his order, not the practitioner's; consent his own, competence recorded per decision including the decision about what the family is told (nothing, today; the plan for the father's conversation drafted **by him** in session four); the practitioner's questions deferred to the final third; MI as the grammar throughout, because ambivalence is the case (the cannabis works tonight and costs tomorrow — a true double-sided reflection, not a contradiction).

The session, in order: his agenda; the contract; the sleep architecture worked as engineering (week 3): the phone's exile to the hallway, the revision hour moved from midnight to after the dawn prayer, the caffeine of the evening kiosk named; the cannabis addressed by evocation only in session one — the good and the cost in his own words, change talk counted (desire, reasons, one commitment-

language sentence: "I want the nights to be mine again"), no advice given, the information offered when asked and only then; the household's future orientation **shared rather than carried** — the session's deepest work: the sentence "the land is not yours alone to save" rehearsed for the family conversation he will lead, with the father's stroke-grief named as the room's unspoken fourth chair; the aspiration rung dated (week 10): the university form completed in session five, together, because at seventeen the rung is completed in the room or not at all. **Closing:** his own plan, in his words, on his phone's note app — the card's adult form.

The supervision record, and rupture: in session three the practitioner, tired, answered Emeka's hesitation with "you know what you need to do" — the righting reflex in its laziest costume; Emeka went quiet and the session ended eight minutes early. The record carries the rupture named and owned; supervision's three questions (what was the practitioner carrying? what did the child's hesitation actually say? what is the repair sentence?); and the repair delivered at session four's opening, verbatim: "Last week I answered your silence with a sentence that belonged to your father, not to me. I got that wrong. Your hesitation was telling me something, and I talked over it — say it again, I am listening now." Emeka's change talk returned in the fourth sentence. The lesson the panel exists to teach: the repair is not damage control; at seventeen, being repaired by an adult is rarer than being apologised to by none, and the alliance that survives a named rupture is the alliance that holds at two in the morning.

> **SAFEGUARDING AND DUTY TO REPORT**
> The panel's three cases each carry one safeguarding edge to check in examination conditions: Case A — the staff member's conduct (report per policy; the child's person is not the accused adult); Case B — means storage and the matron's role (institutional child-protection officer engaged; boarding policy reviewed); Case C — the cannabis's supplier within the school (statutory and school policy edges named; the child's own use handled clinically, the supply handled institutionally). A practicum record that misses its safeguarding edge fails regardless of technique marks.

Worked example 15.1 — Case A's full session plan

Task. Write Tunde's session-one plan in the examination format: architecture line, contract line, agenda line, third object, doing-based moves, closing, falsifier.

Solution. *Architecture:* 40 minutes; room B (the window chair, the fan off); seats beside the table; paper, pencils, the ward map; walk route agreed with the office before the session. *Consent:* mother's written consent recorded 12/—; Tunde's assent teach-back verbatim: "I can stop when I want and my mum knows I come." *Contract:* delivered at minute two; teach-back verbatim: "stays

here unless hurt or court; then you tell me first." *Agenda:* "the stomach" (his word adopted). *Third object:* "draw the stomach's week" — seven boxes; Monday black, Saturday football; the draw discussed at one remove ("what does Monday's box know?") before directly. *Walk, minute fifteen:* route via the junior pitch; the peer layer arrives unprompted (the reading-aloud teacher); the practitioner reflects only, no questions for four minutes. *Doing-based moves:* (i) the mother's Monday sentence rewritten with Tunde choosing the words; (ii) the games master named as his person, introduction arranged for Thursday; (iii) the head-teacher channel opened for the reading-aloud conduct, with Tunde informed of every step beforehand (accompaniment). *Closing:* the seven-box draw diary; next session booked at his chosen day (Saturday — his football day, chosen deliberately so the session rides the good day); the mother's teach-back of the Monday sentence recorded. *Falsifier:* Monday attendance ≥3 of 4 at week four; else week 13′s anxiety differential reopens including maternal history.

Worked example 15.2 — Case C's rupture record

Task. Write the supervision record for Emeka's session-three rupture in the house format: event, practitioner's carrying, child's hesitation decoded, repair sentence, outcome, learning.

Solution. *Event:* minute 34, Emeka hesitates on the cannabis-cost sentence; practitioner says "you know what you need to do"; silence; session ends eight minutes early; practitioner's note that night reads "client resistant" — corrected in supervision to "practitioner reflex". *Practitioner's carrying:* the practitioner's own brother's examination death the previous year, unspoken in nine months of caseload; the hesitation touched the practitioner's grief and the reflex spoke instead of the practitioner. *Child's hesitation decoded:* not resistance — the cost sentence's other half is "if I stop, I sleep without it and the nights are where my father's stroke lives"; the hesitation was grief approaching, and the reflex closed the door on it. *Repair sentence (delivered session four, minute one):* as recorded in Lecture III, verbatim. *Outcome:* change talk returned at sentence four ("the nights are where he is… I want the nights to be mine again"); the father conversation drafted that session, by Emeka; cannabis reduced to three nights by review without any practitioner argument — the evocation record standing as the method's evidence. *Learning, one sentence for the practitioner's file:* the righting reflex speaks loudest where the practitioner is un-grieved; supervision's first question is always "what am I carrying?", asked before "what is the client doing?"

SKILLS LABORATORY

Practical 15 — the panel rehearsal. In fours (client, practitioner, observer, supervisor), run Case B's hot–cold session to the safety plan, timed at fifty minutes; the

observer scores sequence fidelity (cold before hot, plan closing) and the supervisor conducts a ten-minute review using the three questions; rotate all four roles across the three cases in the week's two contact sessions. 500-word supervision record including one rupture named and owned — a record without a rupture is a record of a session that was not observed. The mark is for sequence fidelity and for the repair sentence delivered aloud, fluently, at minute one.

ASSESSMENT

Assessed task. A practicum portfolio of 1,500 words: one full session plan per case in the examination format (architecture, consent and contract lines, agenda, technique by register, closing, falsifier); the hot–cold agenda order justified for Case B with the minute of the hot opening; Case C's MI scored for OARS, change talk and righting reflex on a supplied fragment; and one supervision record with rupture, decode, repair and learning.

Criterion	Weight
Three session plans in format, registers distinct	30%
Sequence fidelity justified (Case B)	15%
Consent and contract lines complete per age	15%
MI fragment scored accurately (Case C)	15%
Supervision record with owned rupture and repair	25%

Formative. Write the repair sentence you owe someone — client, supervisee, child of your own — and say whether you will deliver it this term. The practicum's final mark is conduct, not prose.

UNIT SYNTHESIS

Synthesis. The gradient holds the method constant and changes the register: at thirteen, forty minutes beside a third object with assent beside consent and the plan built from a draw and a walk; at fifteen, hot–cold sequencing with the contract retested at the door, function-seeking inquiry, means as friction-removal, and the safety plan in the child's words closing; at seventeen, the client's agenda first and the practitioner's questions last, evocation as the grammar, the household's future orientation shared rather than carried, and the rung completed in the room; and over all three, supervision as quality control — the rupture named and owned, the practitioner's carrying asked first, and the repair delivered at minute one, because the alliance that survives a named rupture is the alliance that holds at two in the morning.

READING (APA 7TH)

- Miller, W. R., & Rollnick, S. (2013). *Motivational interviewing: Helping people change* (3rd ed.). Guilford Press. — the adolescent applications.
- Patton, G. C., Sawyer, S. M., Santelli, J. S., Ross, D. A., Afifi, R., Allen, N. B., Arora, M., Azzopardi, P., Baldwin, W., Bonell, C., Kakuma, R., Kennedy, E., Mahon, J., McGovern, T., Mokdad, A. H., Patel, V., Petroni, S., Reavley, N., Taiwo, K., ... Viner, R. M. (2016). Our future: A *Lancet* commission on adolescent health and wellbeing. *The Lancet, 387*(10036), 2423–2478. — the service-delivery and workforce sections.
- Steinberg, L. (2014). *Age of opportunity: Lessons from the new science of adolescence*. Houghton Mifflin Harcourt. — **core text**; final synthesis.
- World Health Organization. (2014). *Health for the world's adolescents: A second chance in the second decade*. WHO.

Seminar questions

1. What fails at thirteen is the grammar, not the therapy. Name one technique of yours that does not survive the gradient downward.
2. Hot–cold sequencing: what is the cost of asking for the hot material in minute four, and who pays it?
3. The repair sentence at minute one: why is owning the rupture an intervention rather than a confession?
4. Supervision's first question is "what am I carrying?" What are you carrying this term, and who knows?
5. At seventeen the rung is completed in the room or not at all. Which rung of your current caseload is waiting on a pen?

Next week

Week 16 gathers the semester: the four-strand map, retrieval and examination craft, and the model answers against which your own are marked.

16 LECTURE UNIT 16 Teaching week 16 4 notional hours

Revision, Integration and Examination

LEARNING OUTCOMES

By the end of this week you will be able to:

1. **Reconstruct** the volume from memory as one map: four strands, their weeks, and the instruments each strand leaves in your hand.
2. **Retrieve** the volume's load-bearing sentences under examination conditions, using the retrieval schedule supplied.

3. **Answer** each examination verb correctly — define, distinguish, apply, formulate, design — with the structure each requires.
4. **Write** a case answer in the house structure: formulation, plan, falsifier, accompaniment — and mark it against the published rubric.
5. **State** the four habits the semester must leave behind, beyond the examination.

Where this week sits

The semester closes as it opened: with a map and a question about evidence. This week is revision and examination craft — the four strands reassembled, the retrieval schedule that makes the map retrievable under pressure, the verbs' grammar, and two model answers worked in full against the rubric. Nothing new is taught this week; everything is made examinable, because an instrument you cannot retrieve under examination conditions is an instrument you will not retrieve at two in the morning either.

Key concepts

FOUR STRANDS

The volume's architecture: (I) the body and the brain — weeks 1–3; (II) the self and its weather — weeks 4–7; (III) relationships and contexts — weeks 8–12; (IV) practice and integration — weeks 13–16. Every examination case draws on at least three strands, and a case answer that uses one strand is a case answer about a stranger. In the room and in the hall: the map is the retrieval cue.

RETRIEVAL SCHEDULE

The revision method the evidence prefers: recall before re-reading — the strand map from memory first, the book second; the load-bearing sentences written from recall and checked; the diagrams redrawn from memory (a diagram recalled is a mechanism owned); spaced across the week rather than massed in a night. In the hall: the schedule is supplied below; deviating from it is the commonest revision error this programme sees.

VERB GRAMMAR

Each examination verb has a required structure: *define* — one sentence, the construct and its boundary; *distinguish* — the two constructs with the discriminating test; *apply* — the instrument used on named case material with the output shown; *formulate* — the five parts of week 13 with the falsifier; *design* — the plan with owners, dates and evaluation. Answers are marked against the verb's structure, not their length. In the hall: read the verb twice before writing anything.

HOUSE CASE STRUCTURE

The case answer's four movements: formulation (five parts, one page, two clocks, falsifier); plan (sequenced, protections before risks where the count is high, owners and dates named); falsifier and review (what would prove you wrong, and when you will look); accompaniment and limits (who goes with the child, what must travel, where your role ends and the medical or statutory pathway begins). In the hall: the four movements in order, every case, no exceptions.

Lecture I — The map, reassembled

Strand I, the body and the brain (weeks 1–3). Adolescence defined three ways and the gap between them; the invention of the concept and the three corrections to storm and stress; puberty's axis and its secular trend, off-timing's meanings; the remaking brain — pruning, myelination, the dual systems and their critics, sleep's phase delay. *The instruments:* the two clocks; the timing questions; the sleep audit; the heat-and-weather distinction.

Strand II, the self and its weather (weeks 4–7). Formal operations and the imaginary audience and personal fable; peer-accelerated risk and the divergence-point method; identity's statuses and moratoriums and the minority-stress sentence; esteem's domains and dip and the comparison machine; the internalising gap, rumination, self-harm's grammar, the direct risk question and the safety plan. *The instruments:* the four questions; the status map in three domains; the domain-weight list; the feed audit; the risk conversation and the card.

Strand III, relationships and contexts (weeks 8–12). The family's renegotiation, the three autonomies, knowledge-supply, the domain model and the jurisdictional lever, the two dials in the household's idiom; the peer layers, selection and socialisation, co-rumination, romance's sequence and dangers; school climate and the absence differential, work as harness and hazard, the horizon conversation; risk counted both ways, ordinary magic, cumulative risk, turning points, the five Cs; one biology on many clocks, adversity's four presentations, the WEIRD correction and the second grammar. *The instruments:* the peer audit; the attendance chart; the two lists with counts; the horizon's four moves; the two-clock formulation line.

Strand IV, practice and integration (weeks 13–16). The onset curve and comorbidity; the one-page formulation; the four differential questions; the red-flag list; the first ten minutes; the contract and its teach-back; Gillick-type competence per decision; MI's spirit, OARS, change talk and the righting reflex; the gradient and the three registers; hot–cold sequencing; rupture and repair; and this week's craft. *The instruments:* the five-part page with its falsifier; the contract in forty seconds; the competence record; the OARS counts; the session plan format; the supervision record.

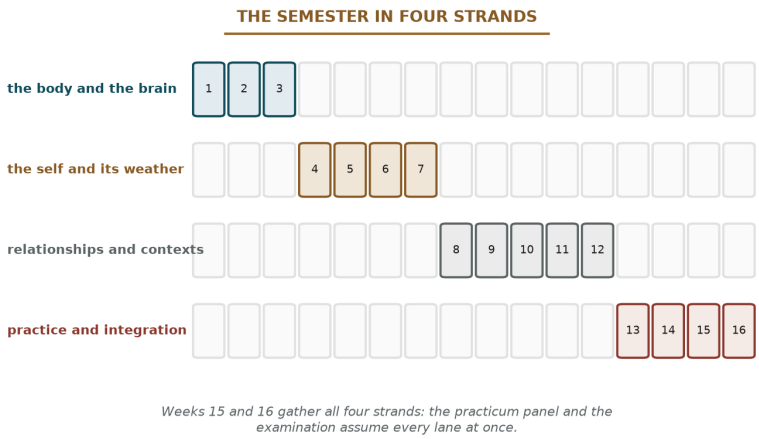


Figure 16.1 The semester in four strands: weeks 1-16 as swimlanes, with weeks 15 and 16 gathering all four. *Source:* prepared for this edition.

> **PRACTICE NOTE**
> **Clinical implication.** Redraw the four-strand map from memory once per revision day, then check it. The strand you keep omitting is the strand your case answers will omit — and the strand your future clients will pay for.

Lecture II — Examination craft

The verbs, with their structures and their common failures. *Define* fails when the boundary is missing ("adolescence is the teenage years" defines nothing; "the interval between puberty's onset and social adulthood's arrival, whose length is set by both clocks" defines). *Distinguish* fails without the discriminating test ("rumination and worry differ" is assertion; "worry is problem-shaped and future-shaped and stops at solution; rumination is self-shaped and past-shaped and stops at nothing — the test is what ends it" distinguishes). *Apply* fails when the output is not shown ("use Marcia's statuses on Ada" requires the three domains named with statuses and the governing strand, not a paragraph about identity). *Formulate* fails without the falsifier and the context part. *Design* fails without owners and dates — a design with no owner is a wish with headings.

Time and structure in the hall: read the whole paper first, five minutes; answer the case last but plan it first (the case is where the marks' structure is strictest and panic costs most); budget by marks, not by interest; leave the final five minutes for the falsifier line and the accompaniment line, because those two lines are where examiners look first and students drop last.

The retrieval schedule for this volume, one week: day 1 — strand I map from memory, then check; the three corrections to storm and stress written verbatim from recall. Day 2 — strand II map; the risk conversation's four assessments and the safety plan's five lines, written from recall and checked. Day 3 — strand III map; the jurisdictional lever and the horizon's four moves aloud. Day 4 — strand IV map; the contract in forty seconds, timed, twice; the red-flag list from memory. Day 5 — two diagrams redrawn from memory (the dual systems and the confidentiality circle), then checked. Day 6 — one full case answer under timed conditions against the rubric below. Day 7 — rest, and one walk through the map in your head, strand by strand, without the book.

Lecture III — Model answers, and the habits beyond the hall

Model answer A (formulate; 25 marks), abridged to its structure. *Case:* Bala, 14, JSS2, brought by his mother after the floods: anger at home, sleeping in the day, refusal of the temporary school, one fight. *Formulation, five parts:* presenting in two voices (Bala: "the water took the house and you people want me to wear a uniform"; mother: "he is becoming a stranger"); history and timing — displacement at thirteen and a half (the social clock broken mid-transition, week 12), father deceased two years prior (the loss beneath the loss), no prior contact; body and brain — day-night inversion (phase delay plus no dawn obligation in the camp, week 3), no substances reported, medical screen asked and unremarkable; maintaining mechanisms — the day-sleep protects him from the camp's daytime idleness and from the temporary school where he is "the flood boy" (belonging wound, week 6), the anger supplies the only register in which the household hears him (function, week 7's mask); context — camp economy, mother's trading hours, the peer layer scattered (week 9's losses across every layer at once), faith community intact but unattended, adversity count six, protections two. *Falsifier:* if the uniform refusal persists at four weeks despite the belonging niche and the sleep re-anchoring, grief work (the father) opens as the governing strand rather than the displacement. *Plan, sequenced:* protections first — the sleep anchor (dawn task at the mother's stall, week 3), one adult in the temporary school named (week 10's lever), the faith community's youth group as the belonging bridge (week 11's setting); then the risks — the fight addressed through the ward's youth rota with contribution (the flood-drain team, supervised, week 11's safeguard note honoured); the grief conversation scheduled, not forced, with the father's name said aloud once by the practitioner so that the room permits it. *Accompaniment and limits:* mother informed of attendance and plan with Bala present and speaking first; no red flags present on the list, documented; review at four weeks with the falsifier read aloud from the file.

Model answer B (design; 20 marks), structure only. *Task:* design a school-based group for SS1 students with rising absence. *Design against the five PYD*

features: sustained (a term, weekly, same room); adult relationship (the games master, trained one afternoon, supervised monthly); skill with standards (the under-14s league's administration — fixtures, ledger, kit, with the league's own rules as standards); contribution with consequences (the juniors' season depends on the group's work — real, checkable, public); cross-setting alignment (the attendance officer feeds the group's fixture list into the absence follow-up, so attendance becomes the route to the fixture rather than the enemy of it). *Owners and dates:* games master (weekly), attendance officer (fortnightly feed), counsellor (monthly supervision of the group as a whole); evaluation counted and dated — attendance slope per member at weeks six and twelve, fixtures staffed per month, one voluntary telling per member per month to any adult in the design. *The sentence that would fail it:* any member's safeguarding concern places them outside unsupervised charge of juniors immediately (week 11's safeguard), and the design records that rule at the top, not in a footnote.

The four habits beyond the hall. *Count in both directions* — risks and protections, every case, forever. *Date your falsifiers* — a plan without a test is a story, and stories thicken while children wait. *Say the contract before the question* — in every room you ever hold, including the ones without walls: the walk, the stall, the pitch. *Accompany* — the child goes with an adult, not to one; in referrals, in protection work, in the family conversation, in the examination of your own practice before a supervisor. These four are the semester's residue; the marks are its receipt.

> **SAFEGUARDING AND DUTY TO REPORT**
> Examination conditions include ethics: case material in answers is anonymised and composite; no real client is ever written into an examination script, and any answer drawn from a live case without consent and anonymisation is a conduct matter, not a mark matter. The habit stated here is the habit the profession enforces later at greater cost.

Worked example 16.1 — Marking a candidate answer

Task. Mark the supplied candidate answer to Model A's case against the rubric, and write the examiner's two sentences of feedback.

Solution. *Candidate's answer, in brief:* a fluent narrative of displacement and anger; the formulation's context part strong; the body-and-brain part absent (no sleep, no medical screen); no falsifier; the plan lists "counselling sessions and sensitisation of the mother"; accompaniment unstated. *Marking:* presenting 4/5 (both voices present, the second paraphrased rather than verbatim — one mark); history and timing 4/5 (displacement and loss placed, the clock-break named); body and brain 0/5 (the strand-I omission: the day-night inversion is the

case's most movable mechanism and it is missing); maintaining mechanisms 3/5 (belonging wound named, the anger's function missed); context 5/5; formulation subtotal 16/25 with the two omitted parts costing nine; plan 2/5 (no sequence, no owners, no dates — protections not before risks because neither is identifiable); falsifier 0/5; accompaniment 1/5 (mother "sensitised", the child's voice and presence unstated). *Total 19/40 — a fail that reads fluently,* which is the examination's central lesson: fluency is not structure, and structure is what protects the child when the practitioner is tired. *Examiner's two sentences:* "You wrote about Bala; you did not examine him — the sleep, the body and the test are where his case lives. Re-sit with the five parts as headings and the falsifier as a date, and this becomes a good answer."

Worked example 16.2 — The retrieval session, run in class

Task. Run the day-6 retrieval as a timed class exercise and record the strand-omission pattern across the cohort.

Solution. Forty minutes, books closed: (i) the four-strand map from memory, ten minutes; (ii) the red-flag list and the contract's three limits from memory, five minutes; (iii) one case answer in house structure, twenty-five minutes, case supplied at the door: *Amina, 15, SS1, three weeks of afternoon-only absence, a healed burn on the forearm she calls "the iron", and a boyfriend of twenty-six named by a classmate in the referral.* The case is chosen because it draws every strand at once — the absence differential (strand III), the burn's differential including self-harm function and including the household iron's truth (strand II's function question and strand IV's red-flag screen), the age-asymmetric relationship as a protection-law matter (strand III's adversity and strand IV's statutory pathway), and the two clocks (strand III's culture line). *Marking in pairs against the published rubric, then the cohort's omission pattern tallied on the board:* in this cohort, as in most, the context part and the falsifier are the dropped lines — the two lines that cost least to write and most to lose. *The closing sentence of the semester, said aloud once:* the map is not the territory, but a counsellor without the map will call the territory a mystery, and the child will wait while the mystery is admired.

SKILLS LABORATORY

Practical 16 — the timed case. Under examination conditions (40 minutes, books closed), write the house-structure answer to the case supplied at the door in 16.2; then mark a peer's answer against the rubric and receive the mark on your own with one sentence of dispute permitted. The practical examination of this course is this exercise, observed. The mark is for structure under time — because time is the condition practice imposes, and the hall is merely practice's rehearsal.

ASSESSMENT

Assessed task. The final written examination: three hours, closed book. **Section A (40 marks):** four short scenarios, each requiring one instrument applied with its output shown (a status map; an attendance-differential read; a two-list count; a verb-precise definition pair). **Section B (30 marks):** two essays from four, each requiring a strand's argument with its corrections and its limits (storm and stress; the internalising gap; the family's renegotiation; the WEIRD correction). **Section C (30 marks):** one extended case in house structure — formulation five parts with falsifier, sequenced plan with owners and dates, accompaniment and limits, and the two-clock lines. Continuous assessment (60% of the course mark) comprises the weekly assessed tasks, the practicum portfolio and the supervised sessions; the examination carries 40%.

Criterion	Weight
Section A: instruments applied, outputs shown	40%
Section B: argument with corrections and limits	30%
Section C: house structure complete, falsifier dated	30%

Formative. Write the four habits in your own words on the first page of your practice notebook, dated. Re-read them at your first supervision after qualification, and again at your hundredth case.

UNIT SYNTHESIS

Synthesis. The semester reassembles as four strands — body and brain, self and weather, relationships and contexts, practice and integration — each leaving its instruments in the hand; retrieval before re-reading, spaced across the week, with diagrams redrawn from memory, makes the map available under pressure; the verbs have structures and answers are marked against them; the case answer runs formulation, plan, falsifier and accompaniment in order, every case; and beyond the hall the semester leaves four habits — count in both directions, date your falsifiers, say the contract before the question, and accompany — because the marks are the receipt and the habits are the residue, and it is the residue that will be in the room at two in the morning when the book is not.

READING (APA 7TH)

- Patton, G. C., Sawyer, S. M., Santelli, J. S., Ross, D. A., Afifi, R., Allen, N. B., Arora, M., Azzopardi, P., Baldwin, W., Bonell, C., Kakuma, R., Kennedy, E., Mahon, J., McGovern, T., Mokdad, A. H., Patel, V., Petroni, S., Reavley, N., Taiwo, K., … Viner, R. M. (2016). Our future: A *Lancet* commission on adolescent health and wellbeing. *The Lancet, 387*(10036), 2423–2478. — read once more, whole.

- Steinberg, L. (2014). *Age of opportunity: Lessons from the new science of adolescence*. Houghton Mifflin Harcourt. — **core text**; final pass, preface to conclusion.
- World Health Organization. (2014). *Health for the world's adolescents: A second chance in the second decade*. WHO.

Seminar questions

1. Which strand do you keep omitting from your memory map, and what will that omission cost your first caseload?
2. Read the verb twice: recall one examination answer of your own past that answered a different verb than the one asked.
3. The candidate's answer read fluently and failed on structure. Where in your current practice does fluency mask missing structure?
4. Name your falsifier habit's weakest point: which plan of yours is currently untested and undated?
5. The four habits, in your own words, on one line each — written now, not after the examination.

Closing note

This volume closes as week 1 opened: adolescence is neither storm nor strategy but an interval — a lengthening gap between two clocks, a brain remaking itself in public, a self assembling under new mirrors, a person being inducted into responsibility in whichever grammar their community speaks. The counsellor of adolescents holds the instruments of four strands and the habits of one profession: count, date, contract, accompany. The next volume of this series takes up the ethics that govern every instrument in this one.

Next week

The examination, and then CAC. 703 and the volumes that follow. Take the four habits — count, date, contract, accompany — and the interval, with you.

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